

A map of Brooklyn, New York, showing its various community districts. District 6, located in the northern part of the borough, is highlighted in a bright yellow color. The rest of the map is in shades of gray, with white lines indicating streets and water bodies.

Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests

Fiscal Year
2027

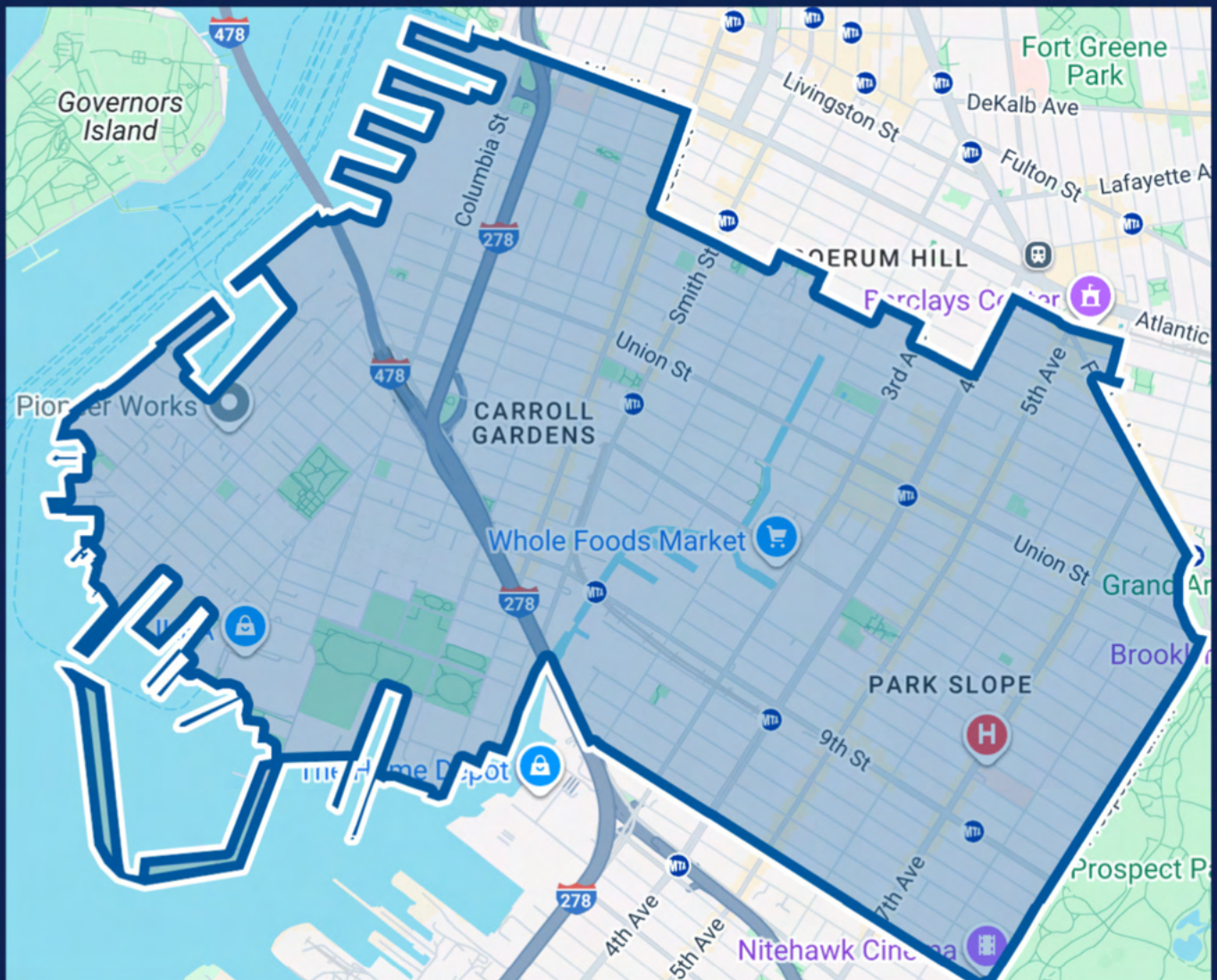
**Brooklyn Community
District
6**

*Prepared by the Community Board
December 2025*

NYC OpenData, New Jersey Office of GIS, Esri, TomTom, Garmin, SafeGraph,
METI/NASA, USGS, EPA, NPS, USDA, USFWS

DISTRICT NEEDS FY27

Chairperson
Eric McClure
District Manager
Mike Racioppo
Land Use
Rebecca Kobert
Budget
Dillon Shen-Cruz
Laura Osorio
Scott Middleton
Anna Hippee



Top Priorities

- Build & preserve housing.
- Infrastructure for climate resilience & transportation.
- Increased social service access.

Statement of District Needs

November 13, 2025

FY 27

Daniel Garodnick, Chair
Department of City Planning
120 Broadway, 31st Floor
New York, New York 10271

Re: Statement of District Needs FY27

Dear Chairperson Garodnick:

Last year, we began our Statement of District Needs with a quote from Martin Luther King Jr.: "Budgets are moral documents." Just as his statement was true decades ago, it remains true now, and it will be true next year and far beyond. As a community board, we recognize how easy it is to view issues only at a micro level. Yet no neighborhood, and no resident, exists solely within the boundaries of a district. Even at their best, these borders are arbitrary. We may represent a district of roughly 100,000 people, composed of six neighborhoods, and depending on who you ask and their perspective, the boundaries of those neighborhoods can vary significantly. But regardless of the boundaries, those who live, work, and study here are also part of a borough of more than 3 million and a city of over 8 million. We keep this in mind when reviewing proposals, making decisions, and voting. While it is easy to forget that we share everything, it never ceases to be true.

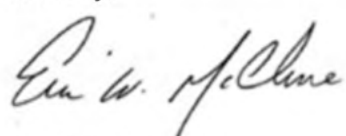
As we submit this year's Statement of District Needs, we are aware that the outgoing Adams Administration has just released its November budget update. The city's November plan, the last of the Adams Administration, increases the total budget to roughly \$118 billion, mainly due to additional spending in Fiscal 2026. Revenues have exceeded expectations, especially income taxes, which brought in over \$400 million more than earlier projections. Pension and labor savings have narrowed the Fiscal 2027 gap from \$5 billion to about \$4.7 billion. The projected shortfalls for 2028 and 2029 have risen to approximately \$6.3 billion each, although City officials describe those gaps as manageable. Taken together, the **incoming Mamdani Administration will inherit a relatively stable fiscal situation**. At the same time, we understand **that no forecast or capital plan is ever certain, especially given the volatility of the current federal administration**. This uncertainty is also why we keep our District Needs Survey open continuously. Much like we do not operate as a community board confined by arbitrary boundaries, people in our district do not live their lives according to the government's fiscal calendar. Their needs, priorities, and concerns do not switch on and off with a budget cycle, and that does not make any of those priorities less real or urgent.

With all of this in mind, the priorities in our FY2027 Statement of District Needs reflect both the immediate needs of our communities and the broader responsibilities we share as part of a larger city. Our **top priority is building and preserving housing, recognizing that increasing housing stability and opportunity in Brooklyn Community District 6 contributes to stability and opportunity citywide**. It's also important to note that the voters of CB6, as we were preparing this, in every neighborhood and 74 of 75 election districts, overwhelmingly supported three ballot measures aimed at increasing housing production in terms of speed, supply, and affordability. Our **second priority, climate resilience and transportation infrastructure**, stems from the reality that storms, heat, flooding, and unsafe streets do not stop at any line on a map. And our **3rd priority, to expand access to social services**, reflects the understanding that the health, safety, and well-being of our neighbors in Red Hook, Gowanus, Park Slope, Carroll Gardens, Cobble Hill, and the Columbia Waterfront are deeply interconnected with the health and well-being of the entire city.

This document is the result of significant and thoughtful work by our Budget Committee. **We especially acknowledge the leadership and contributions of Rebecca Kobert and Dillon Shen-Cruz, who went above and beyond to produce this year's Statement of District Needs**, which was approved unanimously at our November 2025 Full Board meeting.

Thank you, and we look forward to working to make these priorities a reality in the city's next budget.

Sincerely,



Eric McClure
Chairperson



Mike Racioppo
District Manager

INTRODUCTION

The annual Statements of Community District Needs (CD Needs Statements) and Community Board Budget Requests (Budget Requests) are Charter mandates that form an integral part of the City's budget process. Together, they are intended to support communities in their ongoing consultations with city agencies, elected officials and other key stakeholders and influence more informed decision making on a broad range of local planning and budget priorities. This report also provides a valuable public resource for neighborhood planning and research purposes, and may be used by a variety of audiences seeking information about New York City's diverse communities.

HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

This report represents the Statement of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests for Fiscal Year (FY) 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board, collected through an online form available to community boards from June to November, 2025.

Community boards may provide substantive supplemental information together with their Statements and Budget Requests. This supporting material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting them into a web browser, such as Chrome, Safari or Firefox.

If you have questions about this report or suggestions for changes please contact:
CDNEEDS_DL@planning.nyc.gov

This report is broadly structured as follows:

1. **Overarching Community District Needs**

Sections 1 – 4 provide an overview of the community district and the top three pressing issues affecting this district overall as identified by the community board. Any narrative provided by the board supporting their selection of their top three pressing issues is included.

2. **Policy Area-Specific District Needs**

Section 5 is organized by seven distinct policy areas aligned with the service and program areas of city agencies. For each policy area, community boards selected the most important issue for their districts and could provide a supporting narrative. The policy area section also includes any agency-specific needs and a list of relevant budget requests submitted by the community board. If the community board submitted additional information outside of a specific policy area, it may be found in Section 6.

3. **Community Board Budget Requests**

The final section includes the two types of budget requests submitted to the City for the FY24 budget cycle; one list for capital and another for expense budget requests. For each budget request, community boards were able to provide a priority number, explanation, location, and supporters. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests submitted to city agencies.

Disclaimer

This report represents the Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests of this Community District for Fiscal Year 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board.

Budget Requests: Listed for informational purposes only. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests and budget request responses.

Budget Priorities: Priority numbers apply to expense and capital Budget requests from all policy areas. A complete list of expense and capital budget requests by this Board sorted by priority can be found in Section 7 of this document.

Supporting Materials: Some community boards provided substantive supplemental information. This supportive material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting the links provided in the Appendix into a browser.

BROOKLYN COMMUNITY DISTRICT 6

FY2027 Statement of District Needs

Authors: Brooklyn Community Board 6, Budget Subcommittee¹

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¹ Special thanks to the Brooklyn Community Board 6 (BKCB6) Budget Subcommittee—Anna Hippee, Scott Middleton, Laura Osorio, and Dillon Shen-Cruz (BKCB6 Treasurer)—and staff member Rebecca Kobert (BKCB6 Land Use Coordinator). Also thanks to the BKCB6 committee chairs and board members who provided substantial input into these recommendations, and to all who participated in and promoted the public survey.

1. COMMUNITY BOARD INFORMATION

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Address: 250 Baltic Street
Brooklyn, New York 11201

Phone: 7186433027

Email: info@bkcb6.org

Website: <https://brooklyncb6.cityofnewyork.us/>

Chair: Eric McClure

District Manager: Michael Racioppo

2. 2020 CENSUS DATA

The following two pages contain data from the most recent 2020 Decennial Census, which includes basic demographic and housing characteristics for New York City, the borough, and this community district. The data also includes a view of change over time since 2010.

New York City

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	8,175,133	100.00	8,804,190	100.00	629,057	7.7	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	1,768,111	21.6	1,740,142	19.8	-27,969	-1.6	-1.8
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	8,175,133	100.0	8,804,190	100.0	629,057	7.7	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	2,336,076	28.6	2,490,350	28.3	154,274	6.6	-0.3
White non-Hispanic	2,722,904	33.3	2,719,856	30.9	-3,048	-0.1	-2.4
Black non-Hispanic	1,861,295	22.8	1,776,891	20.2	-84,404	-4.5	-2.6
Asian non-Hispanic	1,028,119	12.6	1,373,502	15.6	345,383	33.6	3.0
Some other race, non-Hispanic	78,063	1.0	143,632	1.6	65,569	84.0	0.6
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	148,676	1.8	299,959	3.4	151,283	101.8	1.6
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	3,371,062	100.0	3,618,635	100.0	247,573	7.3	0.0
Occupied housing units	3,109,784	92.2	3,370,448	93.1	260,664	8.4	0.9
Vacant housing units	261,278	7.8	248,187	6.9	-13,091	-5.0	-0.9

Brooklyn

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	2,504,700	100.00	2,736,074	100.00	231,374	9.2	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	594,378	23.7	595,703	21.8	1,325	0.2	-1.9
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	2,504,700	100.0	2,736,074	100.0	231,374	9.2	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	496,285	19.8	516,426	18.9	20,141	4.1	-0.9
White non-Hispanic	893,306	35.7	968,427	35.4	75,121	8.4	-0.3
Black non-Hispanic	799,066	31.9	729,696	26.7	-69,370	-8.7	-5.2
Asian non-Hispanic	260,129	10.4	370,776	13.6	110,647	42.5	3.2
Some other race, non-Hispanic	15,904	0.6	37,579	1.4	21,675	136.3	0.8
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	40,010	1.6	113,170	4.1	73,160	182.9	2.5
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	1,000,293	100.0	1,077,654	100.0	77,361	7.7	0.0
Occupied housing units	916,856	91.7	1,009,804	93.7	92,948	10.1	2.0
Vacant housing units	83,437	8.3	67,850	6.3	-15,587	-18.7	-2.0

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

Brooklyn Community District 6

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	104,709	100.00	113,933	100.00	9,224	8.8	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	19,181	18.3	23,278	20.4	4,097	21.4	2.1
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	104,709	100.0	113,933	100.0	9,224	8.8	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	19,042	18.2	18,136	15.9	-906	-4.8	-2.3
White non-Hispanic	65,691	62.7	69,749	61.2	4,058	6.2	-1.5
Black non-Hispanic	10,967	10.5	10,285	9.0	-682	-6.2	-1.5
Asian non-Hispanic	5,533	5.3	8,372	7.3	2,839	51.3	2.0
Some other race, non-Hispanic	590	0.6	967	0.8	377	63.9	0.2
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	2,886	2.8	6,424	5.6	3,538	122.6	2.8
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	50,268	100.0	53,365	100.0	3,097	6.2	0.0
Occupied housing units	47,188	93.9	49,623	93.0	2,435	5.2	-0.9
Vacant housing units	3,080	6.1	3,742	7.0	662	21.5	0.9

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

Statement on Data Accuracy

Under Title 13 of the U.S. Code, the Census Bureau is legally bound to protect the privacy of individuals participating in the decennial census. To adhere to the law and to avoid the disclosure of information about individual respondents, the Census Bureau has historically applied a host of techniques, such as top- and bottom-coding, imputation, table- and cell-suppression, and data swapping. The Census Bureau is employing a new technique with the 2020 Census, referred to as the Disclosure Avoidance System (DAS), based on differential privacy. With this approach, the Census Bureau “infuses noise” systematically across census data and sets a quantified disclosure risk, referred to as the Privacy Loss Budget (PLB).

While the new DAS approach may diminish the risk of disclosure concerns, it comes at a cost to data accuracy. Consequently, 2020 Census data users should be aware that all sub-state counts, except for housing units (which are unaffected by the DAS), may be adjusted to protect the privacy of Census participants and may be subject to reduced accuracy. Because DAS noise infusion is randomized, it is impossible for data users to know the degree to which any individual statistic is altered. However, it is possible to say that in general the relative size of errors decreases as counts increase. Consequently, data users should have greater confidence in the accuracy of the data as counts get larger. Further, an evaluation of a Privacy-Protected Microdata File (PPMF), treated with a Disclosure Avoidance System like the one applied to 2020 redistricting data, showed that counts of 300 or more rarely have sizable errors (error beyond +/- 10% of the count). Therefore, while data users need to be cognizant of data accuracy limitations, they should have confidence in conclusions based on sizable counts, which are relatively unaffected by the Census Bureau’s latest disclosure avoidance method.

3. OVERVIEW OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT

Brooklyn CB6 represents the neighborhoods of Carroll Gardens/South Brooklyn, Cobble Hill, Columbia Waterfront, Gowanus, Park Slope, and Red Hook -- from the Buttermilk Channel to Prospect Park. From 2010 to 2020, the population has increased by 9% (104,709 according to the 2010 Census figure; 113,933 in 2020 according to the New York City Population FactFinder, and even higher by some estimates). The district is one of the wealthiest, healthiest, and most educated community districts in New York City. Each of our neighborhoods possesses distinctive characteristics; collectively, they reflect our City's vibrant diversity. There are many strengths and assets across the district, including deeply engaged community members, exceptional community-based organizations, excellent (albeit inequitable) schools, physical assets such as the waterfront and parks, landmark districts, and robust economic activity, including essential industrial businesses. However, the data that the City relies on for budget allocations mask disparities across different sections of the community. This is most apparent based on comparisons of census tracts and neighborhoods: Additionally, we must continue to emphasize the issues underlying the City's commitments to specific aspects of the Gowanus rezoning, outlined in the Community Board's conditions for approval, as well as demands from many community organizations, elected officials, and Mayor Eric Adams. There are many specific requirements stated in our Gowanus Zoning Resolution approved on June 23, 2021, that we needn't present here because they were already explicitly conveyed through the DEIS Comments process and the 56-point Points of Agreement, which included requirements for neighborhood investments in housing, infrastructure, public space, community amenities, and workforce and business support programs to improve the quality of life for current and future residents. The document included conditions related to Accountability, Implementation, and Community Participation Public Housing Affordable Housing & Tenant Support Small Business & Workforce Industrial Business Zone Open Space & Waterfront Access Plan Sustainability & Resiliency Transportation & Streets Community Facilities We demand that City agencies and elected officials use that as a guide for investment and focus on affected communities. Although the agreements did not include Red Hook, the community has many of the same challenges, and the points in the agreement can be a guide for investments in Red Hook.

4. TOP THREE PRESSING ISSUES OVERALL

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing

Brooklyn Community District 6 (CD6) is a high-opportunity district, featuring destination parks, excellent schools and hospitals, access to cultural institutions, dense transit access, and some of the City's greatest restaurants—but it has also been decreasing in socioeconomic and racial diversity in recent decades². CD6 is now one of the wealthiest, whitest, and oldest districts in the City.

In order to increase opportunities for more New Yorkers to access the district where we love to live, we must address housing of all typologies: affordable, market-rate, temporary, and shelter. According to the Office of the Brooklyn Borough President, CD6 is below its targets for density in areas suitable for more housing, relative to most Brooklyn neighborhoods.³ Patterns of housing addition and loss throughout the district are spatially uneven, largely due to policies like restrictive zoning and historic district regulations which constrain development potential in certain areas. Upzoning formerly industrial corridors and neighborhoods such as Fourth Ave (rezoned in 2003 and 2011 and included in the 2021 Gowanuz Rezoning) has led to net district housing gains since 2003. However, in the upland, brownstone neighborhoods (Park Slope, Carroll Gardens, Cobble Hill), housing units have been lost to alterations (such as townhouse unit consolidation and apartment combinations) at an astonishing rate: CD6 has the highest unit loss in Brooklyn and the fourth highest citywide (after Manhattan Community Districts 2, 7, and 8), with 1,500 units lost to consolidations from 2010–2024.⁴ For every three units gained through new development in that period, one unit was lost to alteration: a net gain overall that is nonetheless a counterproductive dynamic in New York City's housing crisis. Creation of new units in upzoned regions cannot and should not make up for simultaneous losses in the highest opportunity neighborhoods within the district.

In addition, recent federal funding cuts may worsen all of the different housing needs in the city and in our community, particularly in the creation and preservation of affordable housing. Cuts to Section 8 and Section 9 within the most recently passed federal budget leave our neighbors in public housing at acute risk.

Brooklyn Community Board 6 (BKCB6) believes that improving our housing supply across typologies is essential to ensuring stability, health, security, and economic opportunity for all residents. A coordinated response that prioritizes each of the following housing categories is essential to meeting CD6's diverse needs:

1. **Affordable Housing:** The district has a significant gap in affordable housing options for both rent and ownership. This broadly burdens all low- and moderate-income households who currently or wish to

² Rebecca Kobert, "Middle Housing Gone Missing: Mediations of Neighborhood Change in Brooklyn Community District 6, 2003–2024" (Pratt Institute, MS Urban and Community Planning Thesis, 2025).

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1iShSgdiHgBCc0gghuDicUdfGnrd0hZ_v/view?usp=drive_link.

³ Antonio Reynoso, *Comprehensive Plan for Brooklyn*, 2025.

https://www.brooklynbp.nyc.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/The_Comprehensive_Plan_for_Brooklyn_2025_spreads-compressed-1.pdf.

⁴ Kobert, "Middle Housing Gone Missing."

live in CD6, driving displacement and removing tenant negotiating power. BKCB6 is particularly concerned for New York's lowest-income residents, or those earning less than 40% of the Area Median Income (AMI). Rising rents and limited availability of affordable units (naturally affordable, temporarily affordable, and permanently affordable) have displaced long-term residents and left about 35 percent of households rent-burdened (spending 30 percent or more of their gross household income in rent).⁵ While citywide this figure is a staggering 50 percent, rent burden is concentrated most heavily in our district's lower income communities rather in the more expensive, but affluent, neighborhoods and census tracts. Additionally, given the aging population, investments in affordable senior housing within the district are needed. We must think creatively about how to improve housing supply that is affordable for low-income families, and addresses diverse local and regional needs. This is critical to sustaining the diverse, mixed-income population that CD6 is at risk of further losing.

2. **Market Rate Housing:** Beyond affordable housing, CD6 needs more responsibly developed market-rate housing, the current supply of which is presently among the most expensive in New York due to low vacancy rates and high demand. Targeted zoning and incentives such as those included in the City of Yes Housing Opportunity, which BKCB6 supported for approval, in addition to recently passed charter revisions, such as 2025 Ballot Proposal #3 to fast track modest affordable housing additions (relevant to the built environment of much of CD6), can create a wider range of options for market-rate and missing middle housing throughout the district. Without such intervention, we risk further displacing long-term residents—renters and owners alike—and harming our district's socioeconomic diversity.
3. **Temporary Housing:** Access to temporary housing solutions, including supportive housing, is essential for residents facing short-term displacement or those transitioning from shelters. The district needs more housing options that offer stability and supportive services to help individuals regain access to permanent housing. Investment in these resources can prevent homelessness and support people in crisis.
4. **Shelter Housing & Other Housing:** The district requires expanded shelter facilities that provide not only safe space but also access to essential services such as healthcare, employment assistance, and mental health resources. Existing shelters are often at capacity, leading to unmet needs for vulnerable populations, including families, seniors, school children, and individuals with disabilities. Ensuring shelters are adequately funded and well-equipped is essential to meeting the immediate needs of these populations. Furthermore, we continue to urge the Department of Housing Preservation and Development to allocate for the FY2027 budget sufficient funds for the planning, site selection/acquisition, development, and construction of affordable senior housing and special needs households in the most needed sections of our district.

By addressing the critical gaps in affordable, market-rate, temporary, and shelter housing, the city can create a more inclusive, stable, economically resilient community. We recommend prioritizing these housing needs in the City's budget process to ensure the district can effectively serve its residents and reduce housing insecurity. We urge that City agencies create a comprehensive strategy to alleviate and address critical housing needs to improve the quality of life for all residents in the district.

⁵ US Census. American Community Survey, 2019–2023 5-Year Estimates for CDTA.

Priority 2: Invest in Infrastructure for Climate Resilience and Transportation

Assessing and enhancing infrastructure in CD6 offers the potential to improve lives by mitigating the impacts of climate change and extreme weather events while also improving safety, health, and mobility outcomes for all residents and road users. Investing in infrastructure can create healthier, more connected, and more resilient communities.

With over 6,000 dwelling units in the 100-year floodplain in CD6, thousands of district residents live with a 1% chance of experiencing a major disaster every year.⁶ In 2012, Hurricane Sandy laid bare the reality that the most vulnerable New Yorkers are disproportionately hurt in major coastal flooding events. For instance, the storm caused significant damage to NYCHA's Red Hook Houses. 13 years later, plans to recover and flood-proof the complex are nearly complete. More recently, Hurricane Ida and Tropical Storm Ophelia revealed the extent to which climate change vulnerabilities impact coastal and upland neighborhoods alike; low-lying areas such as Fourth Avenue experience more and more severe flooding during sudden, heavy downpours known as cloudburst events. NYC Stormwater Flood Maps published by the Mayor's Office of Climate and Environmental Justice show that rainfall of 1.77 inches per hour is likely to result in flooding of over one foot in several areas of the district, including 4th Avenue from 1st Street to President Street.⁷ Additionally, New Yorkers observed historically low levels of rainfall and a higher incidence of wildfires in 2024, suggesting a need for greater drought resilience in the City's watershed and water infrastructure.

One suite of solutions to these interrelated problems is the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency (RHCR) project: a local coastal protection project that broke ground in September 2025 and seeks to reduce flood risks due to coastal storm surge and sea level rise along Red Hook's waterfront. While the RHCR has faced criticism that it provides insufficient storm protection, additional seawall, elevation, and drainage infrastructure is being studied in the Environmental Impact Statement for the Brooklyn Marine Terminal redevelopment plan in Red Hook and the Columbia St Waterfront District, which was approved to move through review in September 2025. That plan includes a number of coastal protection measures to guard against sea-level rise and climate change, such as a flood-barrier system spanning the length of the site and built with a design elevation based on a 100-year storm in 2100. The Department of Environmental Protection is currently working on sewer system upgrades and Combined Sewer Overflow (CSO) facilities associated with the Gowanus rezoning in 2021. These and other city-backed funding and initiatives will help the district adapt to climate challenges; foster a greener urban environment; and safeguard both infrastructure and residents.

Preparing for the impacts of climate change is of the utmost importance to the district. Investing in green infrastructure is critical to making our communities less vulnerable to climate risk and environmental hazards. **To address these rising concerns, neighborhoods within the district need further proactive investment**

⁶ Federal Emergency Management Agency, 2015 Preliminary Flood Insurance Rate Maps and 2007 Flood Insurance Rate Maps.

⁷ NYC Mayor's Office of Climate and Environmental Justice. Extreme Rainfall/NYC Stormwater Flood Maps. <https://climate.cityofnewyork.us/challenges/extreme-rainfall/>.

in climate resilience measures, particularly in the climate vulnerable communities of Red Hook and Gowanus. Top priorities include:

- **Implementing resilience and coastal mitigation measures** to protect against flooding and storm surge, including building retrofits, seawalls, breakwaters, and soft shoreline stabilization techniques.
- **Expanding and designing urban greenery** and permeable surfaces to absorb stormwater, reduce the urban heat island effect, and resist the effects of drought.
- **Installing gray infrastructure** such as sewer pipes and underground storage tanks to minimize damage to property and infrastructure during cloudburst events and increase local drought resilience, modernizing sewer infrastructure to accommodate heavy rain and flooding, and improving and maintaining drainage systems and rain gardens to ensure their efficacy in cloudburst events.
- **Protecting electric infrastructure** and expanding local power generation with solar and energy storage systems to protect residents from power outages and reduce energy burden. Red Hook's power grid is highly vulnerable and susceptible to power outages, and must be modernized.
- **Strengthening social services and emergency preparedness** to help residents prepare for and cope with flooding, heat waves, droughts, wildfires, and cold snaps.

In addition to the climate priorities listed above, we also urge the City to examine a range of transportation issues which limit access to services and even exacerbate social and health issues in some neighborhoods.

We suggest a comprehensive transportation assessment of our district to holistically address these long-running issues. Red Hook's residents, for example, live in a transit desert, yet vehicle ownership is uncommon among those with lower incomes, and residents cannot easily rely on other modes of transportation. Walking and cycling, in particular, are not as safe or comfortable as they could be for all residents in our district, with rising traffic congestion, high vehicle speeds, a lack of pedestrian safety measures (e.g., daylighting at intersections), and a lack of protected bike lanes. Further, in the primarily industrial neighborhoods of Red Hook and Gowanus, heightened freight activity from local truck routes and last-mile warehouses also reduce air quality, increase noise levels, and exacerbate poor health outcomes.

A comprehensive assessment should address road safety, walkability, and bike infrastructure needs. The assessment should also address barriers to access in both public transportation and active modes, including considerations for both physical access and affordability. Additionally, the assessment should address the concentrated impact of freight activity in neighborhoods like Red Hook and Gowanus. The 2014 Red Hook Transportation Study could serve as a model for this work and should be expanded to address district-wide needs, as well as considerations surrounding the proposed vision for the Brooklyn Marine Terminal. Any transportation recommendations that arise from this assessment should address the need for protected bike lanes, enhanced bike network connections, curb extensions, and high-visibility crosswalks to enhance safety for non-vehicular transportation options, while also addressing traffic congestion in both commercial and residential areas of the district, most notably cut-through, rather than neighborhood, traffic circulation. Recent models of meaningful transportation improvements in our district include (1) the recent construction of protected bike lanes and daylighting on 9th Street from Smith Street to 3rd Avenue; (2) the safety and mobility improvements on Court Street from Schermerhorn Street to Hamilton Avenue; and (3) the proposed bicycle network improvements on Union Street between Van Brunt Street and Third Avenue.

Priority 3: Increase Access to Social Services

Our goal is to ensure CD6 becomes a place of opportunity not only for the wealthy, but also for those in most need of services, and to empower all of our district's residents to live healthy, stable, and successful lives. However, CD6 has exhibited significant disparities in economic, health, and social outcomes for decades.

Community profiles managed by several City agencies⁸ show that CD6 performs well on a range of economic, social, and health indicators relative to other districts. But district-level data and statistics do not convey the breadth of experiences across our neighborhoods. On one hand, residents of Park Slope, Cobble Hill, and Carroll Gardens are among the most educated, wealthy, and employed in the City. On the other hand, nearly 10% of the District lives in NYCHA housing, including the Red Hook Houses⁹, the City's second-largest NYCHA complex, where 48% of those under the age of 18 live below the federal poverty line and 19% of those over the age of 16 are unemployed, according to the American Community Survey. From 2003 to 2024, CD6 overall became wealthier, whiter, more highly educated and with higher percentages of homeownership, while income disparity and racial isolation increased. Black (non-Hispanic) and Hispanic populations dramatically decreased in this time, while becoming increasingly concentrated in NYCHA census tracts.¹⁰

BKCB6 is concerned that recent startling shifts in federal policy will worsen disparities, cutting off needed funding and resources for social service programming in the areas with the most need, and further driving poverty and displacement. Across New York, people will lose insurance coverage, pay higher premiums, lose SNAP benefits and eligibility, pay higher energy costs, and lose their jobs in healthcare, government, and more.¹¹ Unfortunately, this will likely inflict disproportionate harm within our district's census tracts with higher levels of poverty and unemployment.

We strongly recommend that the City increases social services funding in CD6, with targeted interventions specifically in Red Hook and Gowanus, to ensure continuity in healthcare, food benefits, and other services for our residents most vulnerable to program cuts. Greater budget allocation with targeted neighborhood investment is needed to fill gaps in healthcare, workforce development, childcare, senior assistance, housing livability, food access, and more. Top priorities include expansion of the following:

- **Access to affordable healthcare**, especially in Red Hook and Gowanus, where residents are far from critical medical services (e.g., public or nonprofit hospitals, primary care clinics), experience high rates

⁸ New York City Department of City Planning. Brooklyn Community District 6 Profile (<https://communityprofiles.planning.nyc.gov/brooklyn/6#resources>) and the NYC Department of Health and Mental Hygiene's Community Health Profile (<https://www.nyc.gov/assets/doh/downloads/pdf/data/2015chp-bk6.pdf>).

⁹ The distribution of CD6's NYCHA population is as follows: 2,604 residents in Gowanus Houses; 1,119 in Wyckoff; 2,969 in Red Hook East; and 3,248 in Red Hook West. This totals to 9,940 residents out of 104.1k overall in CD6, or 9.5%.

¹⁰ Fifth Avenue Committee, *Gowanus Neighborhood Plan: Racial Equity Report on Housing and Opportunity* (New York: NYC Council/City of New York, 2021).

¹¹ Center on Budget and Policy Priorities. "Harmful Republican Megabill Fails New York Families, Children, and Communities." May 2025.

https://www.cbpp.org/research/state-budget-and-tax/harmful-republican-megabill-fails-families-children-and-communities#pick_state=1&state=NY.

of uninsurance and underinsurance, and may be disproportionately burdened by debt from high out-of-pocket medical costs.

- **Access to childcare** both in Red Hook and Gowanus and also throughout the district overall, which has 7,500 children under the age of 5, according to the 2020 US Census, yet only 7 childcare facilities across CD6 that accept vouchers or cash assistance to support low-income families.¹²
- **Access to affordable food options** both in Red Hook and Gowanus and throughout the district, amid rising inflation and the reduction of SNAP benefits and eligibility by federal policymakers.
- **Workforce development programs** throughout Gowanus and Red Hook—neighborhoods that are slated to undergo significant economic development but do not provide adequate job training support for local residents, with 1 in 5 Red Hook residents reporting having trouble accessing job training or employment programs in 2018.¹³
- **Targeted health assessments and interventions** for Gowanus and Red Hook, neighborhoods which do not contain their own hospitals, are disproportionately affected by poor air and soil quality, have higher concentrations of residents with chronic health concerns and disability, and are in need of greater support for chronic conditions, mental health, substance abuse, and other health issues.
- **Greater access to public libraries**, which provide myriad social benefits, with a targeted request of 0.5% of the city budget going toward extending library hours, enhancing library programs, and ensuring access to library resources and heating/cooling centers in cases when libraries must close for renovations (e.g., the recent Carroll Gardens closure; the upcoming Pacific Library closure), especially in consideration of neighborhoods with high concentrations of seniors and school aged children.

¹² New York City Department of Health and Mental Hygiene. Child Care Connect.
<https://a816-healthpsi.nyc.gov/ChildCare/>.

¹³ Red Hook Initiative. Red Hook Community Health Report. October 2018.
https://rhicenter.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/01/redhook_chnaa_oct2018_report_english.pdf.

COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS

Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing

The Land Use, Landmarks, and Housing Committee guides how zoning, housing programs, and preservation decisions shape balanced, inclusive neighborhood growth across the district and reflect the priorities of our communities.

This committee recommends that the City of New York prioritizes the following issues in CD6:

- **Improve NYCHA housing:** Update and maintain NYCHA properties to serve a critical segment of the City's residents by allocating funds to improve NYCHA housing conditions, targeting mold remediation, plumbing repairs, and HVAC systems. In CD6, 11% of all residents who rent are tenants of NYCHA properties. The declining quality of NYCHA housing in our district and citywide is threatening the health of residents living in NYCHA complexes. While BKCB6 was instrumental in negotiating for funds from large redevelopments to serve local NYCHA communities, we emphasize that these targeted community reinvestments are not in lieu of NYCHA's ongoing responsibility to maintain and renovate their campus buildings to ensure safety and comfort for its residents. We recognize the challenge of fulfilling NYCHA's \$78 billion capital needs over the next 20 years¹⁴ without significant federal investment, but continue to fight for appropriate levels of investment in our public housing neighbors, and to ensure NYCHA's Comprehensive Modernization Program provides the critical maintenance at the Gowanus and Wyckoff Houses¹⁵ necessary, even if above and beyond the originally allocated commitments of the Gowanus Rezoning.
- **Support deeply affordable housing:** Increase budget allocations for affordable housing construction and subsidies for deep affordability (<30% AMI) in areas experiencing the most need and displacement pressure, with a special emphasis on needs for existing demographics, which includes an aging population (the +65 population doubled in the last 10 years) as well as family sized units.¹⁶ Furthermore, we continue to urge the Department of Housing Preservation and Development to allocate for the FY2027 budget sufficient funds for the planning, site selection/acquisition, development, and construction of affordable senior housing and special need households in the most needed sections of our district.
- **Improve conditions for market-rate housing:** Following the results of a study conducted by CB6's land use coordinator and presented to the board in the spring of 2025, BKCB6 seeks to address natural affordability, increased accessibility, and aging-in-place within market rate housing through

¹⁴ New York City Housing Authority. "2023 Physical Needs Assessment Final Report."

<https://www.nyc.gov/assets/nycha/downloads/pdf/2023-PNA-Report-Physical-Needs-Assessment-NYCHA.pdf>.

¹⁵ City of New York. "Mayor Adams Outlines Blueprint for 'Housing our Neighbors' Plan to Get New Yorkers Into Safe, High-Quality, Affordable Homes." June 2022.

<https://www.nyc.gov/mayors-office/news/2022/06/mayor-adams-outlines-blueprint-housing-our-neighbors-plan-get-new-yorkers-safe>

¹⁶ New York City Department of Housing Preservation and Development. Area Median Income.

www.nyc.gov/site/hpd/services-and-information/area-median-income.page.

multifamily preservation programs and incentives,¹⁷ as well as promoting additional density through adaptive reuse or new development within contextually rezoned and landmarked parts of the district to accompany industrial rezonings. This will create more diverse housing types across more of the district, particularly in the areas most constrained by regulation, where manufactured scarcity drives up prices, leading to poorer tenant conditions or displacement, even of middle income households.

- **Increase affordability with better zoning and funding:** BKCB6 has repeatedly called on the City to take stronger action to generate more affordable housing—both through new construction and meaningful regulatory change, within our district and citywide. We urge the City to maximize the number and depth of affordability in new housing, particularly within rezoned areas. Following the model of Gowanus Green, we seek to see affordable housing maximized on City-owned sites. We also encourage HPD to adopt more flexible program structures that allow for the integration of multiple housing programs—such as combining SARA (affordable senior housing) with other affordability models—within the same development. BKCB6 applauds the City For All funding adopted by the Council in 2024, which supports new housing opportunities created under the City of Yes for Housing Opportunity initiative. We encourage the City to build on this momentum by making similar investments to expand affordable housing within mixed-income developments—particularly in our high-opportunity, transit-accessible areas.
- **Prioritize community input for future NYCHA construction:** Inclusive, community-led visioning processes are necessary to generate fresh ideas for NYCHA campuses. Community visioning sessions have been held at Gowanus Houses and Wyckoff Gardens. Input from these and similar sessions should be incorporated into the development of all future RFPs from architectural, engineering, and construction work on NYCHA campuses in our district.¹⁸

Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure

As the committee dedicated to the public realm, mobility, and essential public services, the Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure Committee guides how transportation systems, parks, and public spaces advance safe, equitable, and sustainable neighborhoods.

This committee recommends that the City of New York prioritizes the following issues in CD6:

- **Fund public parks:** Fully fund NYC Department of Parks and Recreation (committing to at least 5% of the City budget) so that parks may continue to function as key public spaces and resources for our district. Despite some recent victories, including the introduction of new second shift funding and new swim safety programs, NYC Parks has still lost roughly 700 positions due to budget cuts during the current mayoral administration. Restoring the agency’s budget and staffing to appropriate levels is a top priority for BKCB6.

¹⁷ Kobert, “Middle Housing Gone Missing.”

¹⁸ New York City Housing Authority. Gowanus Neighborhood Rezoning.

<https://www.nyc.gov/site/nycha/about/comp-mod/gowanus-neighborhood-rezoning.page>

- **Expand bicycle parking:** Expand on-street bicycle parking corrals in known hot spots where delivery cyclists congregate to keep sidewalks clear and accessible. Where possible, combine bicycle parking corrals with daylighting to maintain sightlines at intersections and improve pedestrian safety.
- **Improve bikeshare affordability:** Expand Citi Bike's Reduced Fare Bike Share program to include public high school and CUNY students aged 16 and above, in order to help make biking an affordable transportation option for young people. Cap e-bike fares at \$3 for rides within Brooklyn for New Yorkers (fares are already capped for rides into and out of Manhattan).
- **Improve safety on school streets:** Fund materials such as barriers and signage to expand school streets to improve safety, especially during busy drop-off and pickup times. Additionally, streamline the process for approving school streets so that all schools in CD6 have this asset. Currently, PTAs must coordinate directly with DOT to get such materials and field their own volunteers. BKCB6 should work with schools and DOT for a long-term vision of building out pedestrian plazas, shared streets, curb extensions, public seating, and more to ensure safety near schools.
- **Fix the Brooklyn-Queens Expressway:** Continue the planning and design of long-term improvements that preserve the southern portion of the Brooklyn-Queens Expressway (BQE) while also improving street safety, promoting equity, and enhancing the public realm. BKCB6 supports proactive measures to prevent BQE's failure, which would have significant ramifications on both the greater metropolitan region and local communities, who already must contend with high volumes of freight traffic and vehicular congestion.
- **Redesign Vision Zero priority corridors:** Prioritize the physical separation of modes, such as the proposed center-running bus lanes on Flatbush Avenue, as the best option to move people more efficiently while also decreasing injuries for vulnerable road users. Important corridors in and adjacent to CD6 include 9th Street, 5th Avenue, 3rd Avenue, Court Street, Smith Street, Flatbush Avenue, and Atlantic Avenue. Priority intersections include 9th Street/5th Avenue, 3rd Avenue/3rd Street, and Court Street/Hamilton Avenue. Additionally, increase budget and deployment of buffered bike lanes and expanded pedestrian spaces.
- **Overhaul our transportation infrastructure:** Budget for a comprehensive transportation plan to discourage unnecessary automobile trips while addressing road safety, walkability, and bike infrastructure needs. The plan should address the need for protected bike lanes, enhanced bike network connections, curb extensions, and high-visibility crosswalks to enhance safety for non-vehicular transportation options. Additionally, the plan should address access to isolated commercial corridors and traffic congestion on CD6 streets, which has been exacerbated by enormous growth in home delivery of goods and which could be improved with implementation of commercial and residential loading zones, better freight management, including the introduction of a robust waterway freight network ("Blue Highways"), and the use of low-traffic neighborhood concepts.
- **Enhance our subway and bus infrastructure:** Fund accessibility upgrades, such as elevators and ramps, at key subway stations serving CD6. Accessibility improvements are broadly needed; other than the 7th Avenue F/G station, no stations within CD6 are currently served by elevators. CD6 also lacks east-west bus service, and there is widespread support to reactivate the B71 route, which was discontinued in 2010. CD6 also suffers from slow bus speeds, and would benefit from implementation

of transit-signal priority and other enhancements such as proposed center-running bus lanes on Flatbush Avenue, on the northeastern boundary of CD6.¹⁹

- **Increase traffic enforcement to improve public safety:** Budget for critical enforcement action throughout CD6. Trucks find their ways onto CD6's more residential streets, coming off of busy thoroughfares, and legal truck routes, like Atlantic Avenue and 4th Avenue. Signage and enforcement are desperately needed throughout CD6 to protect pedestrians and bicyclists, especially in Red Hook, where a number of last-mile warehouses are currently operating and drawing significant truck traffic. Additionally, the lack of overall traffic enforcement, signage, and modern traffic design leaves CD6's streets overcrowded with large vehicles, making emergency response slow in residential neighborhoods. Blatant disregard for traffic rules by drivers is increasingly putting pedestrians and cyclists, including children and the elderly, in harm's way. Hardened universal daylighting, coupled with dedicated loading zones are needed to increase visibility and safety and reduce commercial double parking which endangers pedestrians, cyclists and motorists. BKCB6 also supports the increase of red-light, speed, and bike-lane cameras at priority intersections throughout CD6, in addition to in-person enforcement.

Committee 3: Business Affairs & Licenses

Focused on the district's commercial vitality, the Business Affairs and Licenses Committee coordinates with the State Liquor Authority, Business Improvement Districts, local merchants, and business advocates to strengthen our commercial corridors and foster a thriving district.

This committee recommends that the City of New York prioritizes the following issues in CD6:

- **Continue Open Streets programming:** Continue and expand support for the Open Streets program within CD6. Open Streets corridors have demonstrated significant economic benefits, including higher sales growth, increased business openings, and lower closure rates compared to nearby areas.²⁰ These pedestrian-friendly spaces create vibrant commercial corridors that support local restaurants and bars by providing safe, accessible outdoor dining and socializing options. Maintain outreach, funding, and support for permitting and upkeep of outdoor sheds and spaces, which also serve as vital "third spaces" for immunocompromised or disabled community members and help sustain a thriving local business environment.
- **Promote greater access to affordable groceries:** Building on the successful community advocacy that led to the soon-to-open Lidl—a full-service, affordable supermarket in Park Slope—prioritize the expansion of affordable, high-quality grocery options across CD6. In general, CD6 needs more options, investment in, and protection of affordable groceries; however, Red Hook in particular faces a higher-than-average rate of food insecurity and SNAP usage, making it a key area for investment.
- **Improve rent affordability for small businesses:** Support rent stabilization measures, vacancy taxes, and long-term lease assistance for small and legacy businesses across CD6. Encourage the

¹⁹ Khalifeh, Ramsey. "Dramatic redesign of Flatbush Ave would add bus lanes to gridlocked Brooklyn street."

gothamist.com/news/dramatic-redesign-of-flatbush-avenue-would-add-bus-lanes-to-gridlocked-brooklyn-street

²⁰ New York City Department of Transportation. Streets for Recovery: The Economic Benefits of the NYC Open Streets Program. October 2022. <https://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/downloads/pdf/streets-for-recovery.pdf>

preservation of discounted industrial space and affordable artist studios, particularly in Red Hook and Gowanus, to maintain the unique character and economic diversity of these neighborhoods.

- **Support Business Improvement Districts (BIDs):** Increase outreach, funding, and support for community-based organizations to conduct Commercial District Needs Assessments that consider all transit modes and seasonal factors. Support the ongoing formation of the Gowanus BID, Merchants of Smith Street (MOSS), and other business improvement districts, and encourage local businesses and groups to pursue Small Business Services funding to drive targeted improvements across CD6's commercial corridors.
- **Expand local workforce development programs:** Fund programs and centers for workforce development within Red Hook, Gowanus, and the NYCHA facilities that are located in the district. This includes NYCHA direct-entry union training programs and workforce development programs related to local employment within Industrial Business Zones, with an emphasis on green manufacturing and skilled trades providing higher earning opportunities.

Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability

As the committee dedicated to improving quality of life and environmental resilience, the Human Services and Environmental Sustainability Committee works to address intersecting environmental challenges such as air and water quality, stormwater and solid waste management, urban heat mitigation, and renewable energy, alongside efforts to strengthen community health and social services.

This committee recommends that the City of New York prioritizes the following issues in CD6:

- **Expand childcare:** Increase the number of childcare programs for children under the age of 5 which are either fully funded by the city or subsidized using city vouchers and cash assistance. Expand the distribution of childcare subsidies.
- **Expand healthcare options:** Budget for permanent healthcare facilities in areas like Red Hook, Gowanus, and Columbia Waterfront, focusing on accessible, low-cost services. Access to such facilities is poor: CD6 lacks any NYC Health + Hospitals facilities; the only hospitals that are within CD6's boundaries are not easily accessible to all parts of the district; and private urgent care clinics are unevenly distributed.
- **Increase access to healthy food:** Provide budget for community gardens, urban farms, and affordable food programs to reduce food insecurity in underserved neighborhoods. Expand DOHMH's Shop Healthy! food access programs to improve access to healthy affordable foods, especially in Red Hook, which is not currently eligible for these programs.
- **Support people experiencing homelessness:** Increase funding for shelters, mental health services, and job training programs to support homeless populations within CD6. We must house our fair share of the unhoused population, and to do so, more permanent facilities are needed. Beyond housing, additional job training and placement programs can help address the root issues for the unhoused population, including through support of relevant nonprofit groups.
- **Support victims of domestic and sexual abuse:** Continue funding domestic violence shelters (including shelters that house women and children) and programs that serve those impacted by family violence, child violence, and domestic violence. BKCB6 acknowledges the fact that Brooklyn is the

borough with the most documented instances of child abuse, despite having only one designated Rape Crisis Program (at Wyckoff Heights Medical). We support advocacy efforts and resourcing to mitigate this issue, including those of the NYC Alliance against Sexual Assault²¹.

- **Build and maintain community center facilities and programming:** Allocate sufficient funds for community spaces within large residential developments, including NYCHA complexes such as the Red Hook Houses, to compensate for the many community spaces eliminated as part of FEMA construction work. NYCHA should direct additional resources for the programming and maintenance of these and other community facilities so that they may provide robust and comprehensive programming for community members of all ages.
- **Protect vulnerable areas against flooding:** Allocate funds for fixed and deployable flood barriers in vulnerable areas to prevent damage during heavy storms, including as part of the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency initiative and the tentatively selected plan in the NY & NJ Harbor & Tributaries Focus Area Feasibility Study (HATS), which proposed a series of shoreline based measures for the Red Hook waterfront.²² Fund the improvement and ongoing maintenance of enhanced drainage systems.
- **Improve local resilience to extreme weather events:** Fund emergency response resources, including heating and cooling centers, to assist residents during severe weather, particularly in low-lying or otherwise vulnerable areas of CD6. Fund direct assistance programs for home flooding protection for tenants, and fund programs or create awareness campaigns of existing resources for building owners to renovate and retrofit their properties to combat increasingly severe climate events.
- **Upgrade green infrastructure and stormwater systems:** Increase funds for the areawide installation of green infrastructure including, but not limited to, bioswales, rain gardens, offline retention facilities, rain barrels, pervious surface treatments, street trees, and other best management practices to aggressively prevent storm water from entering into the sewer system, particularly in Red Hook and Gowanus. Reduction of storm water entry into the system is necessary to reduce the amount of combined sewer overflow events that occur, particularly within the Gowanus watershed area. Many green infrastructure investments will also reduce the urban heat island effect and reduce the risk of heat-related injuries during more frequent and severe heat waves. Investments in improved stormwater infrastructure (see Committee 2), including sewer capacity increases and street drainage, is also necessary to mitigate flood risks. Ensure future projects use at least 2100, 100-year projections (Long Island City Rezoning, Brooklyn Marine Terminal), unlike the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency project (used only 2050 projections.)

²¹ BKCB6 received a presentation from the NYC Alliance Against Sexual Assault, led by Executive Director Emily Miles, which shared that (1) there is currently only one RCP based in Brooklyn, Wyckoff Heights Medical Center; (2) two additional RCPs, CVTC and NYP-DOVE, push into the borough; (3) emergency departments in this county have closed or are being threatened with closure, including Kingsbrook Jewish and SUNY Downstate; (4) hospitals in Brooklyn struggle to find advocates who are willing to travel to their locations due to distance or safety of the area; (5) other resources in the Bronx include a Family Justice Center (FJC) and Child Advocacy Center; (6) Brooklyn CAC has the highest caseload of any borough.

²² U.S. Army Corps of Engineers. NY & NJ Harbor & Tributaries Focus Area Feasibility Study Alternative 3B Summary Map. https://www.nan.usace.army.mil/Portals/37/HATS_100yrIntSLR_Risk_wAlt3B_500dpi.pdf

5. SUMMARY OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT NEEDS AND BUDGET REQUESTS

HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Most Important Issue Related to Healthcare and Human Services

Services for low-income and vulnerable New Yorkers

While the District has needs relative to the areas outlined in each of the eleven possible responses, the Department of City Planning's prompt allows for only one selection. As such, we have selected Services for low-income and vulnerable New Yorkers because the most major needs among the other possible answers (Access to healthy food/life style programs; chronic disease prevention; environmental health issues; health facilities; infections disease prevention and management to include COVID-19; mental health programs and substance abuse treatment/prevention programs; programs, services of facilities for seniors; services for domestic violence victims) should, under any reasonable, rational definition of action to address Services for low-income and vulnerable New Yorkers, be addressed as well.

As the committee dedicated to improving quality of life and environmental resilience, the Human Services and

Environmental Sustainability Committee works to address intersecting environmental challenges such as air

and water quality, stormwater and solid waste management, urban heat mitigation, and renewable energy,

alongside efforts to strengthen community health and social services.

This committee recommends that the City of New York prioritizes the following issues in CD6:

- Expand childcare: Increase the number of childcare programs for children under the age of 5 which are either fully funded by the city or subsidized using city vouchers and cash assistance. Expand the distribution of childcare subsidies.
- Expand healthcare options: Budget for permanent healthcare facilities in areas like Red Hook, Gowanus, and Columbia Waterfront, focusing on accessible, low-cost services. Access to such facilities is poor: CD6 lacks any NYC Health + Hospitals facilities; the only hospitals that are within CD6's boundaries are not easily accessible to all parts of the district; and private urgent care clinics are unevenly distributed.
- Increase access to healthy food: Provide budget for community gardens, urban farms, and affordable food programs to reduce food insecurity in underserved neighborhoods. Expand DOHMH's Shop Healthy! food access programs to improve access to healthy affordable foods, especially in Red Hook, which is not currently eligible for these programs.

- Support people experiencing homelessness: Increase funding for shelters, mental health services, and job training programs to support homeless populations within CD6. We must house our fair share of the unhoused population, and to do so, more permanent facilities are needed. Beyond housing, additional job training and placement programs can help address the root issues for the unhoused population, including through support of relevant nonprofit groups.
- Support victims of domestic and sexual abuse: Continue funding domestic violence shelters (including shelters that house women and children) and programs that serve those impacted by family violence, child violence, and domestic violence. BKCB6 acknowledges the fact that Brooklyn is the 12 borough with the most documented instances of child abuse, despite having only one designated Rape Crisis Program (at Wyckoff Heights Medical). We support advocacy efforts and resourcing to mitigate this issue, including those of the NYC Alliance against Sexual Assault²¹.
- Build and maintain community center facilities and programming: Allocate sufficient funds for community spaces within large residential developments, including NYCHA complexes such as the Red Hook Houses, to compensate for the many community spaces eliminated as part of FEMA construction work. NYCHA should direct additional resources for the programming and maintenance of these and other community facilities so that they may provide robust and comprehensive programming for community members of all ages.

- Protect vulnerable areas against flooding: Allocate funds for fixed and deployable flood barriers in vulnerable areas to prevent damage during heavy storms, including as part of the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency initiative and the tentatively selected plan in the NY & NJ Harbor & Tributaries Focus Area Feasibility Study (HATS), which proposed a series of shoreline based measures for the Red Hook waterfront.
- Fund the improvement and ongoing maintenance of enhanced drainage systems.
Improve local resilience to extreme weather events: Fund emergency response resources, including heating and cooling centers, to assist residents during severe weather, particularly in low-lying or otherwise vulnerable areas of CD6. Fund direct assistance programs for home flooding protection for tenants, and fund programs or create awareness campaigns of existing resources for building owners to renovate and retrofit their properties to combat increasingly severe climate events.
- Upgrade green infrastructure and stormwater systems: Increase funds for the areawide installation of green infrastructure including, but not limited to, bioswales, rain gardens, offline retention facilities, rain barrels, pervious surface treatments, street trees, and other best management practices to aggressively prevent storm water from entering into the sewer system, particularly in Red Hook and Gowanus. Reduction of storm water entry into the system is necessary to reduce the amount of combined sewer overflow events that occur, particularly within the Gowanus watershed area. Many green infrastructure investments will also reduce the urban heat island effect and reduce the risk of heat-related injuries during more frequent and severe heat waves. Investments in improved stormwater infrastructure (see Committee 2), including sewer capacity increases and street drainage, is also necessary to mitigate flood risks. Ensure future projects use at least 2100, 100-year projections (Long Island City Rezoning, Brooklyn Marine Terminal), unlike the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency project (used only 2050 projections.)

Community District Needs Related to Healthcare and Human Services

Needs for Health Care and Facilities

CB6 does not have a New York City Health + Hospitals facility and thus lacks access to H+H's rapid point-of-care testing. The only hospital within the district boundaries, Methodist, is not easily accessible to parts of the district, and private urgent care clinics are unevenly distributed. Mobile and pop-up units can be utilized for vaccinations, including seasonal flu shots; as such investments in such infrastructure has broader use. The loss of Long Island College Hospital has not been sufficiently addressed in the district.

Needs for Older NYs

There is a lack of facilities in the district that would allow some of the aging population to remain in their community as they continue to age and the district becomes more and more expensive to live in.

Needs for Homeless

While this Board has been in support of the Mayor's short term response to the homeless epidemic in the city, and believes strongly that we have a role to play in helping make sure the district houses its share of the unhoused population, clearly to project of renting hotel rooms for this population is not enough and more permanent facilities are needed. Beyond that, job training and placement programs to address the root issues for the unhoused population are lacking, and the few local resources available for this are typically non-profit in nature and lacking in critical funding, staffing, and programming.

Needs for Low Income NYs

New affordable housing, job training and placement programs, as well as much needed improvements to existing NYCHA properties and some mode of political infrastructure that can demand more accountability from NYCHA broadly.

HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
HHC	1 / 1	Provide a new or expanded health care facility

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DFTA	1 / 1	Funding for a new senior center program
DOHMH	1 / 4	Other programs to address public health issues requests
DOHMH	2 / 4	Other programs to address public health issues requests
DOHMH	3 / 4	Animal and pest control requests including reducing rat and mosquito populations
DOHMH	4 / 4	Other programs to address public health issues requests
HRA	1 / 1	Other domestic violence services requests

YOUTH, EDUCATION AND CHILD WELFARE

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Most Important Issue Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

Other - Write In (Required)

While the Parks within the District have some needs that fall within any reasonable understanding of the fourteen possible responses provided by the Department of City Planning, we have selected "Other" because foundational issue that undergirds the needs we have in each of these categories is the City's austerity relative to the needs of the community.

Expansion of Childcare Programs: Increase the number of childcare programs for children under the age of 5 which are either fully funded by the city or subsidized using city vouchers and cash assistance. Expand the distribution of childcare subsidies.

- **Health Facility Funding:** Budget for permanent healthcare facilities in areas like Red Hook, Gowanus, and Columbia Waterfront, focusing on accessible, low-cost services. The district lacks any NYC Health + Hospitals facilities, and the only hospital within the district boundaries is not easily accessible to parts of the district, and private urgent care clinics are unevenly distributed.
- **Healthy Food Access Initiatives:** Provide budget for community gardens, urban farms, and affordable food programs to reduce food insecurity in underserved neighborhoods. Expand DOHMH's Shop Healthy! food access programs to improve access to healthy affordable foods, especially in Red Hook, which is not currently eligible for these programs.
- **Homelessness Services:** Increase funding for shelters, mental health services, and job training programs to support homeless populations within the district. Community District 6 must house its fair share of the unhoused population, and to do so, more permanent facilities are needed. Beyond housing, additional job training and placement programs can help address the root issues for the unhoused population, including through support of relevant nonprofit groups.

Community District Needs Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

Needs for Youth Education

CB6 has historically high income inequality, which can often hide the needs of low-income youth behind unrepresentative averages. As the pandemic closed schools and asked parents to fill the gaps, low-income children in our district have borne the brunt of this exacerbated inequality, with many students experiencing food insecurity and unsafe living situations. We urge SCA to fund ventilation and outdoor infrastructure so public schools can operate more safely during public health crises. In the meantime, we urge DOE to continue to fund school meal programs, with pickup options if schools are closed, and high-speed internet access and computing devices for students who must learn from home and lack these essential resources. With 8% of CB6 residents under the age of 5 (a significantly higher rate than NYC as a whole), day care is an economic issue: parents

without access to affordable day care for their children cannot work. We urge DOH to fund affordable day-care options, of which there are only 3 in our district. Finally, the pandemic has caused cuts to youth employment and after-school programs, jeopardizing students' ability to build skills and bounce back after schools reopen. We urge DYCD to re-fund SYEP programs and increase funding to other youth-centered community building initiatives in our district.

Needs for Youth and Child Welfare

See needs for Youth Education.

Build and maintain community center facilities and programming: Allocate sufficient funds for community spaces within large residential developments, including NYCHA complexes such as the Red Hook Houses, to compensate for the many community spaces eliminated as part of FEMA construction work. NYCHA should direct additional resources for the programming and maintenance of these and other community facilities so that they may provide robust and comprehensive programming for community members of all ages. • Protect vulnerable areas against flooding: Allocate funds for fixed and deployable flood barriers in vulnerable areas to prevent damage during heavy storms, including as part of the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency initiative and the tentatively selected plan in the NY & NJ Harbor & Tributaries Focus Area Feasibility Study (HATS), which proposed a series of shoreline based measures for the Red Hook waterfront.²² Fund the improvement and ongoing maintenance of enhanced drainage systems. • Improve local resilience to extreme weather events: Fund emergency response resources, including heating and cooling centers, to assist residents during severe weather, particularly in low-lying or otherwise vulnerable areas of CD6. Fund direct assistance programs for home flooding protection for tenants, and fund programs or create awareness campaigns of existing resources for building owners to renovate and retrofit their properties to combat increasingly severe climate events. • Upgrade green infrastructure and stormwater systems: Increase funds for the areawide installation of green infrastructure including, but not limited to, bioswales, rain gardens, offline retention facilities, rain barrels, pervious surface treatments, street trees, and other best management practices to aggressively prevent storm water from entering into the sewer system, particularly in Red Hook and Gowanus. Reduction of storm water entry into the system is necessary to reduce the amount of combined sewer overflow events that occur, particularly within the Gowanus watershed area. Many green infrastructure investments will also reduce the urban heat island effect and reduce the risk of heat-related injuries during more frequent and severe heat waves. Investments in improved stormwater infrastructure (see Committee 2), including sewer capacity increases and street drainage, is also necessary to mitigate flood risks. Ensure future projects use at least 2100, 100-year projections (Long Island City Rezoning, Brooklyn Marine Terminal), unlike the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency project (used only 2050 projections.)

YOUTH, EDUCATION AND CHILD WELFARE

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
SCA	1 / 2	Provide a new or expand an existing middle/intermediate school
SCA	2 / 2	Renovate other site component

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DOE	1 / 2	Assign more non-teaching staff, e.g., to provide social, health and other services
DOE	2 / 2	Provide, expand, or enhance funding for Child Care and Head Start programs

PUBLIC SAFETY AND EMERGENCY SERVICES

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Most Important Issue Related to Public Safety and Emergency Services

Traffic violations and enforcement

Public Safety Traffic Enforcement: Budget for critical enforcement action throughout the district. Trucks find their ways onto the more residential streets in the district more and more frequently, coming off of busy thoroughfares like Atlantic Avenue and 4th Avenue. Signage and enforcement are desperately needed throughout the district to protect pedestrians and bicyclists, especially in Red Hook, where a number of last-mile warehouses are currently operating and drawing significant truck traffic. Additionally, the lack of traffic enforcement, signage, and modern traffic design leaves our district's streets overcrowded with large vehicles, making emergency response extremely slow in residential neighborhoods.

Community District Needs Related to Public Safety and Emergency Services

Needs for Public Safety

Traffic enforcement is critical throughout the district. Trucks find their ways onto the more residential streets in the district more and more frequently as the years pass, coming off of extremely busy thoroughfares like Atlantic Avenue and 4th Avenue. Signage and enforcement are desperately needed throughout the district to protect pedestrians and bicyclists. This is especially true for Red Hook, where a number of last-mile warehouses are beginning or planning to begin operation.

Needs for Emergency Services

The lack of traffic enforcement, signage, and modern traffic design leaves our district's streets overcrowded with large vehicles, making emergency response extremely slow in the most residential of our neighborhoods, which also happens to be the oldest of our neighborhoods.

PUBLIC SAFETY AND EMERGENCY SERVICES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
NYPD	1 / 2	Other NYPD facilities and equipment requests
NYPD	2 / 2	Other NYPD facilities and equipment requests
FDNY	CS	Other FDNY facilities and equipment requests

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
NYPD	1 / 2	Other NYPD staff resources requests
NYPD	2 / 2	Other NYPD programs requests

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Most Important Issue Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

Preparedness for extreme weather events (incl. coastal flooding, heat waves, cold snaps, heavy wind and rain)

Resiliency and preparing for the impacts of long-term climate change are of the utmost importance not just to the shoreline of the Brooklyn Community Board 6 but also to the health and vitality of New York City and the country as a whole.

Theme 2: Climate Resilience

With over 6,000 dwelling units in the 100-year floodplain in Brooklyn Community District 6, thousands of district residents live with a 1% chance of experiencing a major disaster every year.

In 2012, Hurricane Sandy laid bare the reality that the most vulnerable New Yorkers are disproportionately hurt in major coastal flooding events. For instance, the storm caused significant damage to NYCHA's Red Hook Houses and even 12 years later, plans to recover and flood-proof the complex are yet to be completed.

More recently, Hurricane Ida and Tropical Storm Ophelia revealed the extent to which climate change vulnerabilities impact coastal and upland neighborhoods alike; low-lying areas such as Fourth Avenue experience more and more severe flooding during sudden, heavy downpours known as cloudburst events. NYC Stormwater Flood Maps published by the Mayor's Office of Climate and Environmental Justice show that rainfall of 1.77 inches per hour is likely to result in flooding of over one foot in several areas of the district, including 4th Avenue from 1st Street to President Street.

Additionally, New Yorkers observed historically low levels of rainfall and a higher incidence of wildfires in 2024, suggesting a need for greater drought resilience in the City's watershed and water infrastructure. Preparing for the impacts of climate change is of the utmost importance to the district. Investing in green infrastructure is critical to making our communities less vulnerable to climate risk and environmental hazards. To address these rising concerns, the neighborhoods within the district need proactive investment in climate resilience measures, especially in the climate vulnerable communities of Red Hook and Gowanus.

Top priorities include:

3 NYC Mayor's Office of Climate and Environmental Justice. Extreme Rainfall/NYC Stormwater Flood Maps.

<https://climate.cityofnewyork.us/challenges/extreme-rainfall/>

2 According to FEMA's 2015 Preliminary Flood Insurance Rate Maps (PFIRM) and the FEMA 2007 Flood Insurance Rate Maps (FIRM).

- Implementing coastal mitigation measures to protect against flooding and storm surge, including building retrofits, seawalls, breakwaters, and soft shoreline stabilization techniques.
- Expanding and designing urban greenery and permeable surfaces to absorb stormwater, reduce the urban heat island effect, and resist the effects of drought
- Installing gray infrastructure such as sewer pipes and underground storage tanks to minimize damage to property and infrastructure during cloudburst events and increase local drought resilience, and modernizing sewer infrastructure to accommodate heavy rain and flooding
- Protecting electric infrastructure and expanding local power generation with solar and energy storage systems to protect residents from power outages
- Strengthening social services and emergency preparedness to help residents prepare for and cope with flooding, heat waves, droughts, wildfires, and cold snaps.

Several of these interventions are included in the Red Hook Coastal Resiliency project – a local coastal protection project that seeks to reduce flood risks due to coastal storm surge and sea level rise along Red Hook's waterfront. Similarly, the Department of Environmental Protection is currently working on sewer system upgrades associated with the Gowanus rezoning in 2021. These and other city-backed funding and initiatives will help the district adapt to climate challenges; foster a greener urban environment; and safeguard both infrastructure and residents.

Community District Needs Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

Needs for Water, Sewers, and Environmental Protection

Many sections of the BKCB-6 map are low-lying and experience frequent flooding during heavy rains and storms. This is especially true in Gowanus and Red Hook, neighborhoods.

Needs for Sanitation Services

Schools and institutions should be provided with more regular sanitation services such as garbage and recycling pick-up, and DSNY should work with these institutions on placement of containerized storage for waste. With plans to make the Gowanus neighborhood much more residential, DSNY needs to be prepared to offer more and better litter basket collection to the neighborhood.

CORE INFRASTRUCTURE, CITY SERVICES AND RESILIENCY

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DSNY	1 / 1	Provide new or upgrade existing sanitation garages or other sanitation infrastructure
DEP	CS	Other capital budget request for DEP

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DSNY	1 / 1	Provide more frequent garbage or recycling pick-up for schools and institutions

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Most Important Issue Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

Affordable housing creation

Brooklyn Community District 6 (CD6) is a high-opportunity district, featuring destination parks, excellent schools and hospitals, access to cultural institutions, dense transit access, and some of the City's greatest restaurants—but it has also been decreasing in socioeconomic and racial diversity in recent decades

2. CD6 is now one of the wealthiest, whitest, and oldest districts in the City. In order to increase opportunities for more New Yorkers to access the district where we love to live, we must address housing of all typologies: affordable, market-rate, temporary, and shelter. According to the Office of the Brooklyn Borough President, CD6 is below its targets for density in areas suitable for more housing, relative to most Brooklyn neighborhoods.

3 Patterns of housing addition and loss throughout the district are spatially uneven, largely due to policies like restrictive zoning and historic district regulations which constrain development potential in certain areas. Upzoning formerly industrial corridors and neighborhoods such as Fourth Ave (rezoned in 2003 and 2011 and included in the 2021 Gowanus Rezoning) has led to net district housing gains since 2003. However, in the upland, brownstone neighborhoods (Park Slope, Carroll Gardens, Cobble Hill), housing units have been lost to alterations (such as townhouse unit consolidation and apartment combinations) at an astonishing rate: CD6 has the highest unit loss in Brooklyn and the fourth highest citywide (after Manhattan Community Districts 2, 7, and 8), with 1,500 units lost to consolidations from 2010–2024.

4 For every three units gained through new development in that period, one unit was lost to alteration: a net gain overall that is nonetheless a counterproductive dynamic in New York City's housing crisis. Creation of new units in upzoned regions cannot and should not make up for simultaneous losses in the highest opportunity neighborhoods within the district. In addition, recent federal funding cuts may worsen all of the different housing needs in the city and in our community, particularly in the creation and preservation of affordable housing. Cuts to Section 8 and Section 9 within the most recently passed federal budget leave our neighbors in public housing at acute risk.

Brooklyn Community Board 6 (BKCB6) believes that improving our housing supply across typologies is essential to ensuring stability, health, security, and economic opportunity for all residents. A coordinated response that prioritizes each of the following housing categories is essential to meeting CD6's diverse needs:

1. Affordable Housing: The district has a significant gap in affordable housing options for both rent and ownership. This broadly burdens all low- and moderate-income households who currently or wish to

2 Rebecca Kobert, "Middle Housing Gone Missing: Mediations of Neighborhood Change in Brooklyn Community District 6, 2003–2024" (Pratt Institute, MS Urban and Community Planning Thesis, 2025). https://drive.google.com/file/d/1iShSgdiHgBCc0gghuDicUdfGnrd0hZ_v/viewusp=drivelink._

3 Antonio Reynoso, Comprehensive Plan for Brooklyn, 2025.
https://www.brooklynbp.nyc.gov/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/The_ComprehensivePlan___Brooklyn___spreads-compressed-1.pdf.

4 Kobert, "Middle Housing Gone Missing." for 2025 22. 3. 4. live in CD6, driving displacement and removing tenant negotiating power. BKCB6 is particularly concerned for New York's lowest-income residents, or those earning less than 40% of the Area Median Income (AMI). Rising rents and limited availability of affordable units (naturally affordable, temporarily affordable, and permanently affordable) have displaced long-term residents and left about 35 percent of households rent-burdened (spending 30 percent or more of their gross household income in rent).

5 While citywide this figure is a staggering 50 percent, rent burden is concentrated most heavily in our district's lower income communities rather in the more expensive, but affluent, neighborhoods and census tracts. Additionally, given the aging population, investments in affordable senior housing within the district are needed. We must think creatively about how to improve housing supply that is affordable for low-income families, and addresses diverse local and regional needs. This is critical to sustaining the diverse, mixed-income population that CD6 is at risk of further losing. Market Rate Housing: Beyond affordable housing, CD6 needs more responsibly developed market-rate housing, the current supply of which is presently among the most expensive in New York due to low vacancy rates and high demand. Targeted zoning and incentives such as those included in the City of Yes Housing Opportunity, which BKCB6 supported for approval, in addition to recently passed charter revisions, such as 2025 Ballot Proposal #3 to fast track modest affordable housing additions (relevant to the built environment of much of CD6), can create a wider range of options for market-rate and missing middle housing throughout the district. Without such intervention, we risk further displacing long-term residents—renters and owners alike—and harming our district's socioeconomic diversity.

Temporary Housing: Access to temporary housing solutions, including supportive housing, is essential for residents facing short-term displacement or those transitioning from shelters. The district needs more housing options that offer stability and supportive services to help individuals regain access to permanent housing. Investment in these resources can prevent homelessness and support people in crisis.

Shelter Housing & Other Housing: The district requires expanded shelter facilities that provide not only safe space but also access to essential services such as healthcare, employment assistance, and mental health resources. Existing shelters are often at capacity, leading to unmet needs for vulnerable populations, including families, seniors, school children, and individuals with disabilities. Ensuring shelters are adequately funded and well-equipped is essential to meeting the immediate needs of these populations. Furthermore, we continue to urge the Department of Housing Preservation and Development to allocate for the FY2027 budget sufficient funds for the planning, site selection/acquisition, development, and construction of affordable senior housing and special needs households in the most needed sections of our district. By addressing the critical gaps in affordable, market-rate, temporary, and shelter housing, the city can create a more inclusive, stable, economically resilient community. We recommend prioritizing these housing needs in the City's budget process to ensure the district can effectively serve its residents and reduce housing insecurity. We urge that City agencies create a comprehensive strategy to alleviate and address critical housing needs to improve the quality of life for all residents in the district.

Community District Needs Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

Needs for Land Use

Brooklyn Community District 6 faces a critical housing shortage that spans affordable, market-rate, temporary, and shelter housing. Addressing these needs is essential to ensuring stability, security and economic opportunity for all residents.

- **Affordable Housing:** The district has a significant gap in affordable housing options, particularly for low- and moderate-income residents. Rising rents and limited availability of affordable units have displaced long-term residents and left many households rent-burden (27.7% of the district's population spend 35% or more of their income in rent). Expanding affordable housing options, both in terms of rental and ownership opportunities, is critical to sustaining the diverse, mixed-income population that defines this community.
- **Market-Rate Housing:** There is demand for responsibly developed market-rate housing that complements the district's infrastructure and affordability needs. Balancing the growth of market-rate units with affordable housing options is necessary to prevent exacerbating displacement and to support neighborhood diversity. Targeted zoning and incentives such as those included in the City of Yes Housing Opportunities package, which Community Board 6 supported for approval, can help create a balance, ensuring new developments contribute to housing diversity and stability.
- **Temporary Housing:** Access to temporary housing solutions, including supportive housing, is essential for residents facing short-term displacement or those transitioning from shelters. The district needs increased housing options that offer stability and supportive services to help individuals regain permanent housing. American Community Survey 2014–2018 5-Year Estimates for PUMA 4005, which is an approximation of BK CD6. Investment in these resources can prevent homelessness and support residents in crisis.
- **Shelter Housing & Other Housing:** The district requires expanded shelter facilities that provide not only safe space but also access to essential services such as healthcare, employment assistance, and mental health resources. Existing shelters are often at capacity, leading to

unmet needs for vulnerable populations, including families, seniors and individuals with disabilities. Ensuring shelters are adequately funded and well-equipped is essential to meeting the immediate needs of these populations. Furthermore, we continue to urge the Department of Housing Preservation and Development to allocate for the FY's 2026 budget sufficient funds for the planning, site selection/acquisition, development, and construction of affordable senior housing and special needs households in the most needed sections of our district.

A coordinated response that prioritizes each of these housing categories is essential to meeting the diverse needs of Community District 6. By addressing the critical gaps in affordable, market-rate, temporary and shelter housing, the city can create a more inclusive, stable, economically resilient community. We recommend prioritizing these housing needs in the City's budget process to ensure the district can effectively serve its residents and reduce housing insecurity. We urge that City agencies create a comprehensive strategy to alleviate and address critical housing needs to improve the quality of life for all residents in the district.

Needs for Housing

Housing affordability and a sufficient housing supply is crucial to the health of the City. New York City's Housing Plan has not kept pace with housing demand, increased jobs and employment numbers. Recent data, even accounting for Covid, still shows that the housing market is strong and has softened only at the very top margins. CB6 recognizes the current dire need for affordable housing within New York City and that this City can and must do much more to expand affordable housing options that allow more residents to share the positive attributes of the district and help to create a more equitable city. CB6 has urged the City to take strong measures to generate more affordable housing through new construction and regulatory changes in CB6 and city-wide. We would like to see the City maximize the number and affordability levels of new housing development, particularly in any new rezoned areas. CB6 residents should have protections from displacement and cost of living burdens, due to increased property values in new development areas, and district wide. The preservation and enhancement of NYCHA properties is imperative, and the City needs to do all it can to update and maintain NYCHA properties to serve a critical segment of the City's residents.

Needs for Economic Development

There are two facets to Community District 6's economic development needs: Invest in Businesses and Invest in People 1) Invest in Businesses: Small businesses -- including retail and industrial/manufacturing -- need support to be viable. Empty storefronts plague our community - DCP's pre-COVID report, "Assessing Storefront Vacancy in NYC," characterized Park Slope and Cobble Hill in its "medium/high vacancy rate" category, and we have seen newly vacant storefronts increase since COVID. The district is also heavily reliant on restaurants, which makes the district even more vulnerable to closures and occupancy caps due to the pandemic. According to an analysis reported in The Patch in October 2020, "The number of empty storefronts on Park Slope's Fifth Avenue more than doubled this year, bringing its vacancy rate to a decade-long high." (<https://patch.com/new-york/parkslope/coronavirus-crisis-doubles-empty-stores-park-slope-main-street>). We would like to see additional time and energy spent on coming up with solutions

that will enable our commercial strips and neighborhood-serving businesses to be viable. This also means that the City must focus on businesses in manufacturing zones. This has been clearly stated as a priority within the Gowanus rezoning plans, but it also applies to Red Hook's industrial areas, including the IBZ and waterfront businesses. These businesses typically offer better pay than retail, and have more advancement opportunities. The City must invest time and resources in the industrial and manufacturing sector/ 2) Invest in People Residents -- particularly youth and unemployed residents of the NYCHA developments in Red Hook and Gowanus - need employment pathways. Unemployment was already high before the pandemic, and it has gotten worse. Youth have few employment pathways, as the Summer Youth Employment Program was almost eliminated last year, and it has become nearly impossible to obtain internships and entry-level jobs. Youth in NYCHA developments who need opportunities for training, placement, internships, summer employment and career support. NYCHA Red Hook residents are also far from the Workforce 1 site in downtown Brooklyn, necessitating more localized workforce services in Red Hook We continue to want to see expansion of commercial corridor BIDs and increased technical assistance, as the BID model has proven to be a great success and is important during the pandemic (<https://commercialobserver.com/2020/05/in-the-wake-of-covid-19-new-yorks-bids-help-keep-their-neighborhoods-thriving/>). We also would like to see the City be proactive in exploring the formation of an Industrial BID (IBID) or other mechanisms to provide greater support to industrial businesses, including basic services and long-term investments in infrastructure that will support growth in local business districts and access to the districts extensive waterfront. Finally, it is essential to ensure that families have adequate affordable childcare so that parents can obtain and sustain employment.

HOUSING, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND LAND USE

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
EDC	1 / 1	Invest in infrastructure that will support growth in commercial business districts
HPD	1 / 1	Provide more housing for special needs households, such as the formerly homeless
NYCHA	1 / 2	Other public housing upgrades or renovations requests
NYCHA	2 / 2	Renovate or upgrade NYCHA community facilities or open space
SBS	1 / 1	Other capital budget request for SBS
EDC	CS	Invest in capital projects to improve access to waterfront
NYCHA	CS	Renovate or upgrade NYCHA community facilities or open space

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
EDC	1 / 1	Invest in planning for transportation-oriented infrastructure
NYCHA	1 / 1	Other housing support requests
SBS	1 / 4	Other workforce development requests
SBS	2 / 4	Provide or expand occupational skills training programs
SBS	3 / 4	Conduct a commercial district needs assessment
SBS	4 / 4	Other expense budget request for SBS

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Most Important Issue Related to Transportation and Mobility

Other - Write In (Required)

Overall Transportation Infrastructure - Roadway design that will improve pedestrian and cyclist safety are high priorities, including the implementation of curb extensions and high-visibility crosswalks, and enhancement and connection of the bike lane network. Traffic congestion is a problem on many district streets, exacerbated by enormous growth in home delivery of goods, which can be improved with implementation of commercial and residential loading zones and better freight management. A comprehensive traffic study is necessary to address exploding growth in last-mile delivery facilities in Red Hook.

.We urge the City to examine various transportation issues that limit access to services and even exacerbate social and health issues in some neighborhoods. Red Hook's residents, for example, live in a transit desert; yet, vehicle ownership is uncommon among those with lower incomes, and residents cannot easily rely on other modes of transportation. Walking and cycling, in particular, are not as safe or comfortable as they could be for all residents in our district, with rising traffic congestion, high vehicle speeds, a lack of pedestrian safety measures (e.g., daylighting at intersections), and a lack of protected bike lanes. Further, in the primarily industrial neighborhoods of Red Hook and Gowanus, heightened freight activity from local truck routes and last-mile warehouses also reduces air quality, increases noise levels, and exacerbates poor health outcomes. We suggest a comprehensive transportation assessment of our district to address these long-running issues holistically. A comprehensive assessment should address road safety, walkability, and bike infrastructure needs. Any transportation recommendations arising from this assessment should address the need for protected bike lanes, enhanced bike network connections, curb extensions, and high-visibility crosswalks to enhance safety for non-vehicular transportation options while also addressing traffic congestion in the district's commercial and residential areas. The assessment should also address barriers to access in both public transportation and active modes, including considerations for both physical access and affordability. Additionally, the assessment should address the concentrated impact of freight activity in neighborhoods like Red Hook and Gowanus.

Community District Needs Related to Transportation and Mobility

Needs for Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure

Roadway design that will improve pedestrian and cyclist safety are high priorities, including the implementation of curb extensions and high-visibility crosswalks, and enhancement and connection of the bike lane network. Traffic congestion is a problem on many district streets, exacerbated by enormous growth in home delivery of goods, which can be improved with implementation of commercial and residential loading zones and better freight management. A comprehensive traffic study is necessary to address exploding growth in last-mile delivery facilities in Red Hook.

Needs for Transit Services

Subway accessibility is a key issue for residents of CB6, as no stations within the district are currently served by elevators. The district also lacks east-west bus service, and there is widespread support to reactivate and enhance the B71 route, which was discontinued in 2010. The district also suffers from slow bus speeds, and would benefit from implementation of transit-signal priority and other enhancements.

TRANSPORTATION AND MOBILITY

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DOT	1 / 7	Reconstruct streets
DOT	2 / 7	Roadway maintenance (resurfacing, trench restoration, etc.)
DOT	3 / 7	Reconstruct streets
DOT	4 / 7	Other transportation infrastructure requests
DOT	5 / 7	Other transportation infrastructure requests
DOT	6 / 7	Repair or construct sidewalks, curbs, or pedestrian ramps
DOT	7 / 7	Reconstruct streets
NYCTA	1 / 2	Improve accessibility of transit infrastructure, by providing elevators, escalators, etc.
NYCTA	2 / 2	Repair or upgrade subway stations or other transit infrastructure
DOT	CS	Other transportation infrastructure requests
DOT	CS	Other transportation infrastructure requests
DOT	CS	Improve traffic and pedestrian safety, including traffic calming
DOT	CS	Reconstruct streets
DOT	CS	Reconstruct streets
DOT	CS	Rehabilitate bridges
NYCTA	CS	Other transit infrastructure requests

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DOT	1 / 1	Other traffic improvement requests

PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Brooklyn Community Board 6

Most Important Issue Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

Other - Write In (Required)

While the Parks within the District have some needs that fall within any reasonable understanding of the fourteen possible responses provided by the Department of City Planning, we have selected "Other" because foundational issue that undergirds the needs we have in each of these categories is the City's austerity relative to the needs of the community.

Adequate Funding for NYC Parks: Fully fund parks so that they may continue to function as key public spaces and resources for our district. Despite some recent victories, including the introduction of new second shift funding and one shot council funding for Urban Park Rangers, NYC Parks' budget has not been fully restored after the mayor's recent cuts. As a result, the agency has seen a \$20M reduction, and has 800 fewer staff than FY24, plus a hiring freeze and the lowest number of Parks Enforcement Officers in years (300 citywide). Restoring the agency's budget to appropriate levels is a top priority for this Community Board.

- Comprehensive Transportation Planning: Budget for a comprehensive transportation plan to address road safety, walkability, and bike infrastructure needs. The plan should address the need for protected bike lanes, enhanced bike network connections, curb extensions, and high-visibility crosswalks to enhance safety for non-vehicular transportation options. Additionally, the plan should address traffic congestion on district streets, which has been exacerbated by enormous growth in home delivery of goods and which could be improved with implementation of commercial and residential loading zones and better freight management.
- Improved Affordability for Citibike: Budget to expand the Reduced Fare Bike Share program to include public high school and CUNY students aged 16 and above,

Community District Needs Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

Needs for Parks

The Park department has responsibility for maintaining an ever expanding collection of parks and properties including pocket gardens, GreenStreets, Bioswales, and our street trees. They are expected to do this with a much reduced and declining percentage of the NYC budget. They are unable to hire and train permanent staff and must rely on temporary workfare recipients for much of their work. Most of our parks are just barely maintained and shabby compared to the Parks I have seen in Europe. It just comes down to pride of place and proper funding.

Needs for Library Services

Both the Carroll Gardens and Park Slope branches of the Brooklyn Public Library are in need of various capital improvements, and as is the case with all other public buildings in the current state of the COVID-19 pandemic, the ventilation systems in all of the District's library buildings should be reassessed and replaced if need be.

Needs for Community Boards

Community Boards have seen their responsibilities expand rapidly over the last decade, all without any update to their funding or staffing capacity. In just the last few years, District Office staff have been newly tasked with digital timesheet entry and confirmation and learning multiple purchase order and inventory programs, both projects that used to be handled by the Borough President's office. Additionally, District Office staff are now responsible for major digital projects, such as this District Needs and Capital/Expense Budget Priorities. All of this while the Boards themselves will start to lean on the District Office staff more than ever with the advent of Board Member term limits. To say that Community Board funding should be maintained at its current level is an especially gracious understatement.

PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
BPL	1 / 2	Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library
BPL	2 / 2	Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library
DCAS	1 / 1	Renovate, upgrade or provide new community board facilities and equipment
DPR	1 / 2	Reconstruct or upgrade a building in a park
DPR	2 / 2	Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)
DPR	CS	Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DPR	1 / 3	Provide more programs in parks or recreational centers
DPR	2 / 3	Other park maintenance and safety requests
DPR	3 / 3	Other park maintenance and safety requests
OMB	1 / 1	Provide more community board staff

6. OTHER BUDGET REQUESTS

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

7. SUMMARY OF PRIORITIZED BUDGET REQUESTS

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

New York City Transit Authority (NYCTA)

- | | | |
|---|--|--------------|
| 1 of 2 | Improve accessibility of transit infrastructure, by providing elevators, escalators, etc. | NYCTA |
| Improve accessibility of transit infrastructure, by providing elevators, escalators, etc. | | |

Due to the pending increase in population just one block north due to the now approved Gowanus Rezoning, and given that a significant portion of that new population expected to be seniors, sufficient funds are requested for the identification, design, and construction of handicapped access elements, preferably elevators, for the Smith-9th Street subway the station, which happens to be the highest elevated public transit point in the entire world. Despite a recent comprehensive station rehabilitation, escalators at this station are still prone to frequent service disruptions. This station is also the only subway stop nearest to the Red Hook community, a neighborhood woefully under-served by transportation options.

- | | | |
|---|--|--------------|
| 2 of 2 | Repair or upgrade subway stations or other transit infrastructure | NYCTA |
| Repair or upgrade subway stations or other transit infrastructure | | |

Sufficient funding is requested for the design and construction of handicapped access elements, preferably elevators, for the Grand Army Plaza subway station, which is not only an important intermodal transfer within the transit system but also provides primary access to a number of Brooklyn's most visited cultural institutions--such as the Grand Army Plaza, Prospect Park, and the Brooklyn Public Library Central Branch--and is a gateway to the Flatbush Avenue and Park Slope commercial corridors.

- | | | |
|---------------------------------------|--|--------------|
| CS | Other transit infrastructure requests | NYCTA |
| Other transit infrastructure requests | | |

Sufficient funds are requested for the installation of cellular/Wi-Fi service in subways systems as a way of improving public safety by increasing channels of communication between riders and emergency service providers in the event that emergency assistance is needed.

Health and Hospitals Corporation (HHC)

- | | | |
|--|---|------------|
| 1 of 1 | Provide a new or expanded health care facility | HHC |
| Provide a new or expanded health care facility | | |

Funds are requested for the opening of a more permanent indoor Red Hook COVID testing and vaccination location. This could be resolved by reopening the H+H location at Red Hook Recreation Center. While we hope COVID-19 will continue to decrease, variants and waves show that flexibility is essential in order to reach high-need areas as surges happen and positivity rates change. The existing mobile vans are often absent or out of commission and there is no way to schedule a test nor call the van to check if it is there on a given day. For residents with disabilities, that means a potentially perilous walk in the cold or snow to see whether the van there. CB6 does not have an H+H facility and thus lacks access to rapid point-of-care testing.

Department of Small Business Services (SBS)

- | | | |
|--------------------------------------|---|------------|
| 1 of 1 | Other capital budget request for SBS | SBS |
| Other capital budget request for SBS | | |

Sufficient funds are requested for the acquisition (if necessary), design and construction of a Red Hook workforce development center. Red Hook has seen the creation of hundreds of new jobs in the last few years from large-scale retail development, introduction of tourism-related industries, and induced commercial development. Its residential population is in need of a local job center where employment training, recruiting and referral services can be offered in addition to courses that promote local entrepreneurship, and generally support the development of the local workforce preparing them for jobs. Because of its geographic isolation and transportation hurdles, Red Hook residents cannot easily access services in Downtown Brooklyn.

New York City Housing Authority (NYCHA)

1 of 2 Other public housing upgrades or renovations requests**NYCHA**

Other public housing upgrades or renovations requests

Funds are requested to eliminate mold and other infrastructure problems in NYCHA buildings in CB6. NYCHA buildings in Red Hook were built in the 1930s and have had dangerous mold and infrastructure problems for years, which are only increasing with climate change. While we understand NYCHA is operating without the full funding it deserves, we want to reinforce that the declining quality of NYCHA housing in our district is threatening the health of our community members, adding extra respiratory risk to the most COVID-vulnerable among us who live in high-density housing.

2 of 2 Renovate or upgrade NYCHA community facilities or open space**NYCHA**

Renovate or upgrade NYCHA community facilities or open space

Funds are requested to improve outdoor public space and mitigate urban heat island effects at Red Hook Houses to compensate for the 457 trees, 14 water sprinkler systems and many community spaces eliminated as part of FEMA construction work. The heat generated by these removals has created dangerous health conditions for residents, especially young children and older residents. Specific remediation should be determined in consultation with residents but this may include replanting trees, installing new benches, soil testing and drainage study, and/or new outdoor recreation facilities.

CS Renovate or upgrade NYCHA community facilities or open space**NYCHA**

Renovate or upgrade NYCHA community facilities or open space

Sufficient funds are requested for a redesign and rehabilitation of the existing Wyckoff Gardens Community Center to allow for a more efficient and effective use of the space. Modernization should include but not be limited to such items as improved security system, new lighting/electrical systems, HVAC/plumbing upgrades, painting and masonry. A solar energy system should also be added to the rooftop as a sustainability and resiliency measure to enable the center to remain powered in the event of electrical grid disruption or failure.

Department of Parks and Recreation (DPR)**1 of 2 Reconstruct or upgrade a building in a park****DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a building in a park

Sufficient funds are requested for a comprehensive facility rehabilitation project for the Red Hook Recreation Center. Scope of work to include at a minimum upgraded programming space for users, office space for department personnel (i.e., painting, electrical, windows, lighting, etc.), perimeter improvements and outfitting with new recreation and office equipment to support both users and staff. It is essential that increasing demands for local recreational opportunities be met within the neighborhood as transportation options available within the neighborhood limit the extent to which local residents can take advantage of facilities in other neighborhoods.

2 of 2 Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)**DPR**

Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

Sufficient funds are requested for the design and construction of a new park--Columbia Waterfront Park--on the City-owned properties along the westside of Columbia Street between Kane and Degraw Streets. These properties are currently in the Department of Transportation's portfolio but they have agreed to release them for the development of a future park to be built there. Much work has already gone into conceptualizing a park use of the space which, with an adequate budget, can be easily adapted into designs and construction plans.

CS Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)**DPR**

Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

Sufficient funds are requested to undertake a series of Capital improvements to Prospect Park including, but not limited to: Lakeside Project (\$9 mil additional), Long Meadow ball fields (\$1.2 mil), lighting at Grand Army Plaza and the arch at Grand Army Plaza, and a continuation of traffic improvements at the Grand Army Plaza circle.

Brooklyn Public Library (BPL)

1 of 2 Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library**BPL**

Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library

A total of \$6.35M is requested for infrastructure upgrades to the Carroll Gardens branch library, to specifically include exterior renovation and windows (\$1.0M), new boiler (\$750k), interior renovation (\$3.0M), new furniture & equipment (\$750k), and safety and security enhancements (\$250k). The Carroll Gardens branch is an unrenovated, heavily-utilized Carnegie branch. The building's critical infrastructure needs to be upgraded.

2 of 2 Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library**BPL**

Create a new, or renovate or upgrade an existing public library

Funds in the amount of \$3.0M are requested for the design and construction of roof and restoration of skylights (\$1.0M) and exterior renovations (\$2.0M) for the Park Slope branch library. The Park Slope library was recently reopened after an extensive interior renovation. This heavily-utilized branch and beloved community institution is one of the three landmarked Carnegie branches in the BPL system. A total exterior renovation would include brick work, refurbished wrought-iron fencing, stonework/repair of concrete entrance stairs, improved signage, landscaping, and sidewalk repair work.

Department of Citywide Administrative Services (DCAS)**1 of 1 Renovate, upgrade or provide new community board facilities and equipment****DCAS**

Renovate, upgrade or provide new community board facilities and equipment

Sufficient funds are requested for the design and construction of a window replacement project for 250 Baltic Street in the Cobble Hill Historic District. This 1936 building still has the original single-paned and uninsulated windows making them highly inefficient energy-wasting devices which negatively contribute to the building tenants' comfort and safety. Modern, energy-efficient windows appropriately designed to area's historic district would go a long way toward reducing heating and cooling costs, improving safety, and creating a vastly improved work environment for the State, City and non-profit entities that occupy the space in this City-owned building. While the City-State have talked about changing ownership status of this building for more than a decade, it will crumble

Department of Transportation (DOT)**1 of 7 Reconstruct streets****DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Sufficient funds are requested for the reconstruction of Court Street from Atlantic to Hamilton Avenues with historic amenities. Preliminary Design Investigation to ascertain the condition of the infrastructure along the project limits. Relocate all utility service boxes below ground, repair/replace missing curb sections, reset curb elevations, repair concrete bus pads and repair defective sidewalk conditions. Use granite curb, bluestone or pigmented concrete sidewalks, historic replica street hardware including street lights, poles-in-ground, fire alarm boxes and hydrants. Also, the inclusion of appropriate traffic calming devices such as, but not limited to, neck downs, bus bulbs, etc. as called for in the Downtown Brooklyn Traffic Calming project.

2 of 7 Roadway maintenance (resurfacing, trench restoration, etc.)**DOT**

Roadway maintenance (resurfacing, trench restoration, etc.)

Sufficient funds should be allocated toward the inclusion of special treatment street resurfacing work in the department's development of future contract work to incorporate the restoration, preservation and maintenance of cobblestone streets. This construction material serves as a traffic calming device, is far more durable than commonly used asphalt material, is a signature characteristic of streets in our Red Hook community and enhances the historic integrity of the community.

3 of 7 Reconstruct streets**DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Sufficient funds are requested to remediate the problems associated with the Brooklyn-Queens Expressway Trench running through our district parallel to Hicks Street. The BQE Trench inhibits local access and mobility between the Columbia Waterfront, Carroll Gardens and Cobble Hill neighborhoods. The concentration of traffic flowing through the trench creates vibrations, noise, odors and other air emissions that impact the residential communities adjacent to the trench. The trench provides opportunities to create new open space and expand resiliency measures (photovoltaics, storm water capture/diversion, etc.). Building on the momentum of a prior study's findings, remedies and opportunities must now be considered, funded and constructed.

4 of 7 Other transportation infrastructure requests**DOT**

Other transportation infrastructure requests

Sufficient funds are requested for the construction of traffic safety median islands in the Furman-Atlantic-Columbia transition area, the approach to Brooklyn Bridge Park's Pier 6 public park, and area growing in popularity and increasingly traveled by pedestrians and recreation users. Prior to the opening of Pier 6, this area was generally unused by pedestrians and was almost exclusively a southbound route used by commuters seeking to avoid the Brooklyn-Queens Expressway. Now, with the opening of Pier 6 and the two-way conversion of Furman Street, vehicular and pedestrian traffic patterns have completely altered the use and complexion of this bustling area. Immediate in-house improvements have done a lot to improve safety, at the cost of aesthetics.

5 of 7 Other transportation infrastructure requests**DOT**

Other transportation infrastructure requests

Sufficient funds are requested to undertake a replacement of the existing standard-issue cobra head street lights with appropriate historic replica street lights in the neighborhoods of Cobble Hill and Carroll Gardens. Currently, only Atlantic Avenue, Clinton Street and Smith Street in these neighborhoods have such amenities. The balance of the neighborhood's street lights should be replaced to enhance and restore the historic integrity of these landmark districts and historically-sensitive areas.

6 of 7 Repair or construct sidewalks, curbs, or pedestrian ramps**DOT**

Repair or construct sidewalks, curbs, or pedestrian ramps

In addition to the regular cement sidewalk replacement activity, we request that the department broaden its scope to include the option of restoring by contract those sidewalks which include special treatments, notably bluestone material. Not only is bluestone a more durable material with significantly longer life expectancy, it also serves to enhance the historic integrity and value of the community. Many property owners are willing to pay the extra cost to have this option, especially given the City's ability to leverage lower cost through bulk contracting.

7 of 7 Reconstruct streets**DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Sufficient funds are requested for the acquisition, mapping, design and construction of a new City street which would extend Conover Street northward from Pioneer Street to Hamilton Avenue in Red Hook. This new street will not only provide additional capacity to handle the new traffic volumes destined for the cruise ship terminal under construction at Pier 12, but will also provide an alternative for the relocation of the Van Brunt Street leg of the City's local Truck Route network in Red Hook. It will ensure that the local street grid is not only not negatively impacted by the cruise terminal traffic but that it will benefit from relieving Van Brunt Street of trucks and removing the existing conflict by directing trucks closer to the industrial section of the neighborhood.

CS Other transportation infrastructure requests**DOT**

Other transportation infrastructure requests

Sufficient funds are requested to fully fund project #SEK20068 for preliminary design investigations, final design and ultimate repair of the 9th Street and Second Avenue corridors abutting the Gowanus Canal. Issues that need to be addressed include negative and insufficient curbs that have resulted in flooding and drainage problems, defective and missing sidewalks and episodic infrastructure failures on 2nd Ave. Frequent and substantial roadway ponding occurs along 9th Street--a mapped Coastal Evacuation Route--which, coupled with new and growing demands in pedestrian and vehicular traffic, requires that the street be a more reliable emergency traffic conveyor and able to withstand rainfall events without

CS Other transportation infrastructure requests**DOT**

Other transportation infrastructure requests

Sufficient funds are requested to fully fund project #SEK20068 for preliminary design investigations, final design and ultimate repair of the 9th Street and Second Avenue corridors abutting the Gowanus Canal. Issues that need to be addressed include negative and insufficient curbs that have resulted in flooding and drainage problems, defective and missing sidewalks and episodic infrastructure failures on 2nd Ave. Frequent and substantial roadway ponding occurs along 9th Street--a mapped Coastal Evacuation Route--which, coupled with new and growing demands in pedestrian and vehicular traffic, requires that the street be a more reliable emergency traffic conveyor and able to withstand rainfall events without

CS Improve traffic and pedestrian safety, including traffic calming**DOT**

Improve traffic and pedestrian safety, including traffic calming

In conjunction with the city's infrastructure work being planned under HWK700B, sufficient funds are requested to undertake the design investigation and construction of appropriate amenities and traffic calming devices to facilitate the safe movement of pedestrians and traffic. Such amenities could include, but not be limited to, the reintroduction of cobblestone treatments, historic lighting, granite curbs, etc. The scope of the existing street reconstruction project should be expanded to include a full electrical upgrade for all of Red Hook with the goal of burying the vulnerable, above-ground electrical lines and ensuring that the grid is modern and able to withstand future events like Hurricane Sandy which plunged the area into darkness for months.

CS Reconstruct streets**DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Sufficient funds are requested for the design and construction of new traffic medians on 4th Avenue between Pacific Street and 8th Streets that would improve pedestrian and vehicular safety along this busy traffic corridor. New medians would include protected pedestrian refuge areas and raised, planted medians with irrigation systems, that would prevent unsafe and unpredictable pedestrian behavior which occurs frequently and is likely a contributing cause to high accident rates along the corridor.

CS Reconstruct streets**DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Funds in the amount of \$26,300,000 are requested to undertake a reconstruction of the Union Street Bridge (HBK1213), a double-leaf Scherzer Bascule bridge which spans the Gowanus Canal. This bridge received a FAIR rating yet is one of the few east-west connectors that provide access and mobility throughout our district. It is a vital corridor that links our waterfront to inland points. Deferred public investment increases the vulnerability of this structure as unanticipated structural failures may occur, resulting in increased cost and time of repair and unwarranted impacts on the surrounding community. We would also like a modified riding surface for the bicycle lane section of the bridge to make it safer and more comfortable for the cyclists who use this segment of the network.

CS Rehabilitate bridges**DOT**

Rehabilitate bridges

Sufficient funds are requested for a full rehabilitation of the 3rd Street Bridge (HBKC068), a double-leaf Bascule Bridge spanning the Gowanus Canal, to improve long-term viability of the structure. For the sake of access and mobility through the district, there are only a handful of east-west connectors that span the Gowanus Canal, on which the community is wholly reliant. Deferred investment increases the likelihood of structural failures, more costly repairs, and longer periods of disruption and inconvenience to the community when the bridge is out of service. We would also like a modified riding surface for the bicycle lane section of the bridge to make it safer and more comfortable for the cyclists who use this segment of the network.

School Construction Authority**1 of 2 Provide a new or expand an existing middle/intermediate school****SCA**

Provide a new or expand an existing middle/intermediate school

Sufficient funds are requested for the design and construction of a soundproofing project at the PS 321 gymnasium at 180 7th Avenue in Park Slope. The poor acoustics in the gymnasium prevents it from being effectively used a multi-purpose space in a school that is historically crowded and in need of additional space. A relatively small project to soundproof the gymnasium would enhance school space utilization, making it more suitable for a wider variety of uses.

2 of 2 Renovate other site component**SCA**

Renovate other site component

Funds in the amount of at least \$150,000 are requested for the design and construction of a soundproofing project at the PS 39 cafeteria at 417 6th Avenue in Park Slope. The tiny cave-like basement cafeteria is the largest open space in the school. The low tin roof and cement walls do little to absorb the loud whir of giant freezers or the noise of the fans used to cool the space due to the lack of air conditioning and window space. When you add more than 350 students during lunchtime the sounds reverberate around the room. The noise drowns out any conversations happening at the tables. By adding wall & ceiling mounted sound panels, extraneous noise will be lessened to manageable levels.

Housing Preservation and Development (HPD)

1 of 1	Provide more housing for special needs households, such as the formerly homeless	HPD
Provide more housing for special needs households, such as the formerly homeless		

Sufficient funds are requested for the planning, site selection/acquisition, development and construction of affordable senior housing in the Carroll Gardens section of our district.

New York Police Department (NYPD)

1 of 2	Other NYPD facilities and equipment requests	NYPD
Other NYPD facilities and equipment requests		

Sufficient funds are requested for the acquisition of radar speed signs to provide advisories to motorists in areas where speeding is suspected or confirmed. Radar Speed Signs can provide a constant monitoring presence to help raise awareness and act as a potential deterrent. Compliance with the City's new 25MPH speed limit relies on an enforcement presence which, at best, can be challenging given limitations of manpower and competing deployment priorities; to some degree these signs can help augment these limitations.

2 of 2	Other NYPD facilities and equipment requests	NYPD
Other NYPD facilities and equipment requests		

Sufficient funds are requested for the acquisition and deployment of Variable Message Boards (VMBs), at least one per precinct, to be used to advise the public of upcoming street closures, events, alerts and other vital information that would enhance public safety and preparedness. The strategic placement of VMBs can provide important directions, reduce traffic congestion, and otherwise assist NYPD in messaging information to the public. Precinct Commanders should have the flexibility to deploy VMBs as needed and in response to ongoing changing conditions within the precinct.

Economic Development Corporation (EDC)

1 of 1	Invest in infrastructure that will support growth in commercial business districts	EDC
Invest in infrastructure that will support growth in commercial business districts		

Sufficient funds are requested for the planning and construction of a cross harbor freight tunnel to link New York and New Jersey by rail to 1) provide for the efficient movement of bulk goods through the region, 2) reduce the amount of truck traffic with its corresponding impacts on traffic volumes, air quality, public safety, etc., and 3) expand opportunities for economic growth in the region. Transportation is one of the most significant obstacles to growth in the region, as our bridges, tunnels and highways experience on a daily basis. Without taking advantage of the area's features - its waterfront and untapped rail potential - further economic growth in the region is threatened. Replacing truck use by rail and barge options should be our top priority. (REQUEST IS FOR PANYNJ!)

CS	Invest in capital projects to improve access to waterfront	EDC
Invest in capital projects to improve access to waterfront		

Sufficient funds are requested for the design and construction of a maritime cultural use at the Atlantic Basin, as we previously suggested, discussed and promised by EDC during and since the development of their Piers 6-12 study for the Brooklyn Waterfront. Many years have lapsed since the study, yet there is no cultural use in place despite the agency's commitments to the community. Funds are needed to provide suitable docking facilities, upland connections and necessary infrastructure (electrical, water, sewage, etc.) to support such a use.

Department of Sanitation (DSNY)

1 of 1	Provide new or upgrade existing sanitation garages or other sanitation infrastructure	DSNY
Provide new or upgrade existing sanitation garages or other sanitation infrastructure		

Sufficient funds are requested for the relocation of BK2 District Sanitation Garage and Broom Garage into the Community Board 2 district to comply with coterminality requirements of the Charter. In the interim, we encourage the department to explore alternatives at the current garage location at 127 2nd Avenue including the reconstruction of the existing garage (addition of a story?) to fully accommodate all fleet vehicles and equipment off the street and sidewalk and under one roof.

Fire Department of New York (FDNY)

CS Other FDNY facilities and equipment requests**FDNY**

Other FDNY facilities and equipment requests

Sufficient funds are requested to equip every firehouse with an emergency generator to ensure continuous electrical supply. Firehouses serve as cooling stations during heat emergencies and, in general, serve the public as a critical local public safety facility for emergency and medical services. Maintaining electrical supply is essential both from an operational standpoint and to maintain a high degree of public confidence in the department's ability to provide a safe haven during times of crisis. We lost service to one of our firehouses in Red Hook during Hurricane Sandy, and would suggest that this site become an immediate priority.

Department of Environmental Protection (DEP)**CS Other capital budget request for DEP****DEP**

Other capital budget request for DEP

DEP: Sufficient funds are requested for the area wide installation of green infrastructure including, but not limited to, bioswales, offline retention capacities, rain barrels, pervious surface treatments, and other best management practices, to aggressively prevent storm water from entering into the sewer system. Reduction of storm water entry into the system is necessary to reduce the amount of Combined Sewer Overflow events that occur, particularly within the Gowanus watershed area.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS**Department of Education (DOE)****1 of 2 Assign more non-teaching staff, e.g., to provide social, health and other services****DOE**

Assign more non-teaching staff, e.g., to provide social, health and other services

Funds are requested to expand access to free and low-cost day care services within CB6. There are only 3 child care facilities that take city vouchers within CB6. This is a critical economic issue: parents without access to affordable, high-quality, accessible day care for their children cannot work. Funding should increase the number of child care facilities in CB6 that accept vouchers, increase the amount of the vouchers, and make vouchers or other city-funded daycare options available to more residents.

2 of 2 Provide, expand, or enhance funding for Child Care and Head Start programs**DOE**

Provide, expand, or enhance funding for Child Care and Head Start programs

Conduct an assessment of alternatives to expand publicly funded early childhood programs in the Gowanus neighborhood: The EIS reports that rezoning would result in a significant adverse impact on publicly funded early childhood programs. As stated, "With the Proposed Actions, child care facilities would operate over capacity by approximately 1,700 slots and exhibit an increase in the utilization rate of approximately 25 percentage points over the No Action condition. Possible mitigation measures for this significant adverse impact may include provision of suitable space in projected developments for early childhood programs, provision of suitable locations within the study area that are also within a reasonable distance (at a rate affordable to NYC DOC providers).

Department for the Aging (DFTA)**1 of 1 Funding for a new senior center program****DFTA**

Funding for a new senior center program

Sufficient funding is requested to increase baseline operating budget allocations in existing senior centers. At a minimum, additional funding is sought to help keep pace with cost of living increases which over time take more and more resources away from the base operating budgets from programming and salary monies. Effectively, by not providing for regular, modest increases the senior centers' budgets are being decreased over time as basic costs only go up. This need is especially pressing with an aging population, as more and more "baby boomers" will be placing increasing demands on these facilities, which is anticipated to increase in the near future.

Department of Small Business Services (SBS)

1 of 4 Other workforce development requests**SBS**

Other workforce development requests

Fund workforce development and training in Gowanus and Red Hook: The City must aggressively address unemployment levels in Red Hook and Gowanus, which are disproportionately high - not just relative the district overall, but to other neighborhoods in the City. For example, In Red Hook Houses, based on the most recently available income data for the census tract, 47% of residents live below the federal poverty line, and 31% of residents over 25 years old are unemployed. Residents of the Gowanus neighborhood - and particularly Gowanus Houses - also suffer from significant economic, educational and health disparities and historic City and Federal underinvestment that is manifested in housing quality and conditions.

2 of 4 Provide or expand occupational skills training programs**SBS**

Provide or expand occupational skills training programs

Funds are requested to increase the capacity of NYCHA direct-entry union training programs. Membership in a union is a prerequisite for NYCHA residents to participate in the city's new community hiring program. The current program is extremely successful but its capacity is only 100 residents. Building extra capacity would unlock the life-changing benefits of this program for CB6 NYCHA residents.

3 of 4 Conduct a commercial district needs assessment**SBS**

Conduct a commercial district needs assessment

Undertake a Commercial District Needs Assessment on the District's main shopping corridors:. According to the DCP, "retail corridors subject to multiple cross-currents that influence retail mix and vacancy. These include the rise of ecommerce, demographic shifts, real estate market trends, local building stock, and other conditions that may vary from street to street. A deeper dive into local trends is needed to understand vacancy conditions. Many factors influence storefront use trends, and monitoring conditions can aid the development of effective policies. "" An October 2020 assessment in Patch reported that the : "Coronavirus crisis doubled empty stores on Park Slope's Fifth Avenue.

4 of 4 Other expense budget request for SBS**SBS**

Other expense budget request for SBS

SBS: Sufficient funds are requested to support existing and enable additional groups to embark on feasibility studies and supportive planning activities to move toward the formation of additional Business Improvement Districts (BID) in appropriate commercial and industrial areas. BIDs are proven to be an asset for the City insofar as they provide needed administrative infrastructure designed to support local commerce at the neighborhood level. Furthermore, the expansion of BIDs from the traditional commercial into the industrial sector will enable the City to better protect the fragile manufacturing sector, which often produces higher wage paying jobs, with specialty skills, and reduces the cost of goods in the City by making us less reliant on imports.

Office of Management and Budget (OMB)**1 of 1 Provide more community board staff****OMB**

Provide more community board staff

Funding in the amount of \$450,000 is requested in order for Community Boards to fulfill their Charter mandated roles to plan and advocate for neighborhood needs. An increase in funds will be used to fund the hiring of a full-time urban planner, to keep pace with cost of living adjustments which have never been applied to Community Boards, to upgrade complaint systems software which was previously supplied and supported by prior Administrations and to expand District Office functionality with the purchase of additional equipment and supplies. Increases to budget due to collective bargaining agreements and maintaining the budget at its current level do not address this request; both are effectively negative responses which should trigger a separate letter explaining the agency's position.

Economic Development Corporation (EDC)

1 of 1 Invest in planning for transportation-oriented infrastructure**EDC**

Invest in planning for transportation-oriented infrastructure

The public and private shoreline infrastructure along the industrial waterfront is aging and needs investment. This is particularly urgent because the City must require or encourage last-mile distribution warehouses to increase the use of water-borne delivery. This will require capital investment, but will also include expenses for non-infrastructure changes. This is not a new need, but has become more urgent as the new last-mile distribution warehouses will increase trucking through the neighborhood, with concomitant traffic safety, road wear, and environmental pollution. According to DCP's Comprehensive Waterfront Plan, "with advancements in the manufacturing, freight, and energy sectors, our city's waterfront industrial zones will remain important, multi-faceted hubs.

Department of Health and Mental Hygiene (DOHMH)**1 of 4 Other programs to address public health issues requests****DOHMH**

Other programs to address public health issues requests

Expand health programs in Red Hook to address needs identified in the Red Hook Community Health Needs and Assets Assessment (CHNAA). The CHNAA was conducted with support from the NYU Langone Health Community Service Plan. The assessment was planned by a team of six organizations: The Alex House Project, Family Health Centers at NYU Langone, Good Shepherd Services, NYU Langone Health Department of Population Health, Red Hook Community Justice Center, and the Red Hook Initiative. According to surveys, focus groups, and data research, top issues are asthma, mental health and diabetes

2 of 4 Other programs to address public health issues requests**DOHMH**

Other programs to address public health issues requests

Conduct narrowly targeted community health assessments in low-income sections of the district, rather than rely solely on district-wide data. The district's data (health, economic, social, and population health related) is based on the district as a whole (or in some cases at the zip code level); unfortunately, as a whole, the district has excellent health. However, this masks the inequities in specific communities within the district. The Community Health Needs and Assets study by NYU Langone and Red Hook community partners identified high rates and concerns about asthma, diabetes and heart disease.

3 of 4 Animal and pest control requests including reducing rat and mosquito populations**DOHMH**

Animal and pest control requests including reducing rat and mosquito populations

Sufficient funds are requested for the hire of additional Health/Pest Control Inspectors for initial field evaluations and compliance inspections. At least one inspector per Community Board ought to be assigned to eliminate bottlenecks in Pest Control servicing, ensure that annual inspections of Health- Licensed facilities can occur, improve agency's productivity and reduce response times for complaint investigation.

4 of 4 Other programs to address public health issues requests**DOHMH**

Other programs to address public health issues requests

Expand the DOHMH's healthy food access programs such as Shop Healthy, healthy corner stores, Green Carts and the FRESH program to include Red Hook. Access to healthy affordable foods has long been a challenge for residents of Red Hook, but the neighborhood is not eligible for these healthy food access programs. : In the 2018 Community Health Needs and Assets Assessment by NYU Langone, Red Hook Initiative, Good Shephard Services and several other community partners, Healthy food options seem limited and too expensive to many Red Hook residents. 58% of survey respondents reported not having places in the neighborhood to buy affordable fresh fruits and vegetables.

Human Resources Administration (HRA)**1 of 1 Other domestic violence services requests****HRA**

Other domestic violence services requests

Additional funding is requested to expand the spectrum of services that provide assistance to victims of domestic violence - from counseling to protection to shelter - in order to ensure that adequate resources exist to help this vulnerable population in need. Outreach and promotional materials are needed to reach the population, provide them with convenient access to services and help educate communities on the importance of these services to remove any fear and stigma that may be attached to these facilities.

New York City Housing Authority (NYCHA)

1 of 1 Other housing support requests

Other housing support requests

NYCHA

Sufficient funds are requested for the expansion of NYCHA Maintenance personnel staff, perhaps through the creation of an in-house training program that would take employable NYCHA residents and train them in the skilled trades in an apprenticeship program and workforce development initiative. Upon successful completion of the program, graduates could be placed in maintenance and construction positions in the private market through the NYCHA- REES program.

Department of Parks and Recreation (DPR)

1 of 3 Provide more programs in parks or recreational centers

Provide more programs in parks or recreational centers

DPR

Funds are requested for upgrades including resumption of the compost program at Red Hook Community Farms, a youth-led food justice program. Since curbside composting programs were cut due to the pandemic, the most-asked question at the farm has been "Are you all accepting food scraps for composting?" Red Hook has no farmer's market and so no access to even private food-scrap composting operations. As such, all food scraps are going to landfills (a city-wide increase of 100 million pounds / year) - food scraps that could instead be used to create rich compost at a local site that already has capacity and expertise, and increase community cohesion, youth empowerment to boot.

2 of 3 Other park maintenance and safety requests

Other park maintenance and safety requests

DPR

Sufficient funds are requested to restore Parks Maintenance personnel to provide for vital maintenance and report of Parks facilities. With the added supervisory role Parks Maintenance workers perform through the departmental use of JTP and other volunteer workers, more staff are needed to continue to fulfill the traditional roles and tasks performed by Parks Maintenance staff.

3 of 3 Other park maintenance and safety requests

Other park maintenance and safety requests

DPR

Sufficient funds are requested to restore Parks Recreation personnel to increase the inventory and range of recreation options available particularly to our teenage youth population. With fewer part-time job opportunities and shrinking afterschool programs we are looking to increase the number of constructive options for this population to keep them engaged in productive, supervised activities.

New York Police Department (NYPD)

1 of 2 Other NYPD staff resources requests

Other NYPD staff resources requests

NYPD

Reallocate budget resources to restore NYPD bicycle patrols. Bicycle patrols provide a lowcost option for policing that combines the best elements of vehicular access with flexible patrol routes. With increased bicycling, and the call for better enforcement of bicycling rules, it would also provide a more convenient way for police to engage other bicyclists in the proper education and enforcement of the rules of the road. Previous bicycle patrols involved the use of vouchered and donated bicycles making this a cost-effective program that should be reinstituted.

2 of 2 Other NYPD programs requests

Other NYPD programs requests

NYPD

Sufficient funds are requested to provide for a substantial increase in dedicated Truck Enforcement Program personnel to meet the overwhelming demand in our community for aggressive truck enforcement. Adherence to Truck Routes is necessary to reduce conflicts with, and impact on residential safety and quality of life. To protect and preserve public safety, effective enforcement is needed to combat pervasive and dangerous violations. Clear, publicly visible truck route signage is also requested to help enforce these routes.

Department of Sanitation (DSNY)

1 of 1 Provide more frequent garbage or recycling pick-up for schools and institutions**DSNY**

Provide more frequent garbage or recycling pick-up for schools and institutions

Sufficient funds are requested to restore the frequency of litter basket service to a minimum of two collections per day, especially on weekends, along busy commercial corridors such as Van Brunt Street, Columbia Street, Court Street, Smith Street, 5th Avenue, 7th Avenue, Atlantic Avenue, and Flatbush Avenue. Overflowing litter baskets create additional work for the department in discretionary cleaning, contributes to the clogging of catch basins, and results in the unfair issuance of summonses to victims of the strewn litter. Litter on commercial strips negatively contributes to the consumer's shopping experience, detracts from the residents' quality of life, and forces the businesses to shoulder the burden for the City after the mess.

Department of Transportation (DOT)**1 of 1 Other traffic improvement requests****DOT**

Other traffic improvement requests

Sufficient funds are requested for restoration of full- time (non-seasonal) work gangs to respond to year- round routine maintenance calls for potholes and street depressions. There has been a noticeable decrease in productivity and increase in response times in this area attributable to significant loss of manpower. There has also been a significant delay in pothole response times during the winter-spring transition which could be remedied by maintaining more year-round personnel to respond to complaints.

APPENDIX

Appendix I: Budget Requests by Agency

Agency	Request / Action	Capital vs Programmatic	Supporting Text / Notes	Priority / Committee
DOB / HPD	Incentives for market-rate housing preservation, adaptive reuse, new development	Capital / Programmatic	Promote additional density through adaptive reuse or new development to create more diverse housing types across more of the district.	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing
HPD	Allocate FY2027 funds for planning, site selection, and development of affordable senior and special needs housing	Capital	Allocate funds for planning, site selection/acquisition, development, and construction of affordable senior and special needs housing in priority areas.	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing
HPD	Allocate budgeting/program assistance to enable deeply affordable housing construction (<30% AMI)	Capital	Increase budget allocations for affordable housing construction and subsidies for deep affordability in areas experiencing the most need and displacement pressure.	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing
HPD	Expand programs to allow for the integration of multiple housing programs in same building (e.g., SARA + other affordability models)	Programmatic	Encourage HPD to adopt flexible program structures allowing integration of multiple housing programs in the same development.	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing
HPD	Maximize affordable housing on City-owned sites	Capital	Following the model of Gowanus Green, maximize affordable housing on City-owned sites.	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing
NYCHA	Improve housing conditions (mold remediation, plumbing, HVAC systems)	Capital	Update and maintain NYCHA properties to improve housing conditions and ensure health and safety for residents.	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing
NYCHA	Community spaces programming and maintenance	Programmatic	Allocate funds for community spaces within large residential developments, including NYCHA complexes, to provide	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, &

			comprehensive programming.	Housing
NYCHA	Community visioning for future construction	Programmatic	Incorporate community input from visioning sessions into future RFPs for architectural, engineering, and construction work on NYCHA campuses.	Priority 1: Build and Preserve Housing / Committee 1: Land Use, Landmarks, & Housing
NYPD	Retrofit precincts to be ADA accessible	Capital	Add ADA accessible ramps and other infrastructural retrofits to the 76th and 78th precinct buildings	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DOT	Comprehensive transportation plan: protected bike lanes, intersections, freight management	Capital	Budget for a comprehensive transportation plan to discourage unnecessary automobile trips while addressing road safety, walkability, and bike infrastructure needs.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DOT	School street materials, streamline approval process	Programmatic	Fund materials such as barriers and signage to improve safety on school streets, and streamline the process for approving school streets for all CD6 schools.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DOT	Redesign Vision Zero corridors & intersections	Capital	Prioritize the physical separation of modes and increase deployment of buffered bike lanes and expanded pedestrian spaces on priority corridors.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DOT / MTA	Accessibility upgrades at key subway stations; reactivate B71 bus	Capital	Fund accessibility upgrades such as elevators and ramps, reactivate the B71 bus route, and implement transit-signal priority and other enhancements.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DOT	Bicycle parking expansion	Capital	Expand on-street bicycle parking corrals in known hot spots, combining with daylighting to maintain sightlines at intersections.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation,

				Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DOT / NYPD	Traffic enforcement, signage, red-light/speed/bike-lane cameras	Programmatic	Increase traffic enforcement throughout CD6, including red-light, speed, and bike-lane cameras and personnel at priority intersections.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DPR	Fully fund NYC Parks operations and restore staffing (5% of City budget)	Programmatic	Fully fund NYC Department of Parks and Recreation to ensure parks continue functioning as key public spaces and resources.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 2: Transportation, Parks, and Public Infrastructure
DEP / DCP / OEM	Flood barriers, green infrastructure, rain gardens, permeable surfaces	Capital	Install green infrastructure to reduce stormwater entry into sewers, reduce urban heat island effects, and mitigate flooding, especially in Gowanus watershed.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
DEP / DCP / OEM	Flood protection: fixed & deployable flood barriers, drainage improvement	Capital	Allocate funds for fixed and deployable flood barriers in vulnerable areas and fund the improvement and ongoing maintenance of enhanced drainage systems.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
DEP	Sewer system upgrades, CSO improvements, stormwater infrastructure	Capital	Invest in improved stormwater infrastructure, including sewer capacity increases and street drainage, to mitigate flood risks.	Priority 2: Invest in Climate-Resilient Infrastructure / Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
DOE / SBS	Workforce development programs in Red Hook, Gowanus, NYCHA	Programmatic	Fund workforce development programs including NYCHA direct-entry union training and green manufacturing skills programs.	Priority 3: Increase Access to Social Services / Committee 3: Business Affairs & Licenses
DOHMH	Expand programs for healthy food access, including Shop	Programmatic	Expand DOHMH's Shop Healthy! food access programs to improve access to healthy affordable foods	Priority 3: Increase Access to Social Services /

	Healthy!		especially in Red Hook.	Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
DOE / DYCD	Expand childcare for under-5 children with vouchers/city subsidies	Programmatic	Increase the number of childcare programs for children under 5, fully funded by the city or subsidized with vouchers and cash assistance.	Priority 3: Increase Access to Social Services / Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
DOE / Libraries	Library programs, extended hours, heating/cooling centers	Programmatic	Allocate 0.5% of the city budget to extend library hours, enhance programs, and ensure access to heating/cooling centers during closures.	Priority 3: Increase Access to Social Services / Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
DHS / HRA / ENDGBV	Domestic violence shelters; family, child, sexual abuse support programs	Programmatic	Continue funding shelters and programs that serve victims of domestic violence, child abuse, and sexual assault.	Priority 3: Increase Access to Social Services / Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
NYC H+H	Permanent low-cost healthcare facilities in Red Hook, Gowanus, Columbia Waterfront	Capital	Budget for permanent low-cost healthcare facilities focusing on accessibility and coverage for underserved areas.	Priority 3: Increase Access to Social Services / Committee 4: Human Services & Environmental Sustainability
SBS	Funding for BIDs, commercial district assessments, Small Business Services programs	Programmatic	Increase outreach, funding, and support for community-based organizations and BIDs, and encourage Small Business Services funding to drive improvements in commercial corridors.	Committee 3: Business Affairs & Licenses
SBS	Open Streets program, outdoor sheds & pedestrian spaces	Programmatic	Continue and expand support for Open Streets programs and maintain funding for permitting and upkeep of outdoor dining and pedestrian spaces.	Committee 3: Business Affairs & Licenses

Table 1.1: All Brooklyn Community Board 6 budget requests for specific City agencies.

Appendix II: FY2027 Community Survey Results

In October 2025, BKCB6 published its “FY2027 District Needs Survey” via Google Forms and publicized the survey using the district newsletter and social media, allowing recipients to share their opinions on the most salient issues facing CD6. The survey received 129 responses as of November 10, 2025. Below is a summary of the results of those responses:

Section 1: Demographics

In which neighborhood(s) do you live, work, or spend the most time?

129 responses

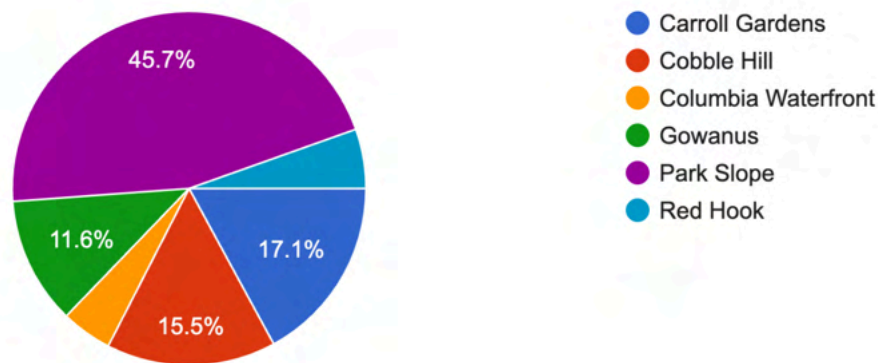


Table 2.1: Respondent demographics, by neighborhood.

In what capacity do you most often engage with the Brooklyn Community Board 6 district (for example, as a resident, employee, or organization representative)?

129 responses

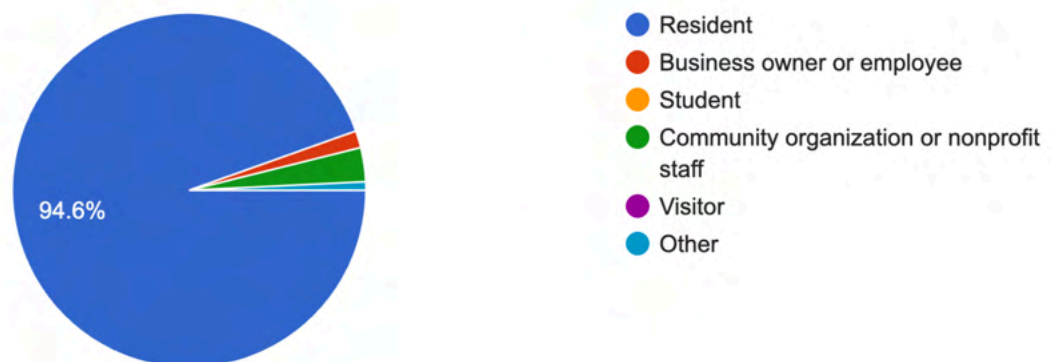


Table 2.2: Respondent demographics, by nature of relationship to Brooklyn Community District 6.

How long have you lived, worked, or otherwise been engaged in the CB6 area?

129 responses

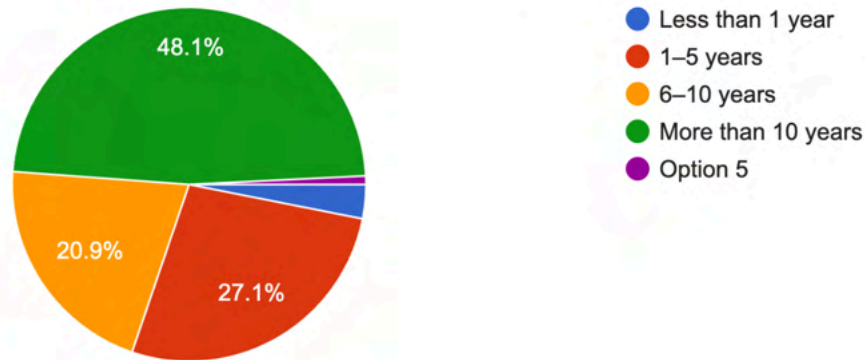


Table 2.3: Respondent demographics, by age of relationship to Brooklyn Community District 6.

Section 2: Overall Priorities

Which policy and budget areas should Brooklyn Community Board 6 focus on most in Fiscal Year 2027?

129 responses

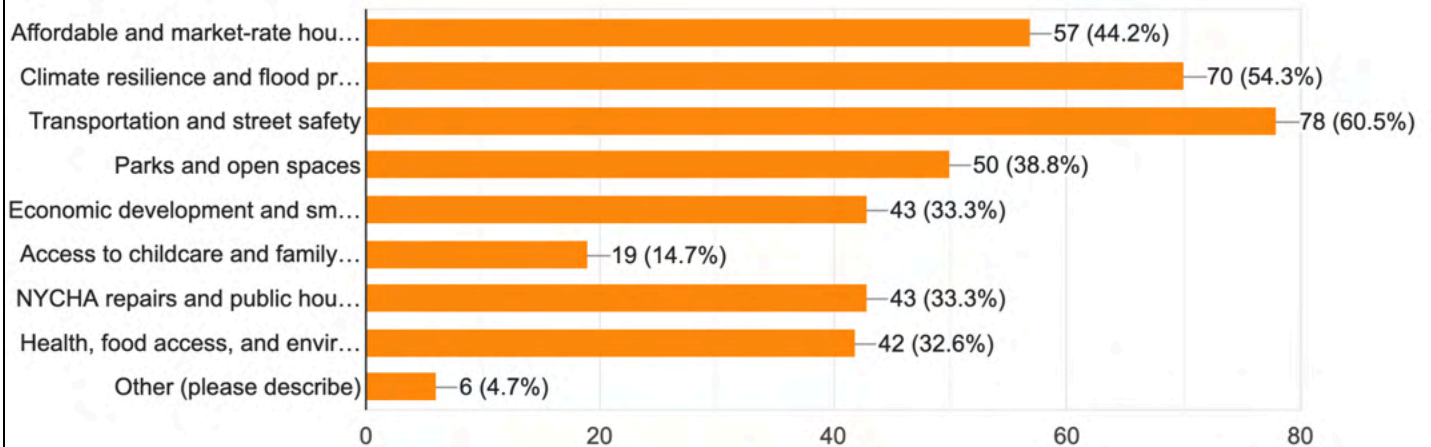


Table 2.4: Overall top priorities for Brooklyn Community Board 6.

Section 3: Housing and Land Use

When respondents were asked to provide an open-ended response to the question “**What is your top concern related to housing?**”, the following top themes emerged:

1. **Affordability and rent pressure:** Persistent concern about rising rents, desire for more deeply affordable units (lower AMI), middle-income options, and expanded rent stabilization; many also want pathways to affordable homeownership, not just rentals.
2. **Build more, but social and physical infrastructure must also keep pace:** Calls to speed housing production via zoning reform and ADUs, countered by warnings that density must be paired with transit, schools, parks, sewer upgrades, and flood resilience; frustration with slow approvals.
3. **Development mix, design, and community character:** Opposition to luxury-only projects; preference for mixed-income housing with family-sized units (3–4 bedrooms), contextual low-rise design, preservation of historic buildings, and avoiding conversions of multi-family to single-family; anxiety about displacement and gentrification.
4. **NYCHA and the existing stock:** Strong push for NYCHA repairs/modernization and keeping existing affordable units viable; bring warehoused stabilized apartments back online; skepticism about AMI definitions and developer accountability to affordability goals.
5. **Policy, market enforcement, and community engagement:** Address illegal short-term rentals, ensure units are occupied, consider small-owner tax/upkeep burdens, and improve community input on major plans; some respondents cite specific plan opposition alongside calls for clearer, faster, fairer processes.

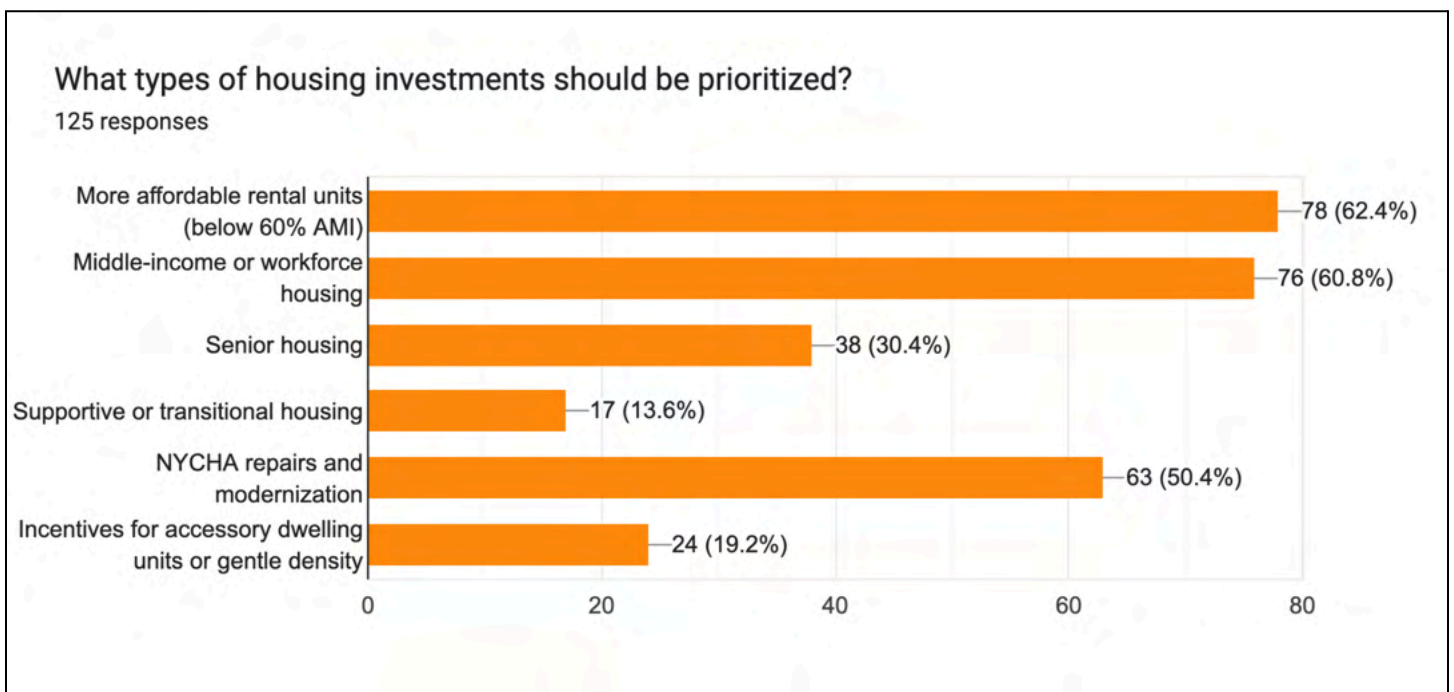


Table 2.5: Top housing-related priorities for Brooklyn Community Board 6.

Do you support exploring zoning or policy changes that allow for more mixed-income and multi-family housing in CB6?

127 responses

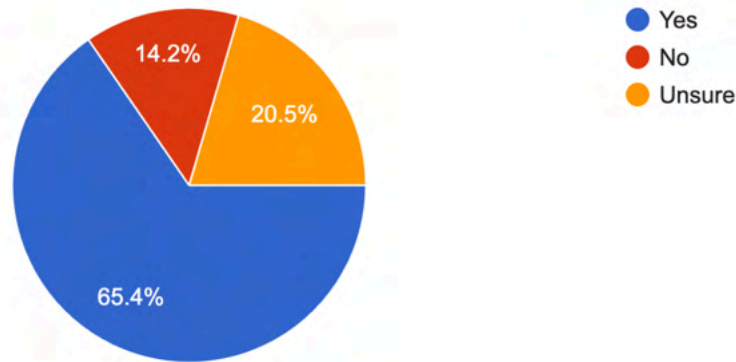


Table 2.6: Whether BKCB6 should explore policy changes toward more mixed- and multi-family housing.

Section 4: Climate, Infrastructure, and Transportation

When respondents were asked to provide an open-ended response to the question “**What specific streets or intersections most need safety or infrastructure upgrades?**”, the following top themes emerged:

- **The most named hotspots** are the broader Atlantic corridor—especially where Atlantic meets Columbia, Henry, Hicks, and BQE ramps—plus the Court Street corridor, 4th Avenue (from Flatbush to the 20s), the Union Street–Flatbush–Grand Army Plaza nexus, and Red Hook routes including Van Brunt, Hamilton, Conover, and Imlay.
- **Safety concerns** focus on heavy truck volumes, speeding and red-light running, inconsistent or unprotected bike lanes, difficult crossings (lack of daylighting, medians, and islands), and poor lighting and cleanliness on key walking routes between Red Hook and Carroll Gardens.
- **Flood-prone intersections and inadequate sewer drainage** are also recurring problems, particularly around Hamilton/West 9th and 4th Ave at Carroll/5th.
- **Other requested fixes include:** restoring safe, predictable operations on Court Street (with strong but conflicting views: some want the protected bike lane kept and strengthened; others want two lanes reinstated), calming Hicks (to reduce its BQE bypass role), adding protected bike lanes and physical barriers (4th Ave, 3rd Ave, Hicks, Sixth/Seventh Aves), pedestrian islands and crosswalk upgrades on Columbia and throughout the Atlantic corridor, stricter enforcement against illegal parking and signal violations, more street lighting and cleaner streets on Red Hook walking connectors, truck route management (rerouting Amazon/cruise-related traffic), new signals (e.g., Court & Luquer) and better signal timing (West 9th/Hamilton), and targeted flood/sewer capacity upgrades at known corners.

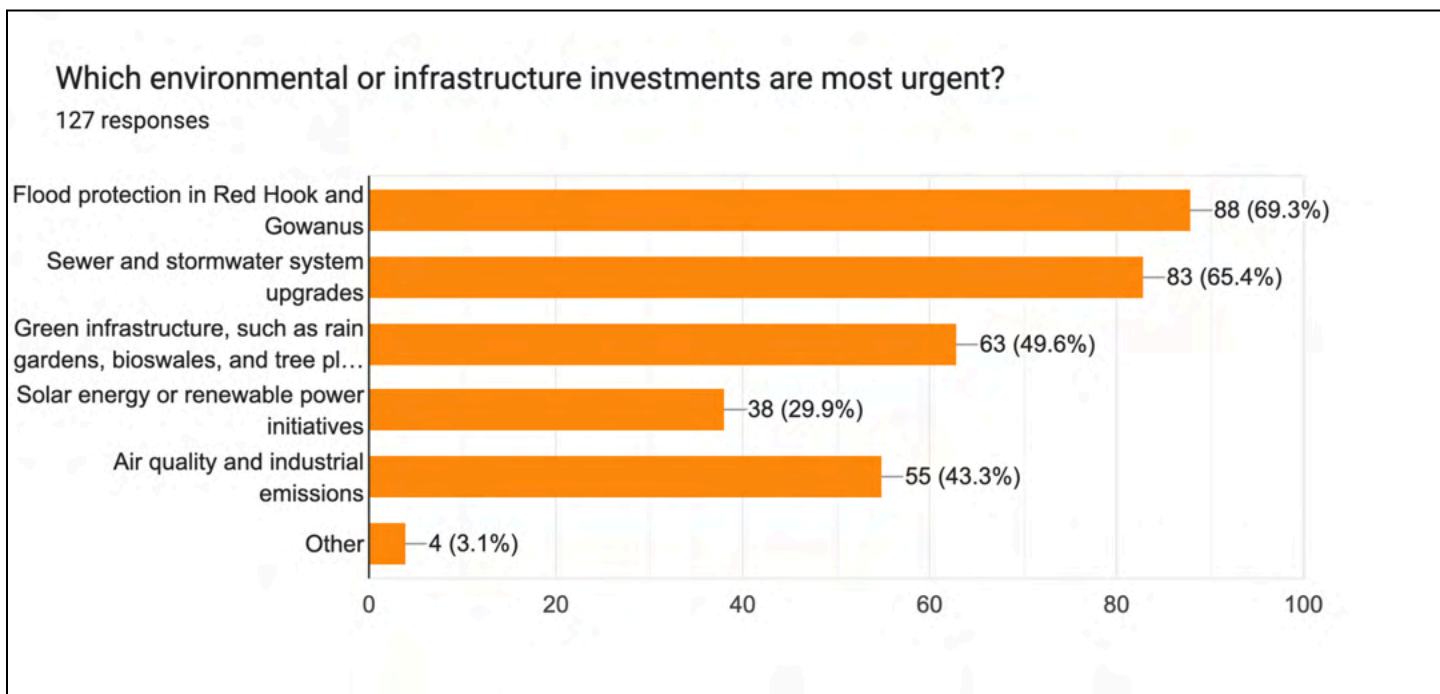


Table 2.7: Top environmental and infrastructure issues for Brooklyn Community Board 6.

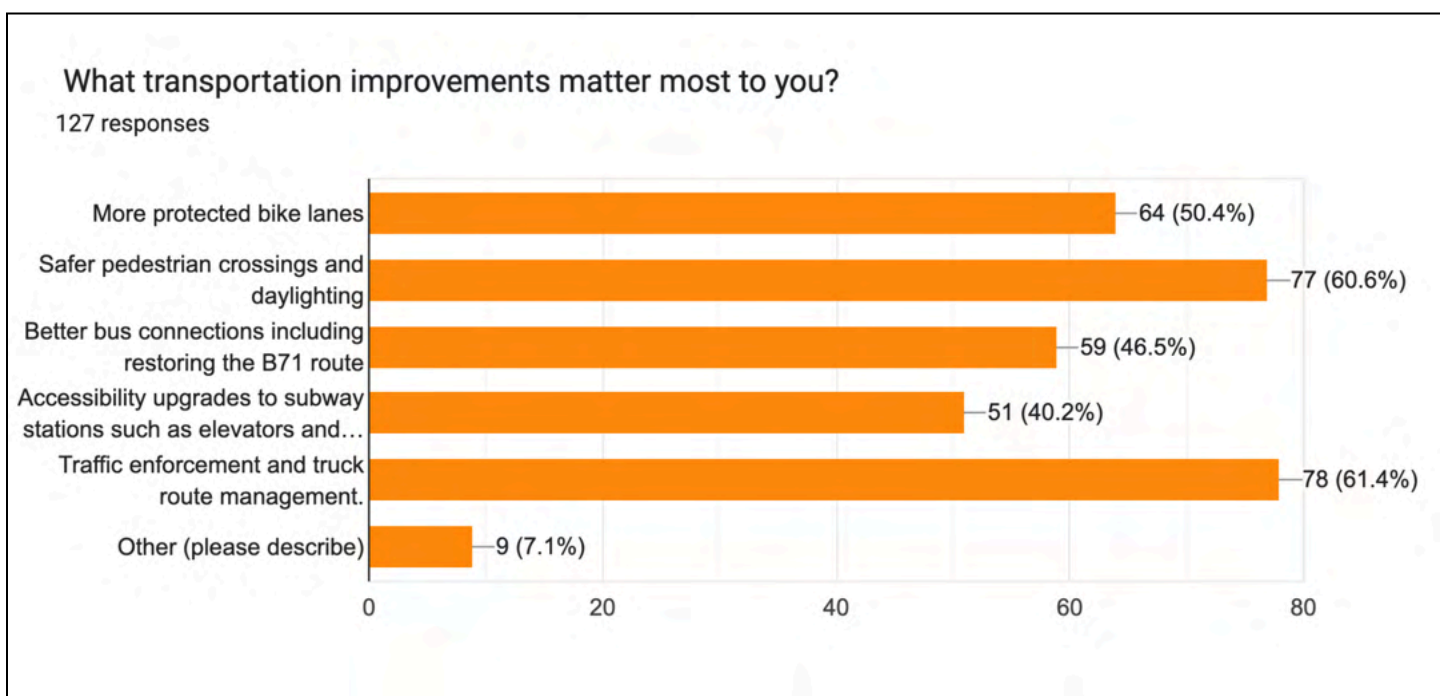


Table 2.8: Top transportation issues for Brooklyn Community Board 6.

Section 5: Parks, Open Space, and Business Corridors

When respondents were asked to provide an open-ended response to the question “**Which parks or open spaces need the most attention?**”, the following top themes emerged:

- **Prospect Park** appears frequently for cleaner bathrooms, longer open hours, and more staffing for trash and upkeep.
- **Van Voorhees Park and the Columbia Waterfront** are cited for pollution, traffic-adjacent conditions, and cleanliness.
- In **Red Hook**, respondents call out Red Hook Park, the pool's staffing, and underused cruise terminal areas, plus a strong need for dog runs at Coffey Park and Valentino Pier.
- Around the **Gowanus Canal**, people want continued waterfront access improvements and a connected walkway system, with more street-tree coverage to mitigate extreme heat.
- Smaller but repeated items include upgrades to **Carroll Park** (especially toddler play), opening the **school playground between Baltic/Butler/Smith** to the public after hours, cleaning and activating **spaces under the BQE**, and adding **more and larger dog runs** district-wide.

How important is increased investment in parks and public spaces?

126 responses

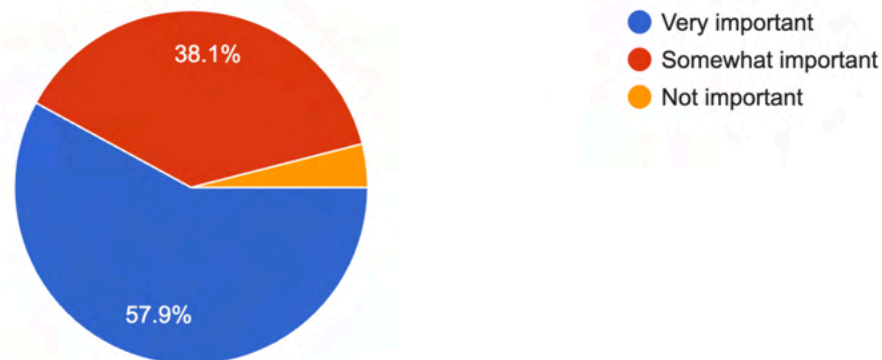


Table 2.9: Respondent sentiment toward parks-related investment.

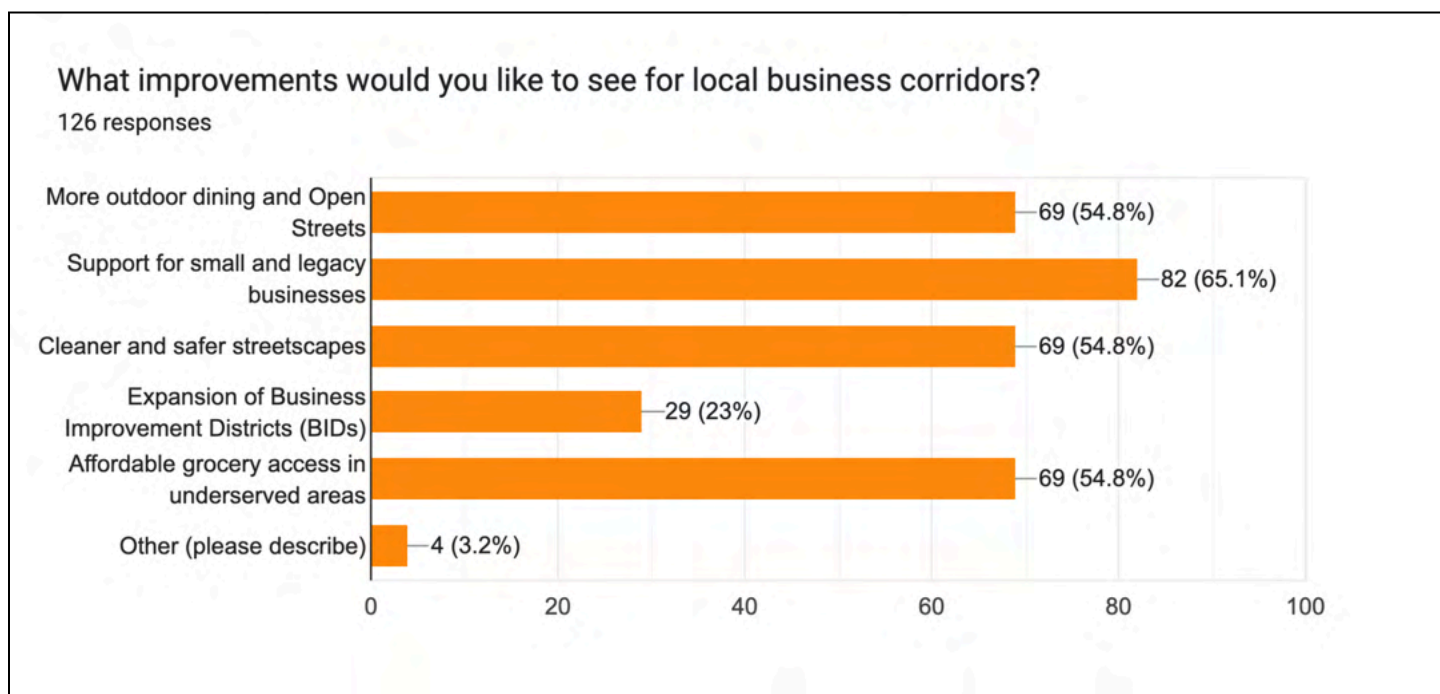


Table 2.10: Top business-related priorities for Brooklyn Community Board 6.

Section 6: Social Services, Health, and Equity

When respondents were asked to provide an open-ended response to the question “**Are there specific service gaps across the district or nearby areas that you would like to highlight?**”, the following top themes emerged:

- **Childcare affordability/availability:** High costs across ages; limited after-school/holiday care; low wages for providers undermine quality.
- **Behavioral health and homelessness support:** More outreach and non-police services at subway nodes (Smith–9th, Union Ave R); homelessness prevention; housing-first supports; specific encampment at Wolcott/Dwight/Lorraine.
- **Food access and SNAP stability:** Reliance on single providers (e.g., CHIPS); concern about SNAP cuts; desire for broader, sustained nutrition options.
- **Seniors’ services and access:** Seniors feel invisible; mobility/access challenges, including concerns on an overreliance on bike infrastructure without other infrastructural improvements for those with impaired mobility.
- **Street-level amenities and safety:** More garbage cans on Henry/Clinton; better sidewalk lighting; noise reduction; stronger enforcement against disorder and traffic violations.
- **Supportive housing and community spaces:** Need common areas for residents at Columbia & Degraw; deliver on promised workforce programs tied to the Gowanus rezoning.
- **Regional infrastructure impacts:** BQE congestion and spillover traffic cited as unfair burden on nearby communities.

Which community services should be expanded or better funded?

119 responses

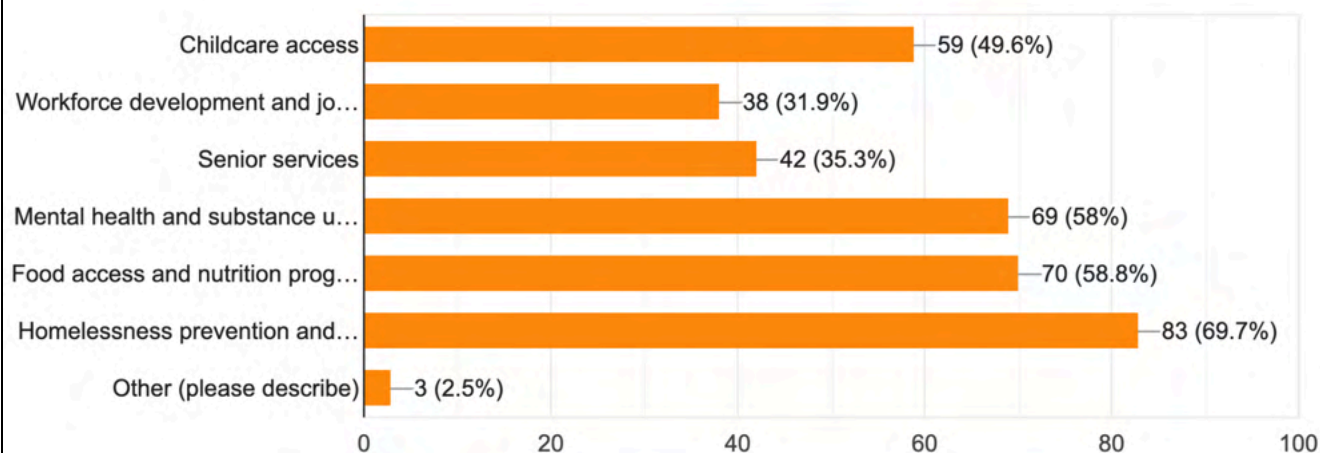


Table 2.11: Top social services-related priorities for Brooklyn Community Board 6.

Appendix III: “Middle Housing Gone Missing: Mediations of Neighborhood Change in Brooklyn Community District 6, 2003-2024” (Kobert, MS Urban and Community Planning, 2025)



Appendix IV: Significant Maps from “The Comprehensive Plan for Brooklyn 2025” (Brooklyn Borough President Antonio Reynoso)

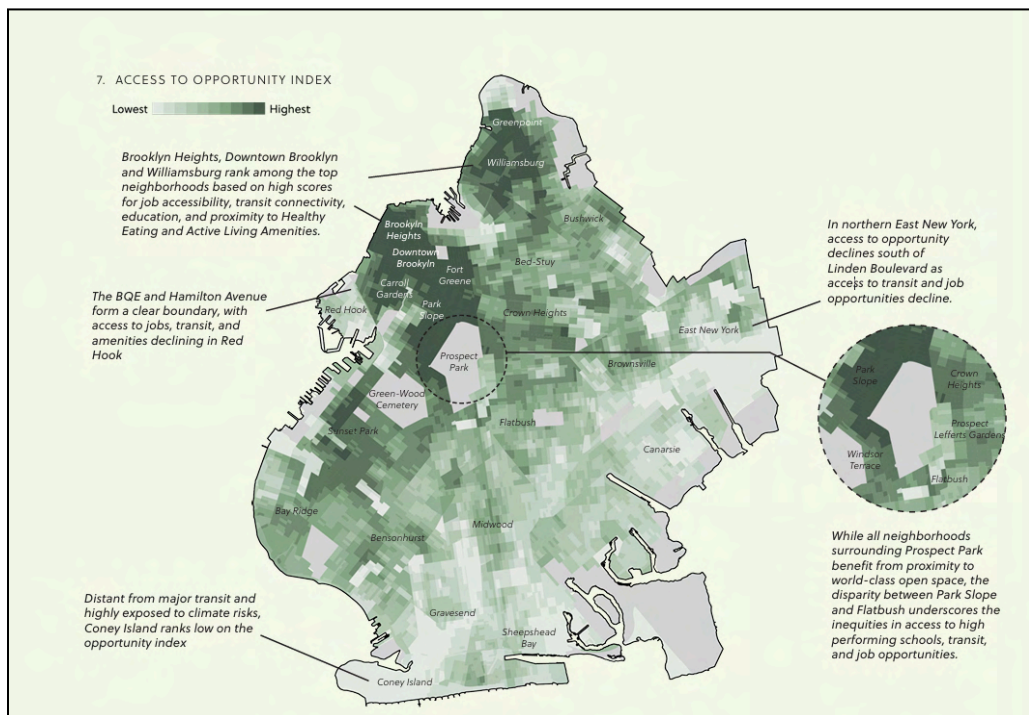


Image 4.1: Access to Opportunity Index.

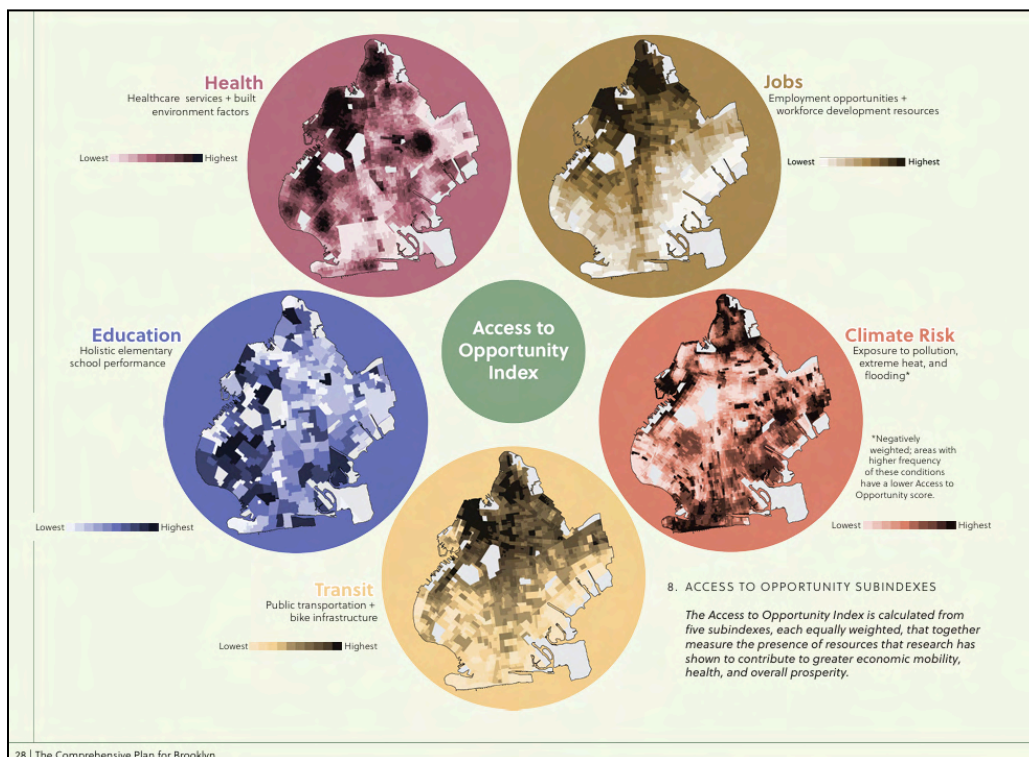


Image 4.2: Access to Opportunity Subindexes.

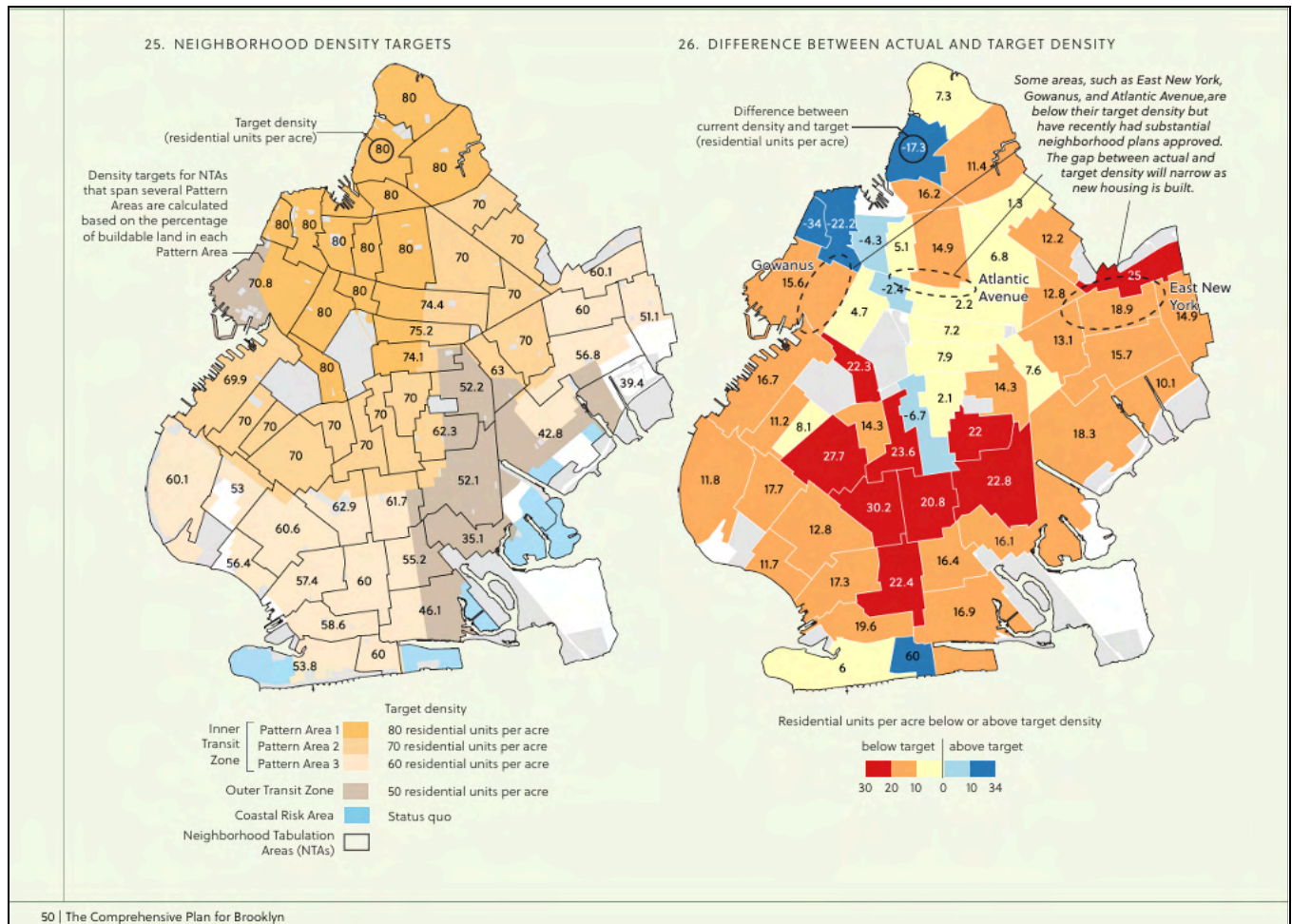


Image 4.3: Neighborhood Density Targets (left) and Difference Between Actual and Target Density (right).

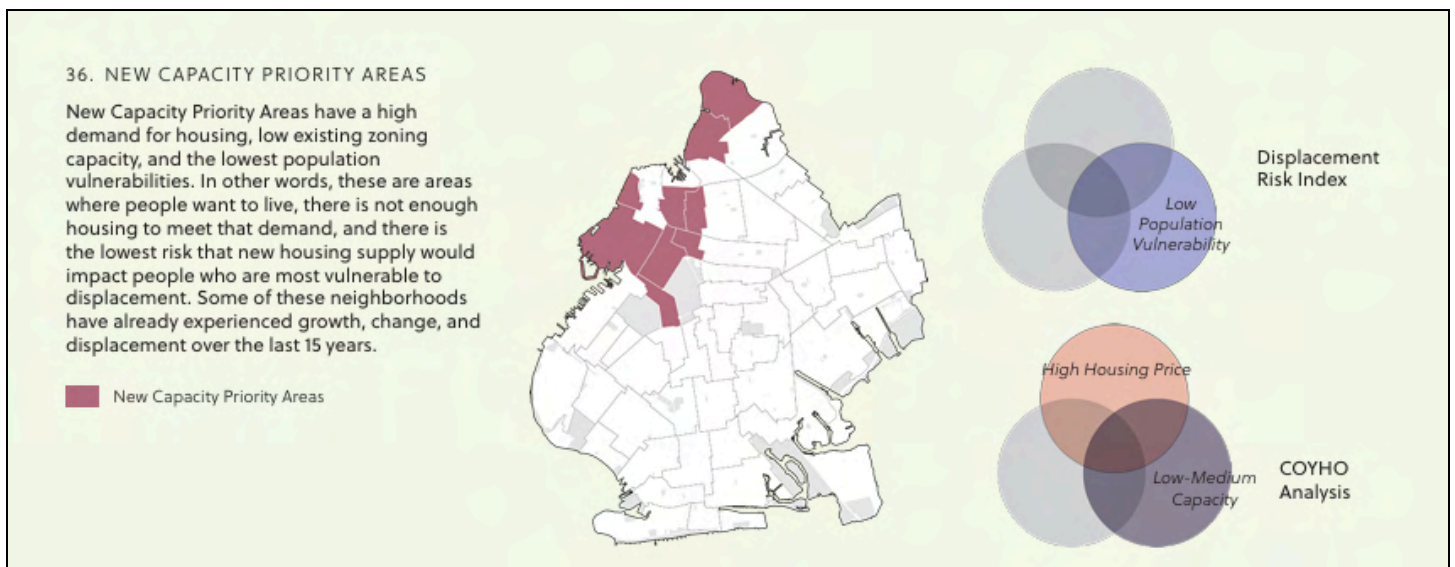


Image 4.4: New Capacity Priority Areas.

41. HOUSING CONSOLIDATION WARNING AREAS (RIGHT)

A handful of census tracts report a net reduction of residential units between 2010-2023. Many of these census tracts are located in parts of the borough with the highest housing prices, where the demand for housing is highest. These areas could be losing units not because of demolition and disinvestment, but because of conversions of existing multi-family buildings into larger, more luxurious units and/or to accommodate larger family sizes.

Recent alterations that resulted in a net loss of at least two residential units show a similar pattern as the census tracts, with high concentrations in the highlighted census tracts near the neighborhoods of Park Slope and Brooklyn Heights. In other parts of the borough, these losses could have been offset by new housing construction that may not be possible in Consolidation Warning Areas either because of a lack of zoning capacity or the designation of historic districts. See the Housing Element for associated Strategies and Actions.

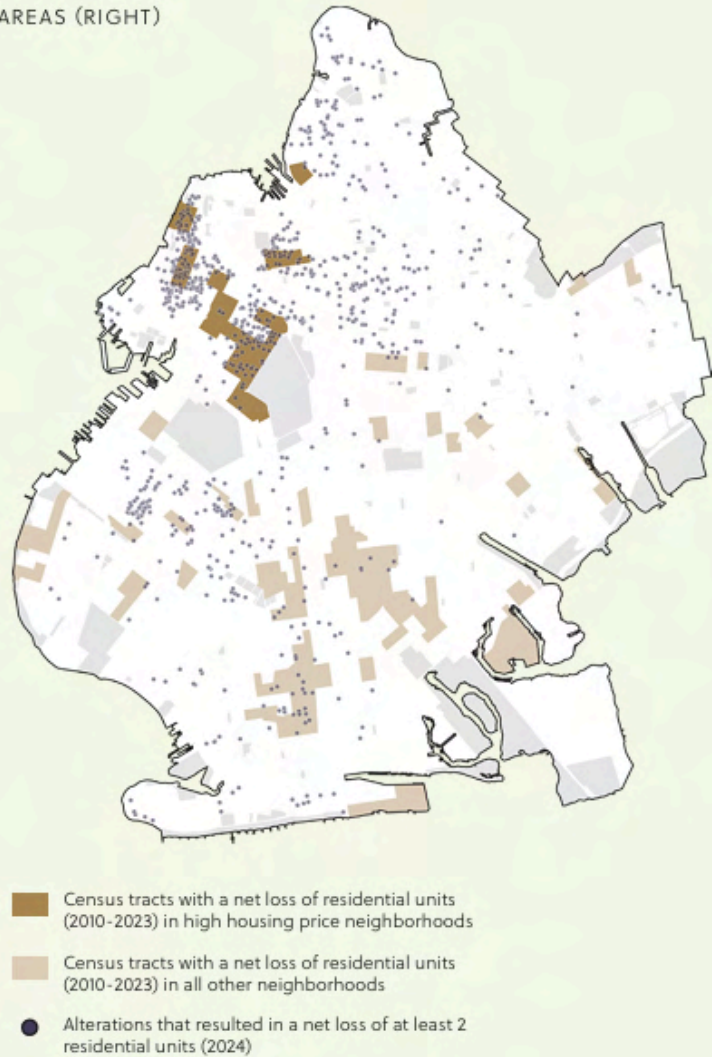


Image 4.5: Housing Consolidation Warning Areas.

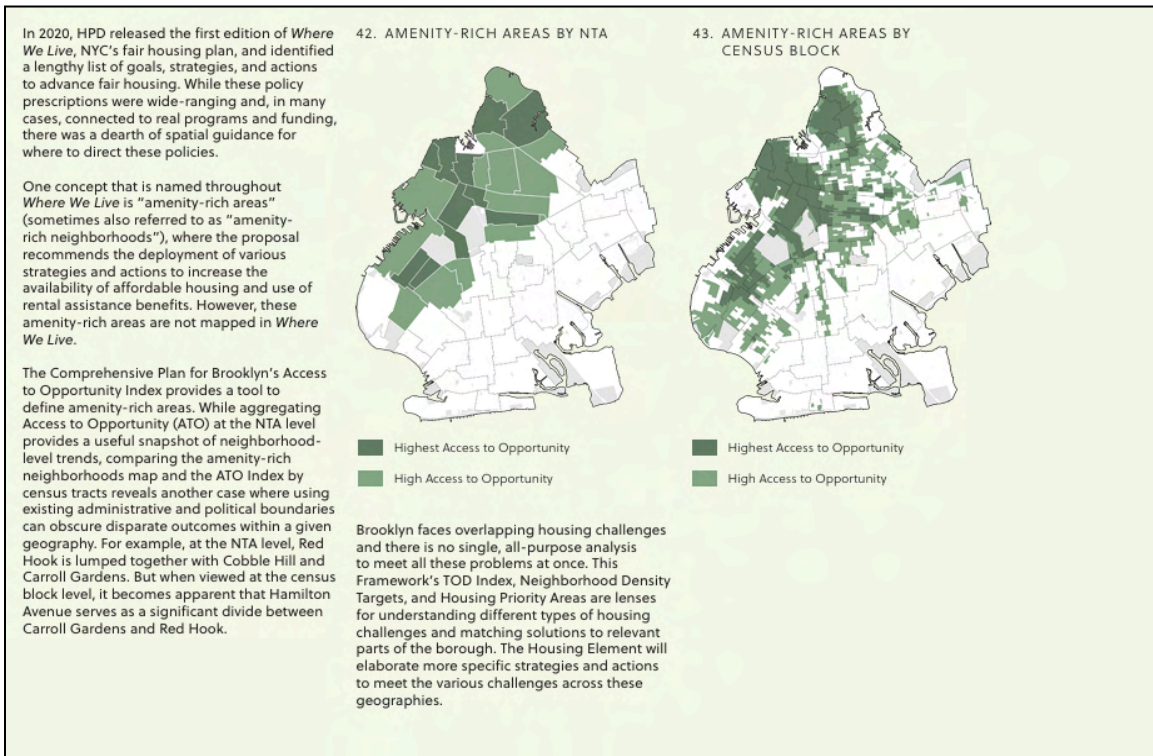


Image 4.6: Amenity-Rich Areas by NTA (left) and Map Amenity-Rich Areas by Census Block (right).

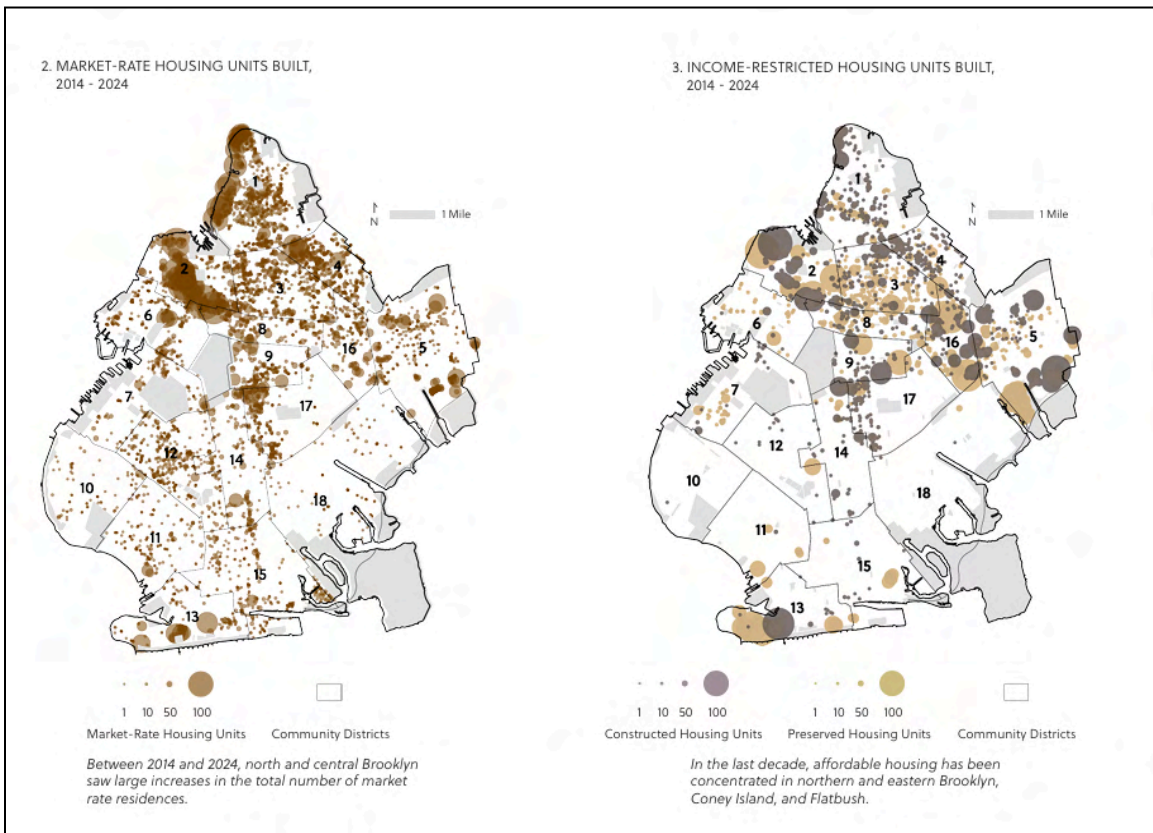


Image 4.7: Market-Rate Housing Units Built, 2014–2024 (left) and Income-Restricted Housing Units Built, 2014–2024 (right).

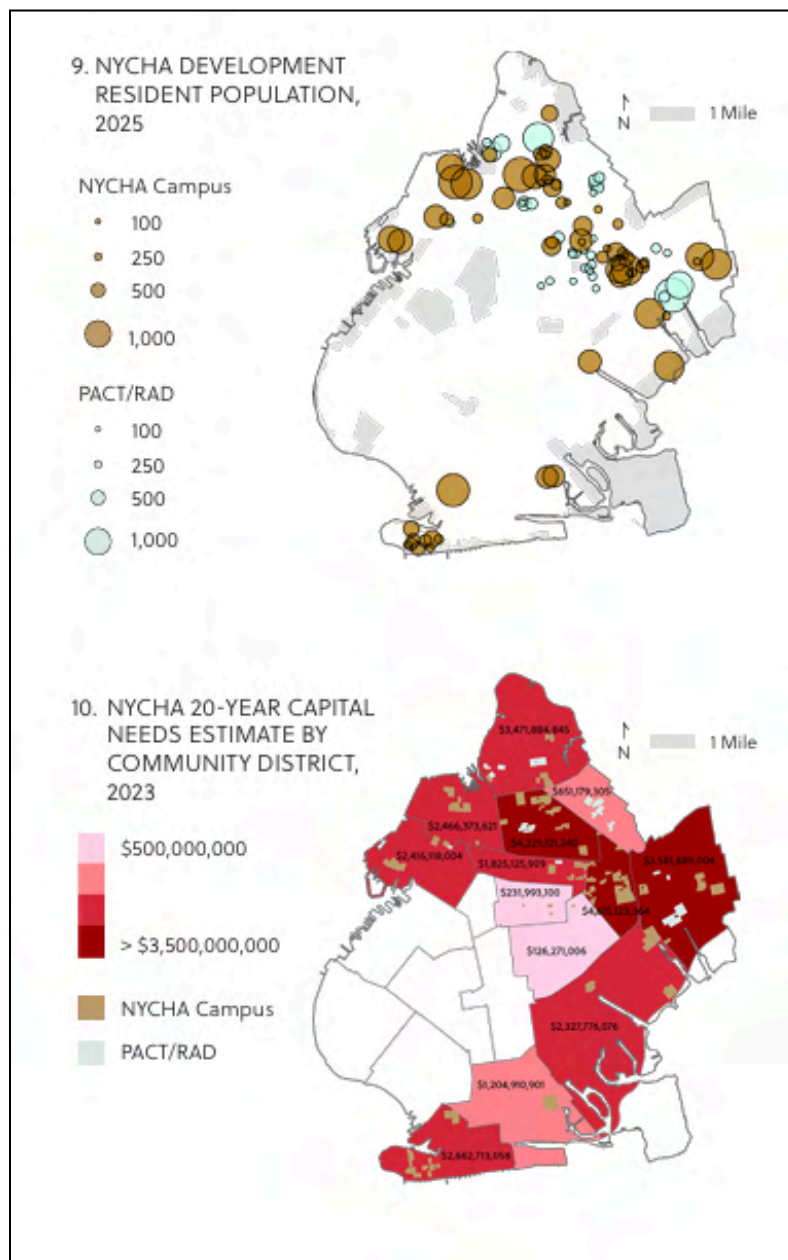


Image 4.8: NYCHA Development Resident Population, 2025 (top) and NYCHA 20-Year Capital Needs Estimate by Community District, 2023 (bottom).

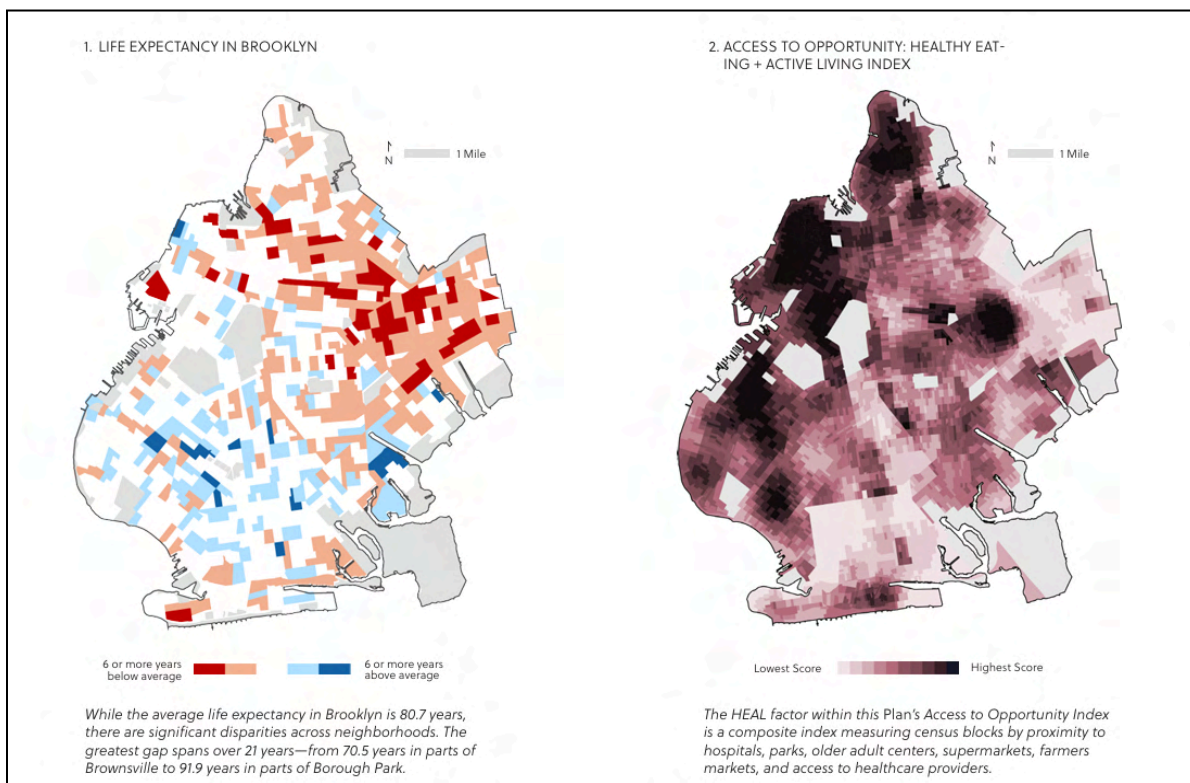


Image 4.9: Life Expectancy in Brooklyn (left) and Access to Opportunity: Healthy Eating + Active Living Index (right).

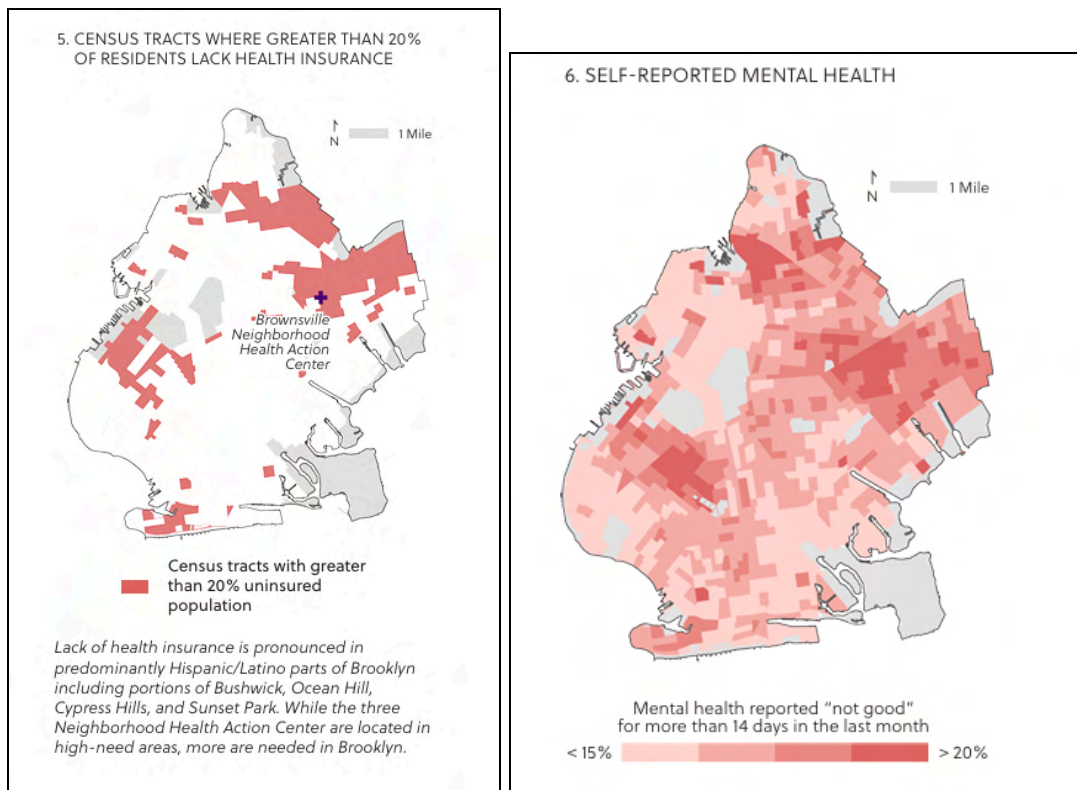


Image 4.10: Census Tracts Where Greater Than 20% of Residents Lack Health Insurance (left) and Self-Reported Mental Health (right).

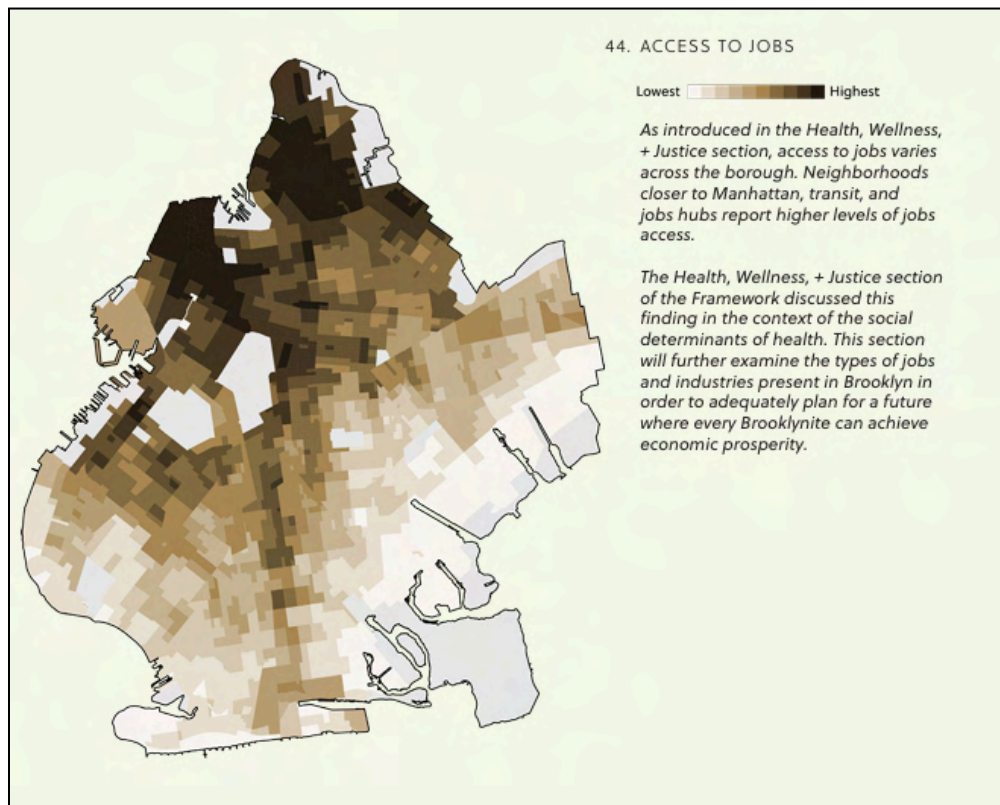


Image 4.11: Access to Jobs.

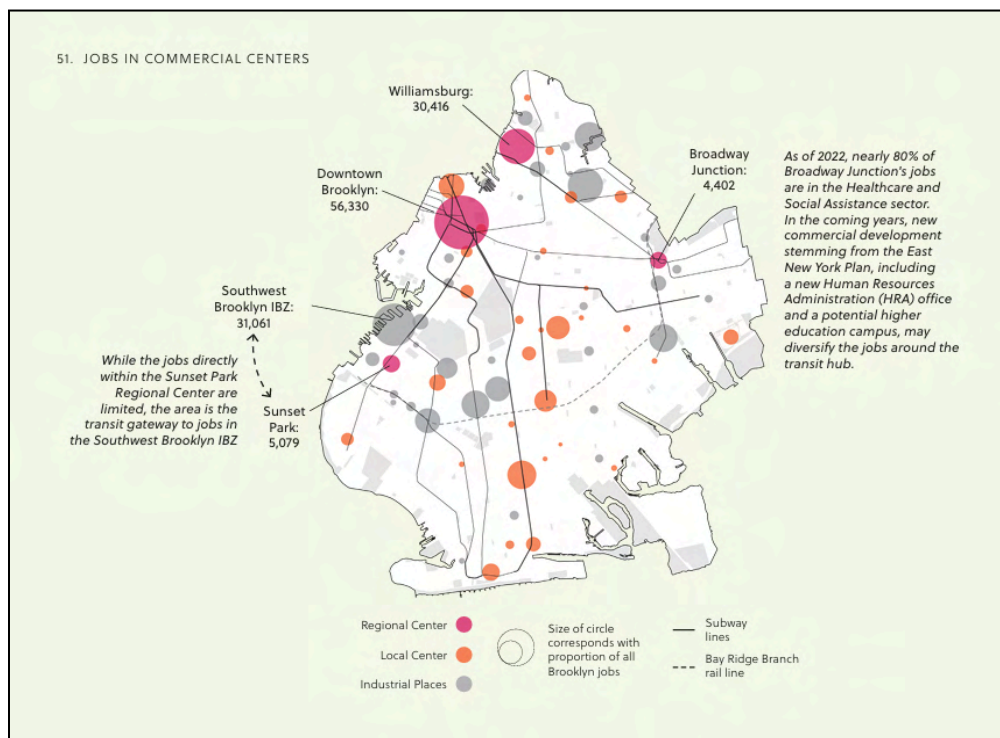


Image 4.12: Jobs in Commercial Centers.

Neighborhood Corridors

Across Brooklyn's Neighborhood Corridors are where residents shop for groceries, stop in their bodegas, and frequent trusted barbershops. These are the same areas as identified in the Urban Design Typology. These corridors are where Brooklynites spend their money, support local entrepreneurship, and build community ties.

Brooklyn's Neighborhood Corridors support 211,460 jobs; one of Brooklyn's invaluable assets is that regardless of where you live, you're not far from a street lined with a variety of stores and services.⁴¹ Many of these corridors unfortunately suffered significant setbacks during the COVID-19 pandemic, as many storefronts closed and local businesses still struggle to compete with the rapid rise of e-commerce.

That said, not all Neighborhood Corridors are faring equally. In some neighborhoods, high and chronic vacancy rates are a serious concern, while others continue to thrive thanks to stronger market and community investment. In many areas, Business Improvement Districts (BIDs) and merchants associations help corridors through marketing assistance, safety enhancements, supplemental sanitation, and regulatory support to local businesses, enabling them to adapt to a shifting retail landscape. Conversely, corridors without BIDs or merchants associations often face challenges related to lacking streetscape improvements, high retail vacancy, and ability to maintain cleanliness.

52. NEIGHBORHOOD CORRIDORS

As introduced in the Urban Design Typology, Neighborhood Corridors describe places with local businesses that cater to the surrounding area rather than a boroughwide or regional market. As such, the health of Neighborhood Corridors relies on strong wages and local residents' disposable income.

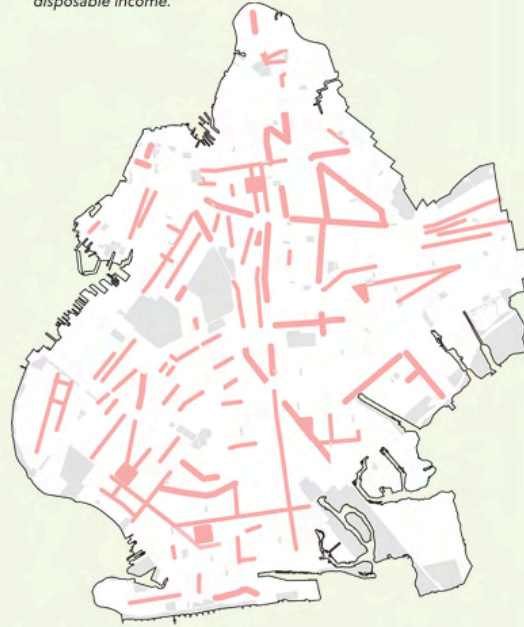
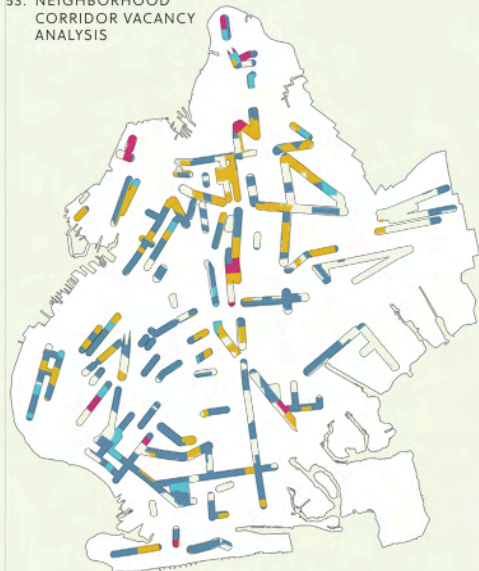


Image 4.13: Neighborhood Corridors.

53. NEIGHBORHOOD CORRIDOR VACANCY ANALYSIS



- Blue Prime Commercial: High Rent + Low Vacancy
- Dark Blue Local Stable: Low Rent + Low Vacancy
- Pink Overheated: High Rent + High Vacancy
- Yellow Underutilized: Low Rent + Low Vacancy
- White No Data

Commercial Corridor Vacancy Analysis

One way to approximate the health of Brooklyn's Neighborhood Corridors is vacancy rate: a simple measure of what percentage of storefronts are unoccupied. A variety of economic factors influence the vacancy rates and vibrancy of Brooklyn's commercial corridors, including market pressure, gentrification, land use policies, and broader shifts in consumer behavior and use of e-commerce. In 2019, DCP published a typology that categorized a subset of commercial corridors into four buckets based on vacancy rate and commercial rent. Map 53 expands this work and applies the typology to the Neighborhood Corridors identified by this Plan. These categories are:

Overheated Corridors: High Rent + High Vacancy

These overheated markets are in neighborhoods experiencing rapid change, for example Montague Street and Henry Street in Downtown Brooklyn, and parts of Bedford Avenue and Nostrand Avenue in Flatbush. These areas have seen an increase in residents' average income, and the high vacancy rates are likely a result of landlords opting to not rent out storefronts with the expectation of earning greater rent in the future.⁴²

Prime Commercial Corridors: High Rent + Low Vacancy

Areas with high rent and low vacancy receive high foot traffic and are more resilient to increased rents; for example, Greenpoint Avenue in Greenpoint, segments of Court Street and Smith Street in Downtown Brooklyn, and parts of Avenue U in Bay Ridge.

Local Stable Corridors: Low Rent + Low Vacancy

Areas with low rent and low vacancy rates are corridors where small businesses thrive without extreme market pressure. There are many commercial corridors that are in this healthy state, especially in South Brooklyn. Much of Avenue U in Bay Ridge, Church Avenue in Kensington, Liberty Street and Fulton Street in East New York, and others.

Underutilized Corridors: Low Rent + High Vacancy

These underutilized areas indicate a weak demand for retail and services. These areas, including East New York, Brownsville, and parts of Coney Island, might face challenges such as a higher percentage of households with lower disposable incomes, disinvestment, limited foot traffic, or outdated infrastructure.

Image 4.14: Neighborhood Corridor Vacancy Analysis.



Image 4.15: Bus Priority Corridors + Street Grid.

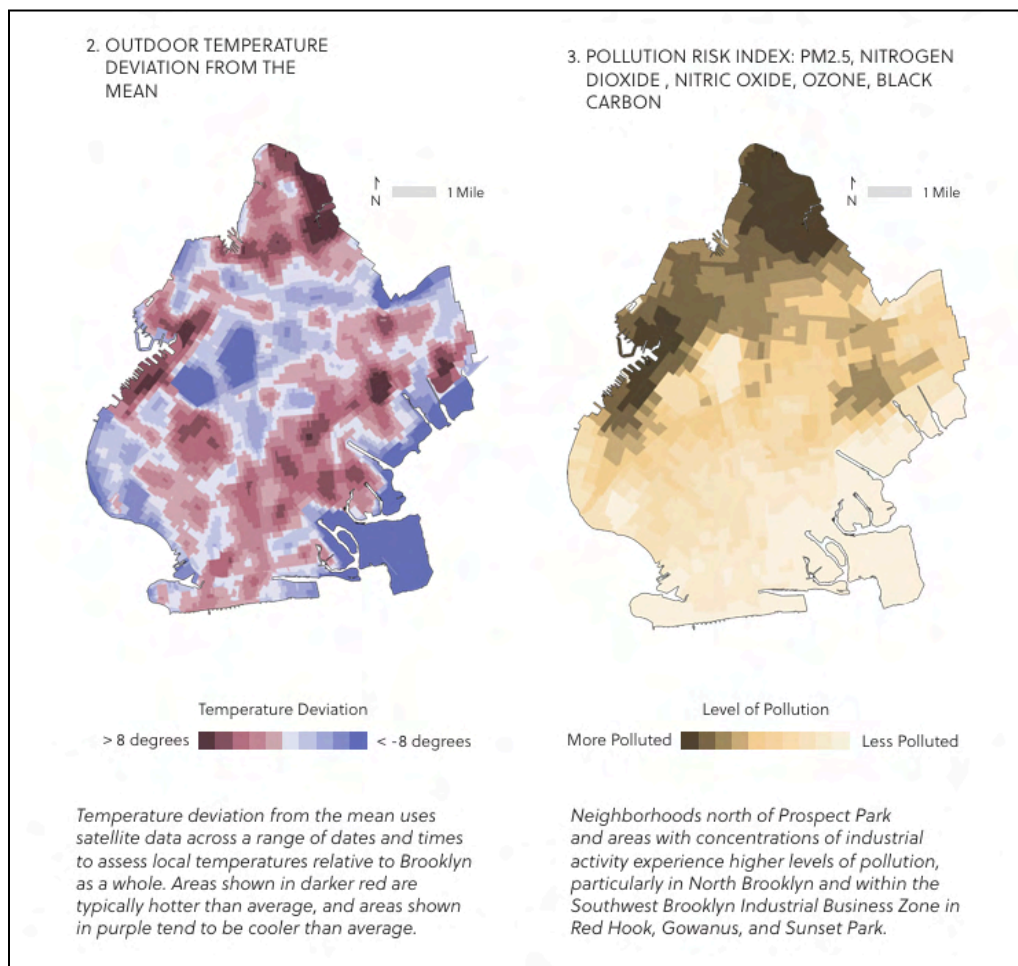


Image 4.16: Outdoor Temperature Deviation from the Mean (left) and Pollution Risk Index: PM2.5, Nitrogen Dioxide, Nitric Oxide, Ozone, Black Carbon (right).

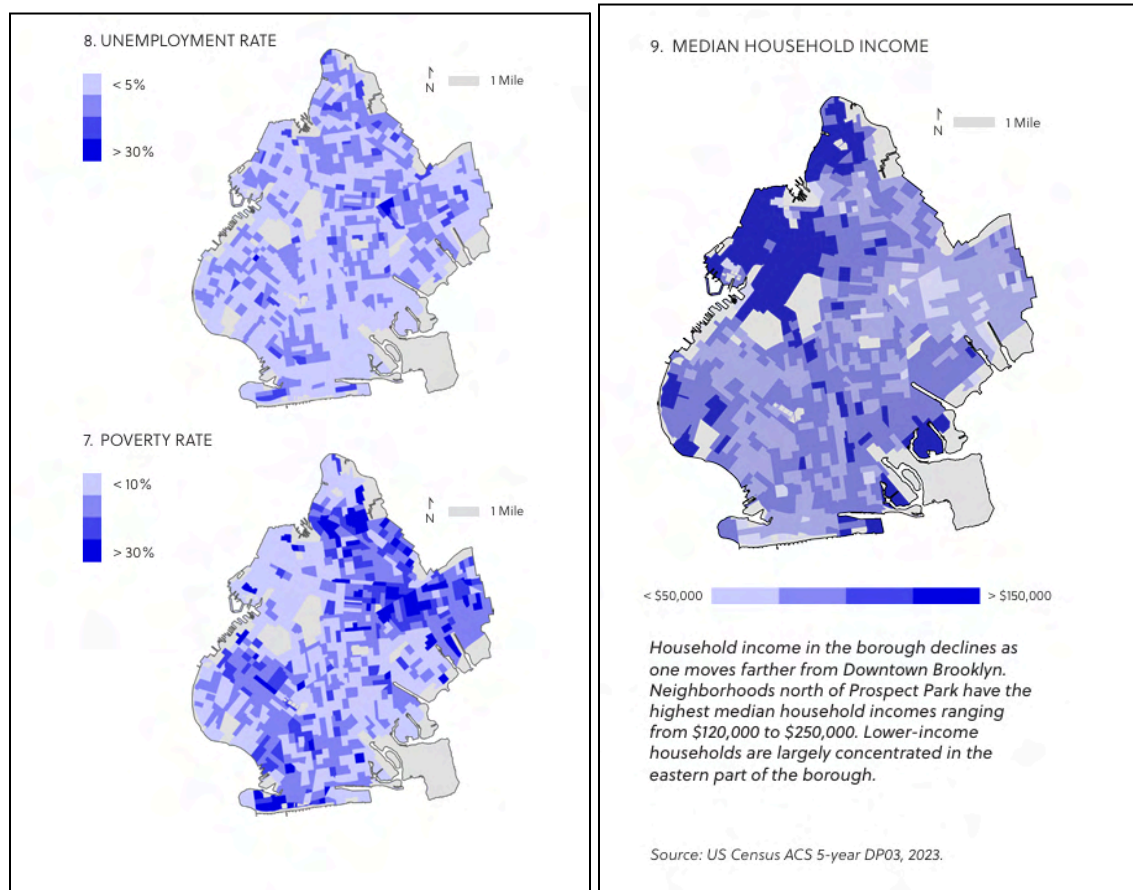


Image 4.17: Unemployment Rate (top-left), Poverty Rate (bottom-left), and Median Household Income (right).

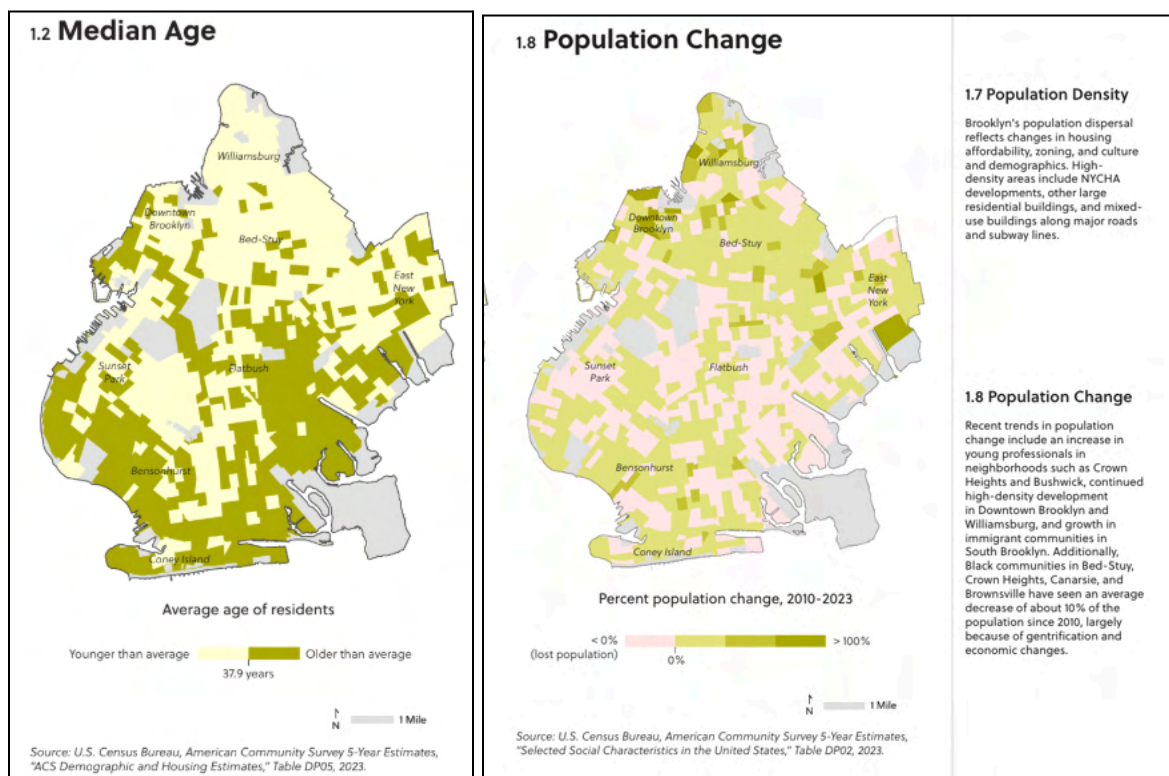


Image 4.18: Median Age (left) and Population Change (right).

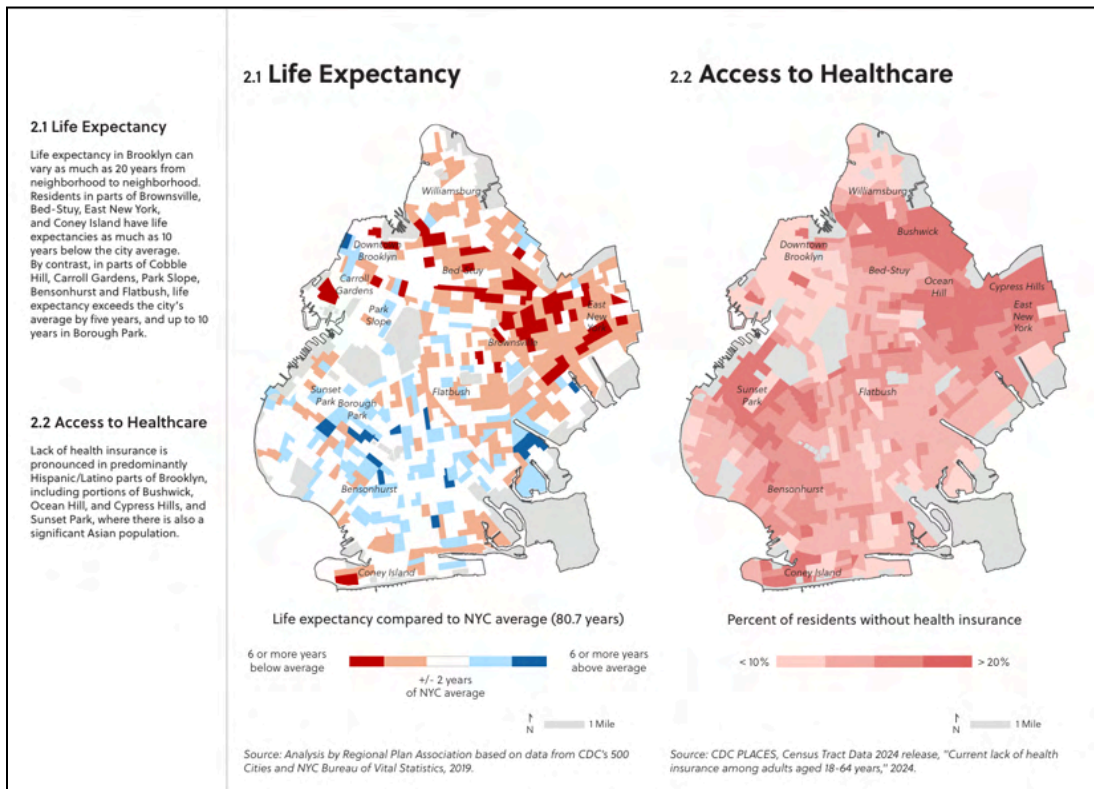
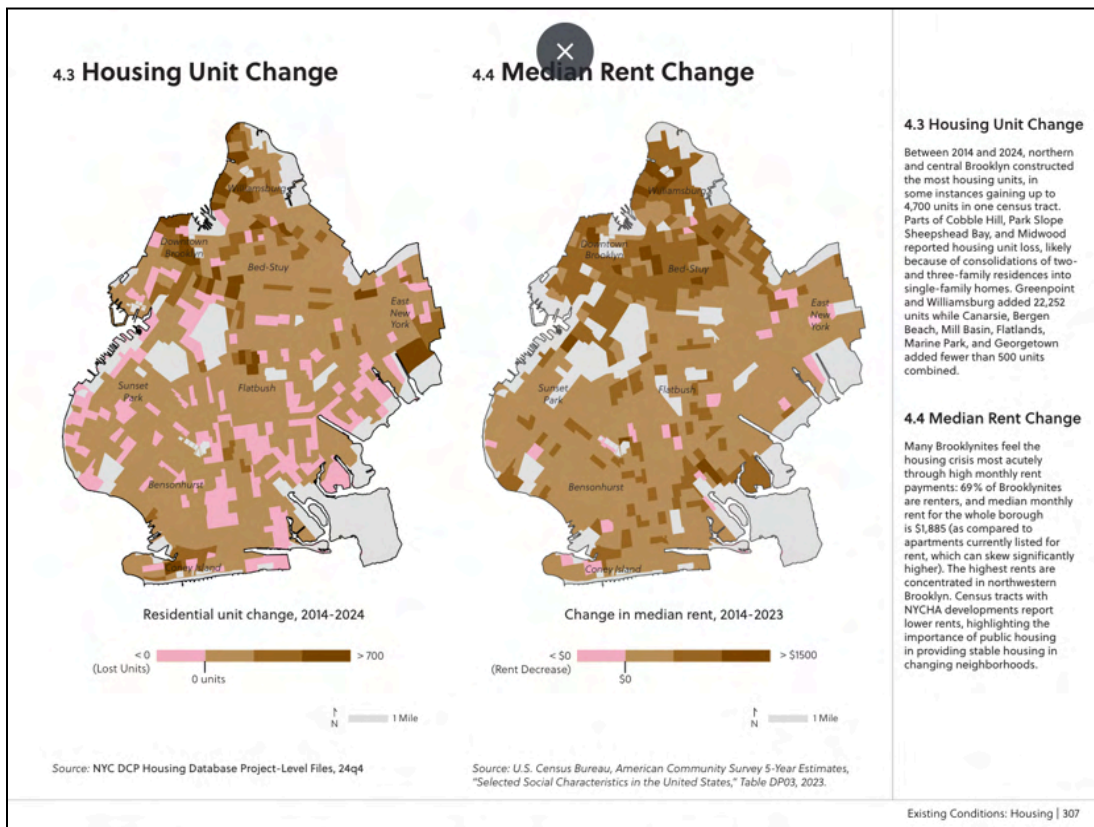


Image 4.19: Life Expectancy (left) and Access to Healthcare (right).



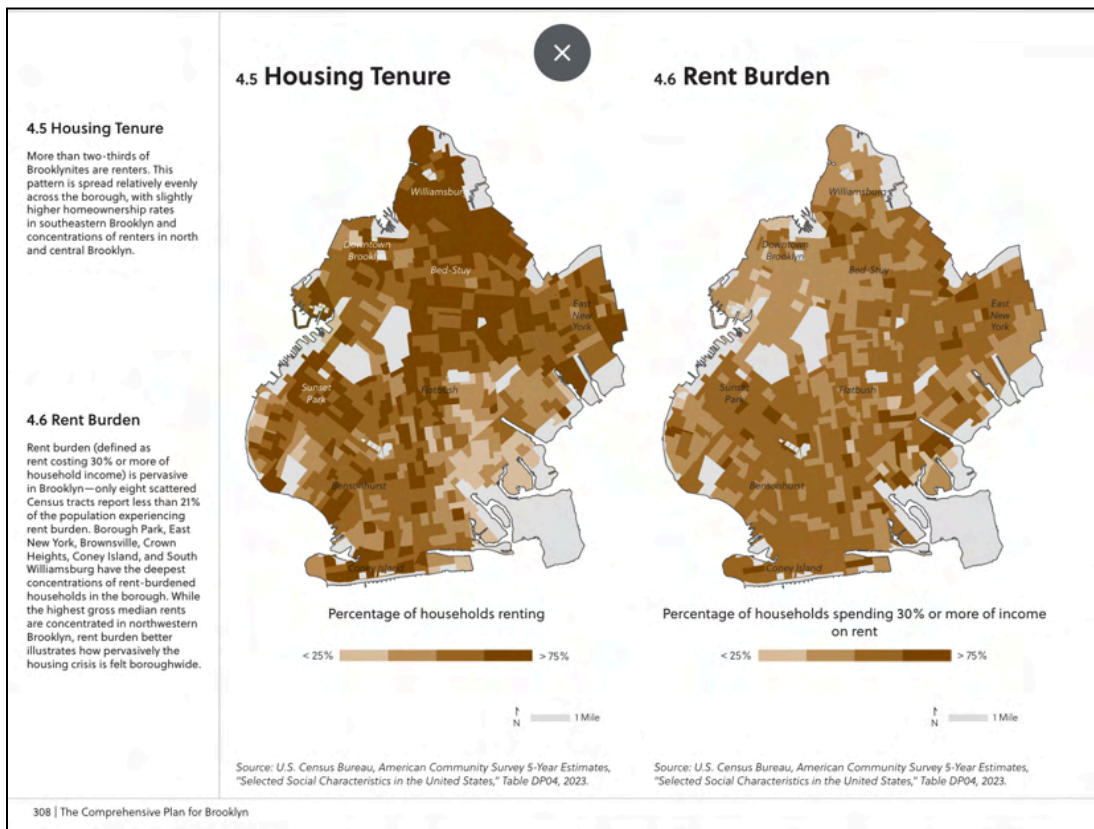


Image 4.21: Housing Tenure (left) and Rent Burden (right).

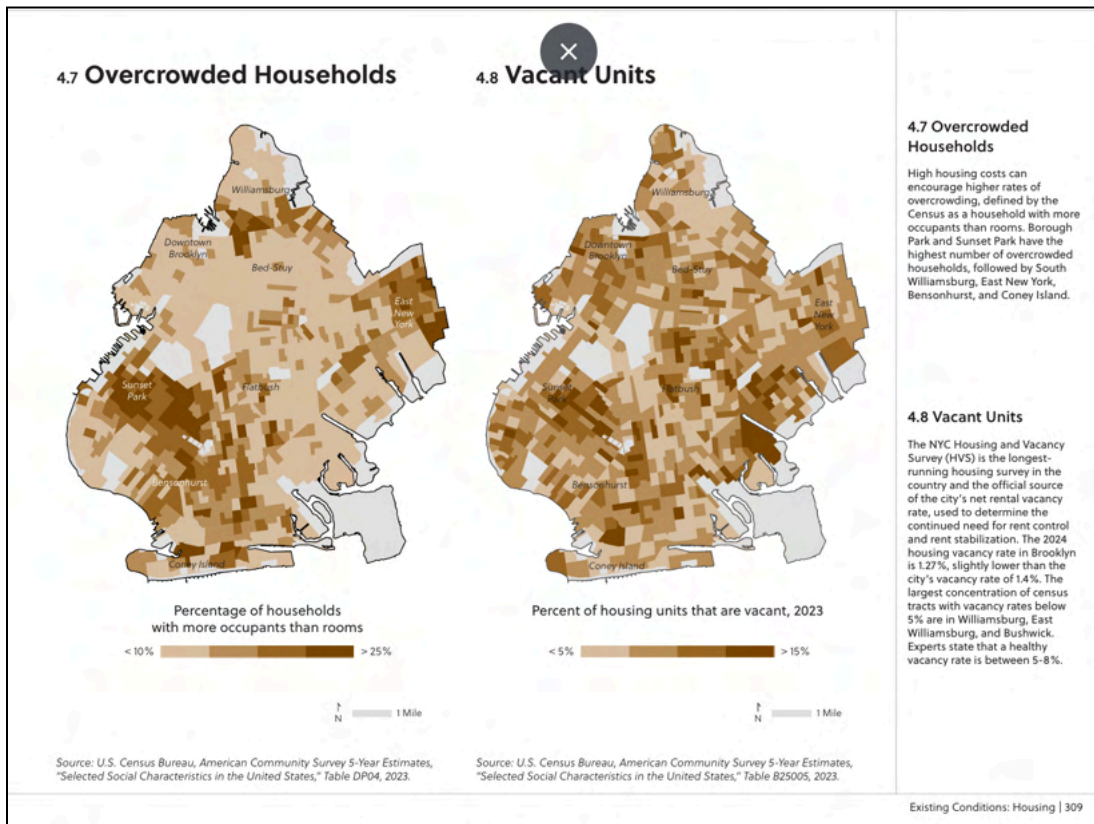


Image 4.22: Overcrowded Households (left) and Vacant Units (right).

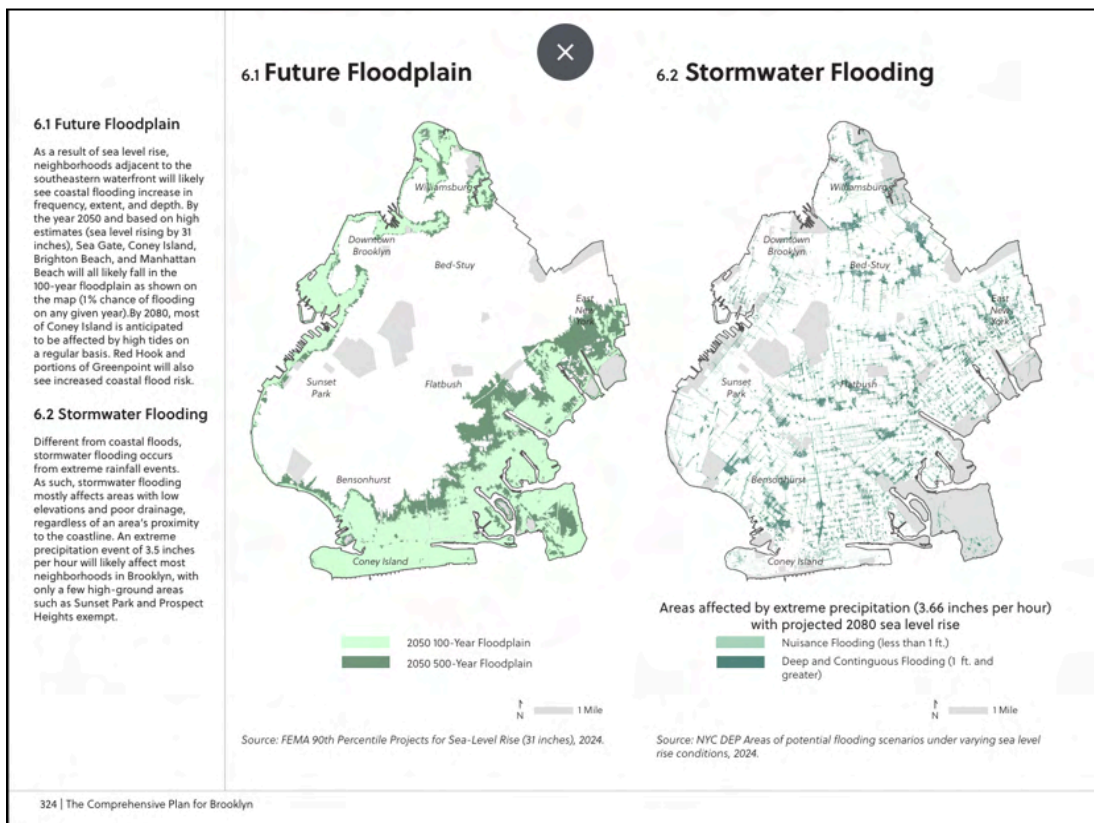


Image 4.23: Future Floodplain (left) and Stormwater Flooding (right).

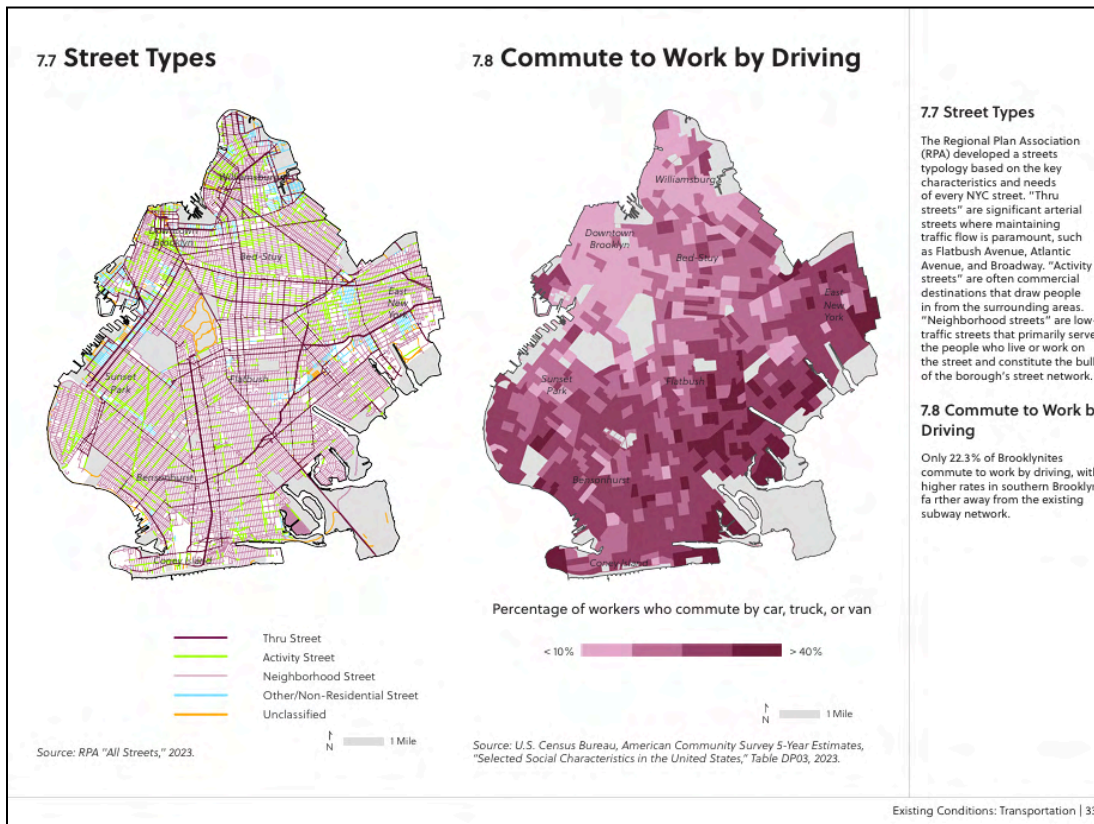


Image 4.24: Street Types (left) and Commute to Work by Driving (right).

